

शब्द

BOOK 3 · VOCABULARY

Words for a Delhi Life

*Twenty themed chapters · 1,100+ entries · Devanagari, roman, phonetics
and gender for every word.*

JACOB'S DELHI HINDI COURSE

A complete six-month self-study program · Standard Hindi of Delhi (Khari Boli) · 2026

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BEFORE YOU START

How to Read Every Entry in This Course

Every Hindi word and sentence in all of these books appears in **three layers**, always in the same order:

मैं दिल्ली में रहता हूँ।

main dillee mein rehtaa hoon. [meh(n) dil-lee may(n) reh-tah hoo(n)]

I live in Delhi.

Line 1 — Devanagari, the real Hindi script. Even in week 1, let your eyes rest on it before reading the other lines; recognition builds silently. **Line 2 — Roman** (*italics*), Hindi in English letters, spelled the way this course always spells it. **Line 3 — Say it** [in brackets], a phonetic respelling an American can read cold, hyphenated by syllable.

The Roman spelling system (training wheels with rules)

Long vowels doubled	<i>a / aa</i> (अ/आ), <i>i / ee</i> (इ/ई), <i>u / oo</i> (उ/ऊ) — so की is <i>kee</i> , का is <i>kaa</i>
CAPITALS = retroflex	<i>T Th D Dh N R Rh</i> (ट ठ ड ढ ण ढ ढ) — tongue curled back. Lowercase <i>t th d dh n</i> (त थ द ध न) = dental, tongue on the teeth. This is the single most useful habit in this course.
h = puff of air	<i>kh gh chh jh Th Dh th dh ph bh</i> are one sound each, said with extra breath
Urdu-flavored letters	<i>z</i> (ज़), <i>f</i> (फ़), <i>q</i> (क़) — Delhi speech is full of z and f
Nasal vowels	Roman keeps a plain <i>n</i> (<i>haan, mein, hoon</i>); the phonetic line shows the truth with (n): [hah(n)] — air through the nose, tongue touches nothing

Reading the phonetic line

uh	अ, like the a in <i>about</i>	ah	आ, as in <i>father</i>
i / ee	इ as in <i>bit</i> / ई as in <i>feet</i>	u / oo	उ as in <i>put</i> / ऊ as in <i>food</i>
ay	ए, like <i>say</i> but pure — freeze the vowel, no glide at the end	eh	ऐ, like <i>bed</i> held a beat longer (this is the Delhi value — है = [heh])
oh	ओ, like <i>go</i> but pure, no glide	aw	औ, like <i>law</i> with rounded lips (Delhi value — और = [awr])

Doubled consonants are split across the hyphen and genuinely held: दिल्ली [dil-lee] — park your tongue on the l for an extra beat. There are no stress capitals: Hindi syllables are far more even than English; the long vowels carry the weight naturally.

Other marks you'll meet

(m)/(f) after a noun is its gender — always learn it with the word. (vt)/(vi) marks verbs that do/don't take *ne* in the past (a Unit 14 story). (lit. ...) is a word-for-word gloss so you can see the Hindi skeleton. The bar | is the Hindi full stop.

NOTE

Two honest wrinkles, so they never confuse you: (1) written Hindi has वह/यह for he/she/it/this/that, but Delhi mouths say *voh* and *yeh*, and casual writing uses वो/ये freely — you'll see both in this course, exactly as you will in real life. (2) Everyday Delhi Hindi happily uses English words (स्कूल, फ़ोन, मेट्रो, टाइम); that's not "cheating," that's the dialect.

CHAPTER 1

Greetings & Courtesy

Delhi greets you in layers: a folded-hands नमस्ते (*namaste*) [nuh-muhs-tay] for the family, an Urdu-flavored आदाब (*aadaab*) [ah-dahb] in Old Delhi, and a cheerful “hello!” everywhere else. This chapter gives you the hellos, goodbyes, thank-yous and sorrys that carry you through a whole Delhi day — and tells you which ones people actually use.

Saying hello

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
नमस्ते	<i>namaste</i>	nuh-muhs-tay	hello / goodbye (all-purpose, safe everywhere)
नमस्कार	<i>namaskaar</i> (m)	nuh-muhs-kahr	hello (a shade more formal than namaste)
आदाब	<i>aadaab</i> (m)	ah-dahb	hello (Urdu-flavored; Old Delhi charm)
सलाम	<i>salaam</i> (m)	suh-lahm	hello (casual Urdu-flavored greeting)
हैलो	<i>helo</i>	heh-loh	hello (English; the default on the phone)
नमस्ते जी	<i>namaste jee</i>	nuh-muhs-tay jee	hello with extra respect (jee = respect tag)

How are you?

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आप कैसे हैं?	<i>aap kaise hain?</i>	ahp keh-say heh(n)	how are you? (polite, to a man)
आप कैसी हैं?	<i>aap kaisee hain?</i>	ahp keh-see heh(n)	how are you? (polite, to a woman)
तुम कैसे हो?	<i>tum kaise ho?</i>	tum keh-say hoh	how are you? (casual, to a man)
तुम कैसी हो?	<i>tum kaisee ho?</i>	tum keh-see hoh	how are you? (casual, to a woman)
क्या हाल है?	<i>kyaa haal hai?</i> (haal m)	kyah hahl heh	how's it going? / what's up?
सब बढ़िया?	<i>sab baRhiyaa?</i>	suhb buh-Rhi-yah	everything great? (Delhi favorite)
मैं ठीक हूँ	<i>main Theek hoon</i>	meh(n) Theek hoo(n)	I'm fine

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
बस बढ़िया	<i>bas baRhiyaa</i>	buh-s buh-Rhi-yah	just great (the standard cheerful answer)
सब ठीक है	<i>sab Theek hai</i>	suhb Theek heh	all is well
आप सुनाइए	<i>aap sunaaiye</i>	ahp su-nah-i-yay	and you? tell me your news (polite)
तुम सुनाओ	<i>tum sunaao</i>	tum su-nah-oh	and you? tell me your news (casual)
और आप?	<i>aur aap?</i>	awr ahp	and you? (polite)

WATCH OUT

Heard सब चंगा? (*sab changaa?*) [suhb chun-gah] in a song or from a Punjabi friend? That's **Punjabi**, not Hindi. It floats around Delhi because the city is half Punjabi at heart, but in Hindi say सब बढ़िया? (*sab baRhiyaa?*) or सब ठीक? (*sab Theek?*).

Saying goodbye

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मिलते हैं	<i>milte hain</i>	mil-tay heh(n)	see you (lit. we'll meet)
फिर मिलेंगे	<i>phir milenge</i>	phir mi-layn-gay	see you again / we'll meet again
कल मिलेंगे	<i>kal milenge</i>	kuhl mi-layn-gay	see you tomorrow
चलता हूँ	<i>chaltaa hoon</i>	chuhl-tah hoo(n)	I'll get going (man speaking)
चलती हूँ	<i>chaltee hoon</i>	chuhl-tee hoo(n)	I'll get going (woman speaking)
शुभ रात्रि	<i>shubh raatri</i>	shubh raht-ri	good night (formal / bookish)
गुड नाइट	<i>guD naaiT</i>	guD nah-iT	good night (what Delhi actually says)
अलविदा	<i>alvidaa</i>	uhl-vi-dah	farewell (dramatic / final — movies, airports)
टाटा / बाय	<i>TaaTaa / baay</i>	Tah-Tah / bah-ee	ta-ta / bye (very common, esp. with kids)

NOTE

शुभ रात्रि (*shubh raatri*) [shubh raht-ri] lives on greeting cards and TV announcers. At home in Delhi people say **“good night”** — गुड नाइट — or just सो जाओ (*so jaaO*) [soh jah-oh], “go to sleep.” Learn shubh raatri to read it, say good night to say it.

Please, sorry, thank you

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कृपया	<i>kripayaa</i>	kri-puh-yah	please (formal — signs, announcements)
प्लीज़	<i>pleez</i>	pleez	please (what people actually say)
ज़रा	<i>zaraa</i>	zuh-rah	just / a little (softens any request)
माफ़ कीजिए	<i>maaf keejiye</i>	mahf kee-ji-yay	excuse me / I'm sorry (polite)
माफ़ करना	<i>maaf karnaa</i>	mahf kuhr-nah	sorry (casual, between equals)
सॉरी	<i>sorree</i>	saw-ree	sorry (the everyday word in Delhi)
माफ़ी	<i>maafee</i> (f)	mah-fee	forgiveness, an apology
शुक्रिया	<i>shukriyaa</i> (m)	shuk-ri-yah	thanks (warm, Urdu-flavored — Delhi's favorite)
धन्यवाद	<i>dhanyavaad</i> (m)	dhun-yuh-vahd	thank you (formal, official)
थैंक्स / थैंक यू	<i>thainks / thaink yoo</i>	theh(n)ks / theh(n)k yoo	thanks (English; totally normal in Delhi)
बहुत-बहुत शुक्रिया	<i>bahut-bahut shukriyaa</i>	bo-hut bo-hut shuk-ri-yah	thank you so much
कोई बात नहीं	<i>koe baat naheen</i> (baat f)	koh-ee baht nuh-hee(n)	no problem / don't mention it
स्वागत है	<i>svaagat hai</i> (svaagat m)	svah-guht heh	welcome (you are welcome here)

Getting attention & oiling the conversation

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सुनिए	<i>suniye</i>	su-ni-yay	excuse me / listen (polite — strangers, elders)
सुनो	<i>suno</i>	su-noh	hey, listen (casual — partner, friends)
ज़रा सुनिए	<i>zaraa suniye</i>	zuh-rah su-ni-yay	excuse me a moment (extra soft)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जी	<i>jee</i>	jee	yes? / polite “hm?”; respect tag after names
जी हाँ	<i>jee haan</i>	jee hah(n)	yes (polite)
जी नहीं	<i>jee naheen</i>	jee nuh-hee(n)	no (polite)
अच्छा	<i>achchhaa</i>	uch-chhah	I see / oh really? / okay / good (all-purpose!)
ठीक है	<i>Theek hai</i>	Theek heh	okay / fine / deal
क्या बात है!	<i>kyaa baat hai!</i> (baat f)	kyah baht heh	wonderful! / wow! (lit. what a thing!)
अरे!	<i>arre!</i>	uh-ray	hey! / oh! (surprise, calling out)

NOTE

अच्छा (*achchhaa*) is Delhi’s Swiss-army word. Falling tone = “I see.” Rising tone = “oh really?!” Quick and flat = “okay, fine.” Drawn out — *achchhaaaa* — = “so THAT’s what’s going on.” Listen for it; you’ll hear it fifty times a day.

Welcoming someone to your home

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आइए	<i>aaiye</i>	ah-i-yay	come in / welcome (polite)
अंदर आइए	<i>andar aaiye</i>	un-dur ah-i-yay	come inside
बैठिए	<i>baiThiye</i>	beh-Thi-yay	please sit
आराम से बैठिए	<i>aaraam se baiThiye</i> (aaraam m)	ah-rahm say beh-Thi-yay	sit comfortably, make yourself at home
पानी लेंगे?	<i>paanee lenge?</i> (paanee m)	pah-nee layn-gay	will you have some water? (the automatic first offer)
चाय लेंगे?	<i>chaay lenge?</i> (chaay f)	chah-ay layn-gay	will you have tea?
खाना खाइए	<i>khaanaa khaaiye</i> (khaanaa m)	khah-nah khah-i-yay	please eat (food)
फिर आइए	<i>phir aaiye</i>	phir ah-i-yay	come again (said to departing guests)

In action

नमस्ते जी! आप कैसे हैं?

namaste jee! aap kaise hain? [nuh-muhs-tay jee, ahp keh-say heh(n)]

Hello! How are you? (polite, to a man)

मैं ठीक हूँ, शुक्रिया। आप सुनाइए।

main Theek hoon, shukriyaa. aap sunaaiye. [meh(n) Theek hoo(n), shuk-ri-yah. ahp su-nah-i-yay]

I'm fine, thanks. What's your news? (lit. I fine am, thanks. You tell.)

और भाई, क्या हाल है? — बस बढ़िया!

aur bhaaee, kyaa haal hai? — bas baRhiyaa! [awr bhah-ee, kyah hahl heh — buhs buh-Rhi-yah]

Hey brother, how's it going? — Just great!

माफ़ कीजिए, ज़रा सुनिए।

maaf keejiye, zaraa suniye. [mahf kee-ji-yay, zuh-rah su-ni-yay]

Excuse me, could I have a moment? (lit. forgive, just listen)

आइए, आइए! बैठिए। पानी लेंगे?

aaiye, aaiye! baiThiye. paanee lenge? [ah-i-yay, ah-i-yay, beh-Thi-yay. pah-nee layn-gay]

Come in, come in! Sit down. Will you have some water?

बहुत-बहुत शुक्रिया! — अरे, कोई बात नहीं।

bahut-bahut shukriyaa! — arre, koe baat naheen. [bo-hut bo-hut shuk-ri-yah — uh-ray, koh-ee baht nuh-hee(n)]

Thank you so much! — Oh, don't mention it.

अच्छा, मैं चलता हूँ। कल मिलेंगे।

achchhaa, main chaltaa hoon. kal milenge. [uch-chhah, meh(n) chuhl-tah hoo(n). kuhl mi-layn-gay]

Okay, I'll get going. See you tomorrow. (lit. okay, I moving am. tomorrow will-meet.)

तुमने खाना बनाया? क्या बात है!

tumne khaanaa banaayaa? kyaa baat hai! [tum-nay khah-nah buh-nah-yah? kyah baht heh]

You made dinner? Wonderful!

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's hellos wear its history. In Old Delhi and anywhere Urdu's music lingers you'll hear आदाब (*aadaab*) [ah-dahb] with a graceful hand raised toward the face, and a breezy सलाम (*salaam*) [suh-lahm] between friends. South Delhi mixes freely: “*helo yaar, kyaa haal hai?*” Answer any of them warmly and you're a local. And कृपया (*kripayaa*)? You'll hear it in every Metro announcement — *kripayaa dhyaan deejie*, “kindly pay attention” — but in conversation everyone just says *pleez* or softens the sentence with ज़रा (*zaraa*).

CULTURE

Here's a trap for polite Americans: **thanking family constantly feels cold in an Indian home.** When your partner's mother refills your plate the third time, a *thank you so much!* every single time builds a little wall — family is supposed to be beyond accounting. Smile, say बहुत अच्छा है (*bahut achchhaa hai*) [bo-hut uch-chhah heh] “it's really good,” and eat. Save शुक्रिया for real favors, and धन्यवाद for speeches. With shopkeepers and strangers, thank away — though even there, a warm ठीक है भैया (*Theek hai bhaiyaa*) [Theek heh bheh-yah] is more local than a thank-you.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three quick rounds with your partner this week:

1. **Morning hello:** greet each other properly for three days — you take नमस्ते! क्या हाल है? (*namaste! kyaa haal hai?*), they answer, then swap. Sneak in one आदाब for style points.
2. **Doorbell drama:** your partner is the guest at your door. Welcome them with आइए, बैठिए, पानी लेंगे? — then switch roles. Bonus: offer chai instead.
3. **The achchhaa game:** your partner tells you three bits of news (one boring, one surprising, one suspicious). You may only respond with अच्छा in different tones — they judge whether your tone matched the news.

CHAPTER 2

People & Family

Hindi keeps family close by keeping the words precise: your father's brother and your mother's brother get different names, and so do their wives. In a Delhi living room this vocabulary is the map of who sits where and who gets touched-feet respect — and since your partner's family is from Delhi, this chapter is your seating chart. Learn it in small doses; the tables below are built to come back to.

People

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आदमी	<i>aadmee</i> (m)	ahd-mee	man
औरत	<i>aurat</i> (f)	aw-ruht	woman
लड़का	<i>laRkaa</i> (m)	luhR-kah	boy
लड़की	<i>laRkee</i> (f)	luhR-kee	girl
बच्चा	<i>bachchaa</i> (m)	buch-chah	child (बच्चे bachche = children)
दोस्त	<i>dost</i> (m/f)	dohst	friend
पड़ोसी / पड़ोसन	<i>paRosee</i> (m) / <i>paRosan</i> (f)	puh-Roh-see / puh-Roh-sun	neighbor
लोग	<i>log</i> (m pl)	lohg	people

The immediate family

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
परिवार	<i>parivaar</i> (m)	puh-ri-vahr	family
माँ	<i>maan</i> (f)	mah(n)	mother, mom
मम्मी	<i>mummy</i> (f)	muhm-mee	mom (the everyday Delhi word)
माता जी	<i>maataa jee</i> (f)	mah-tah jee	mother (respectful/formal)
पिता जी	<i>pitaa jee</i> (m)	pi-tah jee	father (respectful/formal)
पापा	<i>paapaa</i> (m)	pah-pah	dad (the everyday Delhi word)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मम्मी-पापा	<i>mummy-paapaa</i> (m pl)	muhm-mee pah-pah	parents — Delhi families of every age say Mummy-Papa
भाई	<i>bhaaee</i> (m)	bhah-ee	brother
बहन	<i>behen</i> (f)	beh-hen	sister
बड़ा भाई	<i>baRaa bhaaee</i> (m)	buh-Rah bhah-ee	elder brother (likewise बड़ी बहन baRee behen)
छोटी बहन	<i>chhoTee behen</i> (f)	chhoh-Tee beh-hen	younger sister (likewise छोटा भाई chhoTaa bhaaee)
बेटा	<i>beTaa</i> (m)	bay-Tah	son (elders also call any young person beTaa)
बेटी	<i>beTee</i> (f)	bay-Tee	daughter

NOTE

Hindi has no separate word for **cousin** — all cousins are simply भाई (*bhaaee*) and बहन (*behen*), and English-speaking Delhiites say “cousin-brother” and “cousin-sister.” Treat your partner’s cousins as siblings; the family certainly does.

Grandparents — each side has its own pair

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दादा	<i>daadaa</i> (m)	dah-dah	grandfather (father’s father)
दादी	<i>daadee</i> (f)	dah-dee	grandmother (father’s mother)
नाना	<i>naanaa</i> (m)	nah-nah	grandfather (mother’s father)
नानी	<i>naanee</i> (f)	nah-nee	grandmother (mother’s mother)

Uncles & aunts — the full set, with who’s who

Each pair is one couple. The first word is the blood relative, the second is the spouse who married in.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	WHO EXACTLY
चाचा	<i>chaachaa</i> (m)	chah-chah	father’s younger brother
चाची	<i>chaachee</i> (f)	chah-chee	chaachaa’s wife
ताऊ	<i>taaoo</i> (m)	tah-oo	father’s elder brother

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	WHO EXACTLY
ताई	<i>taaee</i> (f)	tah-ee	taaoo's wife
मामा	<i>maamaa</i> (m)	mah-mah	mother's brother (elder or younger)
मामी	<i>maamee</i> (f)	mah-mee	maamaa's wife
मौसी	<i>mausee</i> (f)	maw-see	mother's sister
मौसा	<i>mausaa</i> (m)	maw-sah	mausee's husband
बुआ	<i>buaa</i> (f)	bu-ah	father's sister
फूफा	<i>phoophaa</i> (m)	phoo-phah	buaa's husband

The in-laws (ससुराल)

First, the simple part: **your partner's parents are your सास (*saas*) [sahs] and ससुर (*sasur*) [suh-sur]** — mother-in-law and father-in-law, regardless of which of you is which. The rest of the set depends on whose sibling someone is: you use the *wife's-side* words for your partner's siblings, and she uses the *husband's-side* words for yours. And you yourself join the family as its दामाद (*daamaad*) [dah-mahd] — and, to her younger siblings, as जीजा (*jeejaa*) [jee-jah].

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	WHO EXACTLY
ससुराल	<i>sasuraal</i> (m)	suh-su-rah	the in-laws' home / family
सास	<i>saas</i> (f)	sahs	mother-in-law
ससुर	<i>sasur</i> (m)	suh-sur	father-in-law
साला	<i>saalaa</i> (m)	sah-lah	wife's brother (see warning below!)
साली	<i>saalee</i> (f)	sah-lee	wife's sister
देवर	<i>devar</i> (m)	day-vur	husband's younger brother
जेठ	<i>jeTh</i> (m)	jayTh	husband's elder brother
ननद	<i>nanad</i> (f)	nuh-nud	husband's sister
भाभी	<i>bhaabhee</i> (f)	bhah-bhee	brother's wife (esp. elder brother's)
जीजा	<i>jeejaa</i> (m)	jee-jah	elder sister's husband
समधी / समधन	<i>samdhee</i> (m) / <i>samdhan</i> (f)	sum-dhee / sum- dhun	your child's parents-in-law (the two families' bond)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	WHO EXACTLY
दामाद	<i>daamaad</i> (m)	dah-mahd	son-in-law
बहू	<i>bahoo</i> (f)	buh-hoo	daughter-in-law

WATCH OUT

Handle साला (*saalaa*) with care. Used literally — *meraa saalaa*, my wife's brother — it's a normal family word. Shouted at anyone else, it's a genuine insult (it implies "I'm married to your sister"). Delhiites toss *saalaa/saalee* around as spicy slang between close friends, but do not copy that until your Hindi — and your friendship — can carry it. When in doubt, say it only about your actual brother-in-law.

Couples

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पति	<i>pati</i> (m)	puh-ti	husband
पत्नी	<i>patnee</i> (f)	put-nee	wife
शादी	<i>shaadee</i> (f)	shah-dee	marriage, wedding (formal word: विवाह <i>vivaah</i> [vi-vah])
मंगेतर	<i>mangetar</i> (m/f)	mun-gay-tur	fiancé / fiancée
बॉयफ्रेंड / गर्लफ्रेंड	<i>boyfrend</i> (m) / <i>girlfrend</i> (f)	boy-frenD / gurl- frenD	boyfriend / girlfriend — Delhi says the English words
प्रेमी / प्रेमिका	<i>premee</i> (m) / <i>premikaa</i> (f)	pray-mee / pray- mi-kah	boyfriend / girlfriend (bookish-filmi; songs & novels)

Family for strangers

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
भैया	<i>bhaiyaa</i> (m)	bheh-yah	brother — any man your age: vendor, driver, waiter
दीदी	<i>deedee</i> (f)	dee-dee	elder sister — any woman a bit older
आंटी जी	<i>aunty jee</i> (f)	ahn-Tee jee	any woman of your parents' age
अंकल जी	<i>uncle jee</i> (m)	un-kul jee	any man of your parents' age
रिश्तेदार	<i>rishtedaar</i> (m/f)	rish-tay-dahr	relative

In action

यह मेरे पापा हैं और यह मेरी मम्मी हैं।

yeh mere paapaa hain aur yeh meree mummy hain. [yeh may-ray pah-pah heh(n) awr yeh may-ree muhm-mee heh(n)]

This is my dad and this is my mom. (lit. this my papa are — parents get respectful plural)

मेरा एक बड़ा भाई और एक छोटी बहन है।

meraa ek baRaa bhaaee aur ek chhoTee behen hai. [may-rah ayk buh-Rah bhah-ee awr ayk chhoh-Tee beh-hen heh]

I have one elder brother and one younger sister.

आपके कितने बच्चे हैं? — दो बेटे और एक बेटी।

aapke kitne bachche hain? — do beTe aur ek beTee. [ahp-kay kit-nay buch-chay heh(n) — doh bay-Tay awr ayk bay-Tee]

How many children do you have? — Two sons and one daughter.

दादी पापा की माँ हैं, और नानी मम्मी की।

daadee paapaa kee maan hain, aur naanee mummy kee. [dah-dee pah-pah kee mah(n) heh(n), awr nah-nee muhm-mee kee]

Daadi is dad's mother, and naani is mom's.

मेरे सास-ससुर दिल्ली में रहते हैं।

mere saas-sasur dillee mein rehte hain. [may-ray sahs-suh-sur dil-lee may(n) reh-tay heh(n)]

My parents-in-law live in Delhi.

भाभी, चाय बहुत अच्छी है!

bhaabhee, chaay bahut achchhee hai! [bhah-bhee, chah-ay bo-hut uch-chhee heh]

Bhabhi, the tea is really good!

वह मेरा दोस्त नहीं, मेरा जीजा है।

voh meraa dost naheen, meraa jeejaa hai. [voh may-rah dohst nuh-hee(n), may-rah jee-jah heh]

He's not my friend — he's my brother-in-law (my elder sister's husband).

यह मेरी मंगेतर है। हमारी शादी मार्च में है।

yeh meree mangetar hai. hamaaree shaadee maarch mein hai. [yeh may-ree mun-gay-tur heh. huh-mah-ree shah-dee mahrch may(n) heh]

This is my fiancée. Our wedding is in March.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi families run on Hinglish. Parents are **Mummy-Papa** even when the kids are fifty; spouses introduce each other with the English words — “*ye mere husband hain, ye meree wife hain*” — and *boyfriend/girlfriend* exist only in English, because the Hindi words sound like a 1970s film script. A friend’s wife is warmly called भाभी (*bhaabhee*) even though she’s no relation — and a chai vendor may call his customer’s wife bhaabhee jee too.

CULTURE

In Delhi nobody respectable is a stranger for long: the auto driver is भैया (*bhaiyaa*), the vegetable seller’s wife is दीदी (*deedee*), your partner’s parents’ neighbors are आंटी जी (*aunty jee*) and अंकल जी (*uncle jee*). Using family words for non-family isn’t over-familiar — it’s the polite default, and it instantly warms the interaction. The one to avoid: don’t call a young woman bhaiyaa’s feminine equivalent बहन जी (*behen jee*) [beh-hen jee] — in Delhi it can come off as calling her dowdy. दीदी is the safe warm choice.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks with your partner:

1. **Family tree, out loud:** your partner names five relatives (in English); you produce the exact Hindi term — *your mom’s sister?* मौसी! Then reverse: they say मामी, you say who that is.
2. **The introduction drill:** point at photos on your partner’s phone and introduce each person: यह मेरी सास हैं। यह मेरा साला है। (*yeh meree saas hain. yeh meraa saalaa hai.*) Respect-plural for elders!
3. **Who am I to them?** Work out together what each of her relatives calls *you* — you’re daamaad to her parents, jeejaa to her younger sister... Say each one aloud: मैं दामाद हूँ। (*main daamaad hoon.*)

CHAPTER 3

Pronouns, Question Words & Little Words

These are the fifty smallest words in Hindi and the fifty you will say most: I, you, who, what, where, also, just, absolutely. Delhi conversation is stitched together out of them — *kyaa? kaun? achchhaa, voh bhee?* Master this chapter and you can already interrogate, agree, refuse and gossip.

Personal pronouns

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मैं	<i>main</i>	meh(n)	I
हम	<i>ham</i>	huhm	we
तू	<i>tu</i>	too	you (super-intimate — or rude; handle with care)
तुम	<i>tum</i>	tum	you (casual — partner, friends, kids)
आप	<i>aap</i>	ahp	you (polite — elders, in-laws, strangers)
यह	<i>yeh</i>	yeh	this; he/she (nearby)
वह	<i>voh</i>	voh	that; he/she (over there)
ये	<i>ye</i>	yay	these; they (nearby); also respectful he/she
वो लोग	<i>voh log</i> (log m pl)	voh loh	they, those people (spoken plural of voh)

NOTE

Print and speech disagree here. On the page you'll see वह and plural वे (*ve*) [vay]; out of a Delhi mouth both come out **voh** — and the plural becomes वो लोग (*voh log*). Same with यह: written *yah*-style, said **yeh**. This course romanizes the spoken forms.

Handy possessives & “to me”

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मेरा / मेरे / मेरी	<i>meraa / mere / meree</i>	may-rah / may-ray / may-ree	my (agrees with the noun)
तुम्हारा	<i>tumhaaraa</i>	tum-hah-rah	your (casual)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आपका	<i>aapkaa</i>	ahp-kah	your (polite)
हमारा	<i>hamaaraa</i>	huh-mah-rah	our
मुझे	<i>mujhe</i>	mu-jhay	me, to me (mujhe pasand hai = I like it)
आपको / तुमको	<i>aapko / tumko</i>	ahp-koh / tum-koh	to you (polite / casual)

Question words — the complete kit

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
क्या	<i>kyaa</i>	kyah	what? (also turns a sentence into a yes/no question)
कौन	<i>kaun</i>	kawn	who?
कब	<i>kab</i>	kuhb	when?
कहाँ	<i>kahaan</i>	kuh-hah(n)	where?
क्यों	<i>kyon</i>	kyoh(n)	why?
कैसे	<i>kaise</i>	keh-say	how? (kaisaa/kaisee = what's ... like?)
कितना	<i>kitnaa</i>	kit-nah	how much? (कितने kitne = how many?)
कौन-सा	<i>kaun-saa</i>	kawn-sah	which one? (kaun-see for f nouns)
किसका	<i>kiskaa</i>	kis-kah	whose?

Here, there, somewhere

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
यहाँ	<i>yahaan</i>	yuh-hah(n)	here
वहाँ	<i>vahaan</i>	vuh-hah(n)	there
कहीं	<i>kaheen</i>	kuh-hee(n)	somewhere (kaheen naheen = nowhere)
यहीं	<i>yaheen</i>	yuh-hee(n)	right here (the hee hiding inside = exactly)
वहीं	<i>vaheen</i>	vuh-hee(n)	right there

Someone, something, everyone, nothing

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कोई	<i>koe</i>	koh-ee	someone; some (person); any
कुछ	<i>kuchh</i>	kuchh	something; some (amount)
कोई नहीं	<i>koe naheen</i>	koh-ee nuh-hee(n)	no one
कुछ नहीं	<i>kuchh naheen</i>	kuchh nuh-hee(n)	nothing
सब	<i>sab</i>	suhb	all, everyone
सब कुछ	<i>sab kuchh</i>	suhb kuchh	everything
सब लोग	<i>sab log</i> (log m pl)	suhb loh	everybody, all the people
हर	<i>har</i>	huhr	every (har din = every day)
दोनों	<i>donon</i>	doh-noh(n)	both

The little words that flavor everything

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
भी	<i>bhee</i>	bhee	also, too, even (sits right after the word it touches)
ही	<i>hee</i>	hee	only, exactly (yeh hee = this very one)
तो	<i>to</i>	toh	then; as for (main to... = as for me...)
बस	<i>bas</i>	buhs	that's all; just; enough!
सिर्फ	<i>sirf</i>	sirf	only (sirf ek = just one)
मत	<i>mat</i>	muht	don't (with commands: mat jaao = don't go)

Yes, no, maybe, absolutely

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
हाँ	<i>haan</i>	hah(n)	yes
नहीं	<i>naheen</i>	nuh-hee(n)	no; not
जी हाँ / जी नहीं	<i>jee haan / jee naheen</i>	jee hah(n) / jee nuh-hee(n)	yes / no (polite — use with elders)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
शायद	<i>shaayad</i>	shah-yud	maybe, perhaps
बिल्कुल	<i>bilkul</i>	bil-kul	absolutely, totally (bilkul naheen = not at all)
ज़रूर	<i>zaroor</i>	zuh-roor	definitely, of course

In action

यह क्या है? — कुछ नहीं!

yeh kyaa hai? — kuchh naheen! [yeh kyah heh — kuchh nuh-hee(n)]

What's this? — Nothing!

तुम कहाँ हो? — मैं यहीं हूँ।

tum kahaan ho? — main yaheen hoon. [tum kuh-hah(n) hoh — meh(n) yuh-hee(n) hoo(n)]

Where are you? — I'm right here.

वह कौन है? — कोई नहीं, मेरा दोस्त है।

voh kaun hai? — koe naheen, meraa dost hai. [voh kawn heh — koh-ee nuh-hee(n), may-rah dohst heh]

Who's that? — No one, just a friend of mine.

मेट्रो कब है? — शायद दस बजे।

meTro kab hai? — shaayad das baje. [may-Troh kuhb heh — shah-yud duhs buh-jay]

When is the metro? — Maybe at ten.

कौन-सा अच्छा है? — दोनों अच्छे हैं!

kaun-saa achchhaa hai? — donon achchhe hain! [kawn-sah uch-chhah heh — doh-noh(n) uch-chhay heh(n)]

Which one is good? — Both are good!

मुझे भी चाय चाहिए।

mujhe bhee chaay chaahiye. [mu-jhay bhee chah-ay chah-hi-yay]

I want tea too. (lit. to-me also tea wanted)

सिर्फ पानी, और कुछ नहीं।

sirf paanee, aur kuchh naheen. [sirf pah-nee, awr kuchh nuh-hee(n)]

Just water, nothing else.

तुम ज़रूर आओगे? — बिल्कुल!

tum zaroor aaoge? — bilkul! [tum zuh-roor ah-oh-gay — bil-kul]

You'll definitely come? — Absolutely!

सब लोग वहाँ हैं, हम भी चलें?

sab log vahaan hain, ham bhee chalen? [suhb loh-g vuh-hah(n) heh(n), huhm bhee chuh-lay(n)]

Everyone's there — shall we go too?

DELHI STREET NOTE

On the street, Delhi friends run on तू (*tu*) and *yaar*: तू कहाँ है यार? (*tu kahaan hai yaar?*) [too kuh-hah(n) heh yahr] “where are you, man?” It signals total closeness — and from an outsider it signals disrespect. Your safe ladder: **aap** for elders, in-laws and strangers, **tum** for your partner and friends, and **tu** only if a close friend uses it with you first. When Delhiites want to be extra warm AND polite, they stack: आप बताइए न! (*aap bataaiye na!*) [ahp buh-tah-i-yay nah] “do tell!”

CULTURE

The tu-tum-aap ladder is a map of intimacy, not just politeness. Old friends, small children, and God all get तू — bhajans and Bollywood love songs are full of it — because total intimacy and total surrender sound the same. Meanwhile many Delhi couples keep a lifelong तुम, and some old-school spouses even use आप with each other. Ask your partner what their parents use for each other — the answer usually comes with a story.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks with your partner:

1. **Twenty questions, Delhi style:** your partner thinks of a person you both know. You get ten questions using at least five different question words — कौन? कहाँ? कितना? They answer only with हाँ / नहीं / शायद / बिल्कुल.
2. **The bhee game:** they say what they want — मुझे चाय चाहिए। You always want the same thing: मुझे भी! (*mujhe bhee!*) Then flip it with सिर्फ़: *sirf ek chaay* — only one tea, and argue over who gets it.
3. **Pronoun audit:** together, list five real people (her mom, the chai bhaiyaa, her best friend...) and decide for each: tu, tum, or aap? Say a one-line greeting to each imaginary person with the right pronoun.

CHAPTER 4

Numbers 0-100 & the Counting System

Here's the honest truth every Hindi learner deserves upfront: **Hindi numbers 1-100 are a hundred little words**, not a neat system like English "twenty-one, twenty-two." Each decade rhymes internally, and there are patterns worth knowing (below), but at some point you simply befriend all hundred. That's exactly what flashcard Deck D03 is for — ten a day, and in six weeks they're yours for life. Meanwhile, real Delhi shopping runs on numbers, so this chapter earns its keep fast.

0-10: learn these today

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
0	०	शून्य	<i>shoonya</i>	shoon-yuh
1	१	एक	<i>ek</i>	ayk
2	२	दो	<i>do</i>	doh
3	३	तीन	<i>teen</i>	teen
4	४	चार	<i>chaar</i>	chahr
5	५	पाँच	<i>paanch</i>	pah(n)ch
6	६	छह	<i>chheh</i>	chheh
7	७	सात	<i>saat</i>	saht
8	८	आठ	<i>aaTh</i>	ahTh
9	९	नौ	<i>nau</i>	naw
10	१०	दस	<i>das</i>	dus

11-20

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
11	११	ग्यारह	<i>gyaarah</i>	gyah-ruh
12	१२	बारह	<i>baarah</i>	bah-ruh
13	१३	तेरह	<i>terah</i>	tay-ruh

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
14	१४	चौदह	<i>chaudah</i>	chaw-duh
15	१५	पंद्रह	<i>pandrah</i>	pun-druh
16	१६	सोलह	<i>solah</i>	soh-luh
17	१७	सत्रह	<i>satrah</i>	sut-ruh
18	१८	अठारह	<i>aThaarah</i>	uh-Thah-ruh
19	१९	उन्नीस	<i>unnees</i>	un-nees
20	२०	बीस	<i>bees</i>	bees

The pattern cheat-sheet (read before the big table)

Decade endings	Each decade rhymes: –ees (20s), –tees (30s), –aalees (40s), the 50s end –van, the 60s –saTh, 70s –hattar, 80s –aasee, 90s –aanave.
First digits echo	ik– (1), baa–/ba– (2), ti–/tir– (3), chau– (4), pach– (5), chha– (6), sat– (7), aTh– (8) — e.g. <i>ik-kees</i> , <i>ik-tees</i> , <i>ik-taalees</i> , <i>ik-yah-van...</i> all start with ik.
The 9s look ahead	Numbers ending in 9 say "one-less-than-next-decade": उन्नीस (19, un-BEES-ish), उनतीस (29), उनचास (49), उनसठ (59), उनहत्तर (69), उन्यासी (79). The un– prefix means "just under." (89 breaks the pattern: नवासी.)
Hyphens in our Roman	In words like <i>baa-ees</i> (22) and <i>ik-hattar</i> (71) the hyphen just marks a seam so you don't misread the vowels — it isn't written in Hindi.

21-100, decade by decade

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
21	२१	इक्कीस	<i>ikkees</i>	ik-kees
22	२२	बाईस	<i>baa-ees</i>	bah-ees
23	२३	तेईस	<i>te-ees</i>	tay-ees
24	२४	चौबीस	<i>chaubees</i>	chaw-bees
25	२५	पच्चीस	<i>pachchees</i>	puch-chees
26	२६	छब्बीस	<i>chhabbees</i>	chhub-bees

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
27	२७	सत्ताईस	<i>sattaa-ees</i>	sut-tah-ees
28	२८	अट्ठाईस	<i>aTThaa-ees</i>	uT-Thah-ees
29	२९	उनतीस	<i>untees</i>	un-tees
30	३०	तीस	<i>tees</i>	tees
31	३१	इकतीस	<i>iktees</i>	ik-tees
32	३२	बत्तीस	<i>battees</i>	but-tees
33	३३	तैंतीस	<i>tainteess</i>	teh(n)-tees
34	३४	चौंतीस	<i>chauntees</i>	chaw(n)-tees
35	३५	पैंतीस	<i>paintees</i>	peh(n)-tees
36	३६	छत्तीस	<i>chhattees</i>	chhut-tees
37	३७	सैंतीस	<i>sainteess</i>	seh(n)-tees
38	३८	अड़तीस	<i>aRtees</i>	uhR-tees
39	३९	उनतालीस	<i>untaalees</i>	un-tah-lees
40	४०	चालीस	<i>chaalees</i>	chah-lees
#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
41	४१	इकतालीस	<i>iktaalees</i>	ik-tah-lees
42	४२	बयालीस	<i>bayaalees</i>	buh-yah-lees
43	४३	तैंतालीस	<i>taintaalees</i>	teh(n)-tah-lees
44	४४	चवालीस	<i>chavaalees</i>	chuh-vah-lees
45	४५	पैंतालीस	<i>paintaalees</i>	peh(n)-tah-lees
46	४६	छियालीस	<i>chhiyaalees</i>	chhi-yah-lees
47	४७	सैंतालीस	<i>saintaalees</i>	seh(n)-tah-lees
48	४८	अड़तालीस	<i>aRtaalees</i>	uhR-tah-lees
49	४९	उनचास	<i>unchaas</i>	un-chahs

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
50	५०	पचास	<i>pachaas</i>	puh-chahs
51	५१	इक्यावन	<i>ikyaavan</i>	ik-yah-vun
52	५२	बावन	<i>baavan</i>	bah-vun
53	५३	तिरपन	<i>tirpan</i>	tir-pun
54	५४	चौवन	<i>chauvan</i>	chaw-vun
55	५५	पचपन	<i>pachpan</i>	puch-pun
56	५६	छप्पन	<i>chhappan</i>	chhup-pun
57	५७	सत्तावन	<i>sattaavan</i>	sut-tah-vun
58	५८	अट्ठावन	<i>aTThaavan</i>	uT-Thah-vun
59	५९	उनसठ	<i>unsaTh</i>	un-suTh
60	६०	साठ	<i>saaTh</i>	sahTh
#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
61	६१	इकसठ	<i>iksaTh</i>	ik-suTh
62	६२	बासठ	<i>baasaTh</i>	bah-suTh
63	६३	तिरसठ	<i>tirsaTh</i>	tir-suTh
64	६४	चौंसठ	<i>chaunsaTh</i>	chaw(n)-suTh
65	६५	पैंसठ	<i>painsaTh</i>	peh(n)-suTh
66	६६	छियासठ	<i>chhiyaasaTh</i>	chhi-yah-suTh
67	६७	सड़सठ	<i>saRsaTh</i>	suhR-suTh
68	६८	अड़सठ	<i>aRsaTh</i>	uhR-suTh
69	६९	उनहत्तर	<i>unhattar</i>	un-hut-tur
70	७०	सत्तर	<i>sattar</i>	sut-tur
71	७१	इकहत्तर	<i>ik-hattar</i>	ik-hut-tur
72	७२	बहत्तर	<i>bahattar</i>	buh-hut-tur

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
73	७३	तिहत्तर	<i>tihattar</i>	ti-hut-tur
74	७४	चौहत्तर	<i>chauhattar</i>	chaw-hut-tur
75	७५	पचहत्तर	<i>pach-hattar</i>	puch-hut-tur
76	७६	छिहत्तर	<i>chhihattar</i>	chhi-hut-tur
77	७७	सतहत्तर	<i>sat-hattar</i>	sut-hut-tur
78	७८	अठहत्तर	<i>aTh-hattar</i>	uTh-hut-tur
79	७९	उन्यासी	<i>unyaasee</i>	un-yah-see
80	८०	अस्सी	<i>assee</i>	us-see
#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
81	८१	इक्यासी	<i>ikyaasee</i>	ik-yah-see
82	८२	बयासी	<i>bayaasee</i>	buh-yah-see
83	८३	तिरासी	<i>tiraasee</i>	ti-rah-see
84	८४	चौरासी	<i>chauraasee</i>	chaw-rah-see
85	८५	पचासी	<i>pachaasee</i>	puh-chah-see
86	८६	छियासी	<i>chhiyaasee</i>	chhi-yah-see
87	८७	सत्तासी	<i>sattaasee</i>	sut-tah-see
88	८८	अट्ठासी	<i>aTThaasee</i>	uT-Thah-see
89	८९	नवासी	<i>navaasee</i>	nuh-vah-see
90	९०	नब्बे	<i>nabbe</i>	nub-bay
91	९१	इक्यानवे	<i>ikyaanave</i>	ik-yah-nuh-vay
92	९२	बानवे	<i>baanave</i>	bah-nuh-vay
93	९३	तिरानवे	<i>tiraanave</i>	ti-rah-nuh-vay
94	९४	चौरानवे	<i>chauraanave</i>	chaw-rah-nuh-vay
95	९५	पचानवे	<i>pachaanave</i>	puh-chah-nuh-vay

#	अंक	हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT
96	९६	छियानवे	<i>chhiyaanave</i>	chhi-yah-nuh-vay
97	९७	सत्तानवे	<i>sattaanave</i>	sut-tah-nuh-vay
98	९८	अट्टानवे	<i>aTThaanave</i>	uT-Thah-nuh-vay
99	९९	निन्यानवे	<i>ninyaanave</i>	nin-yah-nuh-vay
100	१००	सौ	<i>sau</i>	saw

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi survival shortcut while the deck does its work: you can always say the digits — *chaar-do* gets you understood for 42 in a pinch, and vendors themselves say prices in English constantly ("forty rupees, bhaiyaa"). Locals also quote fuzzy ranges by pairing numbers: पचास-साठ *pachaas-saaTh* "fifty-sixty" = fiftyish. But know that a crisp बयालीस from a foreigner makes a sabzi-vaalaa's whole afternoon.

Ordinals — first, second, third...

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पहला	<i>pehlaa</i>	peh-lah	first
दूसरा	<i>doosraa</i>	doos-rah	second (also "other")
तीसरा	<i>teesraa</i>	tees-rah	third
चौथा	<i>chauthaa</i>	chaw-thah	fourth
पाँचवाँ	<i>paanchvaan</i>	pah(n)ch-vah(n)	fifth (from 5 on: number + -vaan)
छठा	<i>chhaThaa</i>	chhuh-Thah	sixth (irregular)

These agree like adjectives: पहली बार *pehlee baar* "the first time" (baar is feminine).

The quantity words Delhi actually runs on

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आधा	<i>aadhaa</i>	ah-dhah	half — आधा किलो, half kilo
पाव	<i>paav</i>	pahv	a quarter (kilo) — the sabzi-mandi unit: 250 g
सवा	<i>savaa</i>	suh-vah	plus a quarter — सवा दो = 2¼ (and 2:15 for time)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
साढ़े	<i>saaRhe</i>	sah-Rhay	plus a half — साढ़े तीन = $3\frac{1}{2}$ (3:30) — from 3 up ONLY
पौने	<i>paune</i>	paw-nay	minus a quarter — पौने चार = $3\frac{3}{4}$ (3:45)
डेढ़	<i>DeRh</i>	DayRh	$1\frac{1}{2}$ — its own word; never "saaRhe ek"
ढाई	<i>Dhaaee</i>	Dhah-ee	$2\frac{1}{2}$ — its own word; never "saaRhe do"

Big numbers — welcome to the lakh system

सौ *sau* = 100 · हज़ार *hazaar* = 1,000 · लाख *laakh* = 100,000 · करोड़ *karoR* = 10,000,000. India doesn't count in millions: a flat in Delhi costs अस्सी लाख (80 lakh = 8 million rupees), a hit movie earns सौ करोड़. Even the commas move: 12,34,56,789 (twelve crore, thirty-four lakh...). Compose in-between numbers by stacking: दो सौ पचास *do sau pachaas* = 250; पंद्रह सौ *pandrah sau* "fifteen hundred" = 1,500 (very common for prices).

CULTURE

Phone numbers are read digit-by-digit, and repeated digits use "*Dabal*": 98110-22-33 becomes *nau aaTh ek ek shoonya, Dabal do, Dabal teen*. Delhiites often just switch to English digits mid-number — both are correct Delhi.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three number games: (1) partner says any 2-digit number in Hindi, you write the digits — ten per round; (2) price quiz: they name a Delhi item (chai, auto ride, movie ticket), you guess the price *in Hindi*, they correct you with the real one; (3) the DeRh/Dhaaee trap: they ask times — 1:30? 2:30? 3:30? — you must answer *DeRh, Dhaaee, saaRhe teen* without stumbling.

CHAPTER 5

Time: Days, Months & the Clock

Delhi keeps two clocks: the official one, and the social one that runs forty minutes behind it. This chapter gives you the words for both — days, months, parts of the day, and the Hindi clock with its two famous specialties, डेढ़ (*DeRh*) [DayRh] and ढाई (*Dhaaee*) [Dhah-ee], which trip up every learner exactly once.

Days of the week

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सोमवार	<i>somvaar</i> (m)	sohm-vahr	Monday
मंगलवार	<i>mangalvaar</i> (m)	mun-gul-vahr	Tuesday
बुधवार	<i>budhvaar</i> (m)	budh-vahr	Wednesday
गुरुवार	<i>guruvaar</i> (m)	gu-ru-vahr	Thursday (Delhi also says वीरवार <i>veervaar</i> [veer-vahr])
शुक्रवार	<i>shukravaar</i> (m)	shuk-ruh-vahr	Friday
शनिवार	<i>shanivaar</i> (m)	shuh-ni-vahr	Saturday
रविवार	<i>ravivaar</i> (m)	ruh-vi-vahr	Sunday (official word)
इतवार	<i>itvaar</i> (m)	it-vahr	Sunday — the word Delhi actually says

Months

Hindi's everyday month names are Hindi-flavored English — and in Delhi speech people usually just say the English names anyway (“*March mein shaadee hai*”). Learn these to read signs, tickets and wedding cards.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जनवरी	<i>janvaree</i> (f)	jun-vuh-ree	January
फ़रवरी	<i>farvaree</i> (f)	fur-vuh-ree	February
मार्च	<i>maarch</i> (m)	mahrch	March
अप्रैल	<i>aprail</i> (m)	up-rehl	April
मई	<i>maee</i> (f)	muh-ee	May
जून	<i>joon</i> (m)	joon	June

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जुलाई	<i>julaaee</i> (f)	ju-lah-ee	July
अगस्त	<i>agast</i> (m)	uh-gust	August
सितंबर	<i>sitambar</i> (m)	si-tum-bur	September
अक्टूबर	<i>akToobar</i> (m)	uk-Too-bur	October
नवंबर	<i>navambar</i> (m)	nuh-vum-bur	November
दिसंबर	<i>disambar</i> (m)	di-sum-bur	December

Today, tomorrow — and yesterday

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आज	<i>aaj</i>	ahj	today
कल	<i>kal</i>	kuhl	tomorrow AND yesterday (one day away — see box!)
परसों	<i>parson</i>	puhr-soh(n)	day after tomorrow AND day before yesterday

WATCH OUT

कल (*kal*) means **one day away from today — in either direction**, and परसों (*parson*) means two. The verb tells you which way: कल मैं गया (*kal main gayaa*) [kuhl meh(n) guh-yah] = *yesterday* I went; कल मैं जाऊँगा (*kal main jaaongaa*) [kuhl meh(n) jah-oo(n)-gah] = *tomorrow* I'll go. English speakers panic; Hindi speakers never notice the ambiguity.

Parts of the day

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सुबह	<i>subah</i> (f)	su-beh	morning
दोपहर	<i>dopahar</i> (f)	doh-peh-hur	afternoon, midday
शाम	<i>shaam</i> (f)	shahm	evening
रात	<i>raat</i> (f)	raht	night (aaj raat = tonight)

Now, later, early, late

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अब	<i>ab</i>	uhb	now
अभी	<i>abhee</i>	uh-bhee	right now, just now
बाद में	<i>baad mein</i>	bahd may(n)	later, afterwards
पहले	<i>pehle</i>	peh-lay	before, earlier, first
जल्दी	<i>jaldee</i>	juhl-dee	early; quickly; soon (jaldee karo! = hurry up!)
देर से	<i>der se</i> (der f)	dayr say	late (der = delay; der ho gae = it got late)
हमेशा	<i>hameshaa</i>	huh-may-shah	always
कभी-कभी	<i>kabhee-kabhee</i>	kuh-bhee kuh-bhee	sometimes
रोज़ / हर रोज़	<i>roz / har roz</i>	roh-z / huhr roh-z	daily / every single day

Telling time

The question is कितने बजे हैं? (*kitne baje hain?*) [kit-nay buh-jay heh(n)] — literally “how many have struck?” One o’clock is singular — एक बजा है (*ek bajaa hai*) [ayk buh-jah heh] — and everything from two up is plural: दो बजे हैं (*do baje hain*) [doh buh-jay heh(n)].

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कितने बजे हैं?	<i>kitne baje hain?</i>	kit-nay buh-jay heh(n)	what time is it?
दो बजे	<i>do baje</i>	doh buh-jay	two o’clock / at two
सवा पाँच	<i>savaa paanch</i>	suh-vah pah(n)ch	quarter past five (5:15)
साढ़े तीन	<i>saaRhe teen</i>	sah-Rhay teen	half past three (3:30)
पौने चार	<i>paune chaar</i>	paw-nay chahr	quarter to four (3:45)
डेढ़ बजे	<i>DeRh baje</i>	DayRh buh-jay	half past ONE (1:30) — special word
ढाई बजे	<i>Dhaaee baje</i>	Dhah-ee buh-jay	half past TWO (2:30) — special word

WATCH OUT

Never say “saaRhe ek” or “saaRhe do.” Hindi has dedicated words for one-and-a-half and two-and-a-half: डेढ़ (*DeRh*) = 1½ and ढाई (*Dhaaee*) = 2½. So 1:30 = **DeRh baje**, 2:30 = **Dhaaee baje**, and साढ़े (*saaRhe*) only starts at 3:30 = *saaRhe teen*. The same words measure everything: *DeRh kilo* (1½ kg), *Dhaaee saal* (2½ years), *DeRh ghanTaa* (an hour and a half). Delhi will grin and correct you on this one — beat them to it.

Minutes, hours, weeks, years

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मिनट	<i>minaT</i> (m)	mi-nuT	minute (paanch minaT = five minutes)
घंटा	<i>ghanTaa</i> (m)	ghun-Tah	hour
दिन	<i>din</i> (m)	din	day
हफ्ता	<i>haftaa</i> (m)	huhf-tah	week (formal word: सप्ताह <i>saptaah</i> [sup-tah])
महीना	<i>maheena</i> (m)	muh-hee-nah	month
साल	<i>saal</i> (m)	sahl	year
तारीख	<i>taareekh</i> (f)	tah-reekh	date (of the month)
पिछला हफ्ता	<i>pichhlaa haftaa</i> (m)	pichh-lah huhf-tah	last week (pichhle hafte = last week [adverb])
अगला हफ्ता	<i>aglaa haftaa</i> (m)	ug-lah huhf-tah	next week (agle hafte = next week [adverb])
छुट्टी	<i>chhuTTee</i> (f)	chhuT-Tee	holiday, day off
वीकेंड	<i>veekenD</i> (m)	vee-kenD	weekend (yes, in Devanagari — Delhi says it constantly)

In action

आज सोमवार है।

aaj somvaar hai. [ahj soh-m-vahr heh]

Today is Monday.

कल इतवार है — छुट्टी!

kal itvaar hai — chhuTTee! [kuhl it-vahr heh — chhuT-Tee]

Tomorrow is Sunday — day off!

कितने बजे हैं? — साढ़े चार बजे हैं।

kitne baje hain? — saaRhe chaar baje hain. [kit-nay buh-jay heh(n) — sah-Rhay chahr buh-jay heh(n)]

What time is it? — It's half past four.

फ़िल्म डेढ़ बजे है, ढाई बजे नहीं।

film DeRh baje hai, Dhaaee baje naheen. [film DayRh buh-jay heh, Dhah-ee buh-jay nuh-hee(n)]

The movie is at 1:30, not 2:30.

मैं सुबह जल्दी उठता हूँ।

main subah jaldee uThtaa hoon. [meh(n) su-beh juhl-dee uTh-tah hoo(n)]

I get up early in the morning.

वह हमेशा देर से आता है।

voh hameshaa der se aataa hai. [voh huh-may-shah dayr say ah-tah heh]

He always arrives late.

शादी अगले महीने है, पंद्रह तारीख को।

shaadee agle maheene hai, pandrah taareekh ko. [shah-dee ug-lay muh-hee-nay heh, pun-druh tah-reekh koh]

The wedding is next month, on the 15th.

हम रोज़ शाम को चाय पीते हैं।

ham roz shaam ko chaay peete hain. [huhm rohz shahm koh chah-ay pee-tay heh(n)]

We drink tea every evening. (lit. we daily evening-at tea drink)

अभी नहीं, बाद में। पाँच मिनट दो!

abhee naheen, baad mein. paanch minaT do! [uh-bhee nuh-hee(n), bahd may(n). pah(n)ch mi-nuT doh]

Not right now — later. Give me five minutes!

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi tells time in Hinglish. The commonest way to ask isn't the textbook question at all — it's टाइम क्या हुआ? (*Taim kyaa huaa?*) [Tah-im kyah hu-ah], "what's the time become?" Days and months flip into English mid-sentence: "*Sunday ko milte hain,*" "*March mein exam hai.*" But the half-hours stay stubbornly Hindi — even in an all-English sentence a Delhiite says "*meeting DeRh baje hai.*" And Sunday is इतवार (*itvaar*) far more often than the schoolbook रविवार (*ravivaar*).

CULTURE

Learn the phrase *Indian Standard Time* with a wink: invitations run soft. A wedding card that says 8 baje means dinner around 10; "paanch minaT" from anyone means fifteen; बस पहुँच रहा हूँ (*bas pahunch rahaa hoon*) [buhs puh-hunch ruh-hah hoo(n)] "just arriving" means the person may not have left home. But don't generalize: the Delhi Metro runs to the second, offices keep real hours, and showing up at an aunty's exactly on time is charmingly foreign. Ask your partner which events in their family run on the clock and which run on IST.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks with your partner:

1. **Clock flash:** your partner shows you random times on their phone clock — at least five, always including 1:30 and 2:30. You answer ... बजे हैं out loud. One DeRh/Dhaaee slip = one extra round.
2. **Week in Hindi:** go through your real week together: सोमवार को काम है, इतवार को छुट्टी है। (*somvaar ko kaam hai, itvaar ko chhuTTee hai.*) [sohm-vahr koh kahm heh, it-vahr koh chhuT-Tee heh] Every day gets a sentence.
3. **Kal detective:** your partner says sentences with कल and परसों in mixed tenses; you call out "past!" or "future!" before translating. Five in a row = chai on them.

CHAPTER 6

Food & Drink, Delhi Style

Nobody goes hungry in Delhi and nobody stops talking about food: breakfast paranthas, office chai at four, chaat on the way home. This chapter feeds you the vocabulary of a Delhi kitchen and a Delhi street corner — and the phrases to order, praise, and ask for water when the mirchi wins.

Meals

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खाना	<i>khaanaa</i> (m)	khah-nah	food; a meal (also the verb “to eat”)
नाश्ता	<i>naashtaa</i> (m)	nahsh-tah	breakfast; a snack
लंच / डिनर	<i>lanch</i> (m) / <i>Dinar</i> (m)	lunch / din-er	lunch / dinner — Delhi uses the English words

Breads — the roTee family

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
रोटी	<i>roTee</i> (f)	roh-Tee	flatbread; also “food/bread” in general
चपाती	<i>chapaatee</i> (f)	chuh-pah-tee	chapati (same thing as roTee at home)
नान	<i>naan</i> (m)	nahn	naan (restaurant bread, from the tandoor)
पराँठा	<i>paraanThaa</i> (m)	puh-rah(n)-Thah	parantha — the Delhi breakfast (aaloo paraanThaa!)

The mains

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
चावल	<i>chaaval</i> (m)	chah-vul	rice
दाल	<i>daal</i> (f)	dahl	lentils, dal
दाल मखनी	<i>daal makhane</i> (f)	dahl mukh-nee	dal makhani — Delhi’s buttery signature dal
सब्ज़ी	<i>sabzee</i> (f)	sub-zee	vegetable(s); any veg dish
पनीर	<i>paneer</i> (m)	puh-neer	paneer (fresh cheese — the veg celebration dish)
छोले	<i>chhole</i> (m pl)	chhoh-lay	spiced chickpeas

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
छोले-भटूरे	<i>chhole-bhaToore</i> (m pl)	chhoh-lay bhuh-Too-ray	chhole with huge fried bread — a Delhi institution
राजमा-चावल	<i>raajmaa-chaaval</i> (m)	rahj-mah chah-vul	kidney-bean curry with rice — Delhi comfort food

Top vegetables

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आलू	<i>aaloo</i> (m)	ah-loo	potato
प्याज़	<i>pyaaz</i> (m)	pyahz	onion
टमाटर	<i>TamaaTar</i> (m)	Tuh-mah-Tur	tomato
गोभी	<i>gobhee</i> (f)	goh-bhee	cauliflower
भिंडी	<i>bhinDee</i> (f)	bhin-Dee	okra
पालक	<i>paalak</i> (m)	pah-luk	spinach (paalak paneer!)
मटर	<i>maTar</i> (m)	muh-Tur	peas (maTar paneer!)

Street food & sweets

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
चाट	<i>chaat</i> (f)	chahT	chaat — tangy-spicy street snacks as a category
गोलगप्पे	<i>golgappe</i> (m pl)	gohl-gup-pay	crisp water-filled puris — the DELHI word (see box)
मोमोज़	<i>momos</i> (m pl)	moh-mohz	momos — Delhi's adopted dumpling obsession
समोसा	<i>samosaa</i> (m)	suh-moh-sah	samosa
जलेबी	<i>jalebee</i> (f)	juh-lay-bee	jalebi (hot syrupy spirals)
मिठाई	<i>miThaaee</i> (f)	mi-Thah-ee	sweets (the whole sweet-shop category)

Drinks & kitchen basics

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
चाय	<i>chaay</i> (f)	chah-ay	tea, chai
कड़क चाय	<i>kaRak chaay</i> (f)	kuh-Ruk chah-ay	strong, punchy chai — the Delhi order

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दूध	<i>doodh</i> (m)	doodh	milk
चीनी	<i>cheenee</i> (f)	chee-nee	sugar
नमक	<i>namak</i> (m)	nuh-muk	salt
मसाला	<i>masaalaa</i> (m)	muh-sah-lah	spice, spice blend
मिर्च	<i>mirch</i> (f)	mirch	chili (haree mirch = green chili)
पानी	<i>paanee</i> (m)	pah-nee	water
लस्सी	<i>lassee</i> (f)	luhs-see	lassi (sweet or salted yogurt drink)

Kitchen verbs & tastes

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खाना	<i>khaanaa</i>	khah-nah	to eat
पीना	<i>peenaa</i>	pee-nah	to drink
बनाना	<i>banaanaa</i>	buh-nah-nah	to make, to cook
चखना	<i>chakhnaa</i>	chukh-nah	to taste, to try (food)
मीठा	<i>meeThaa</i>	mee-Thaih	sweet
नमकीन	<i>namkeen</i>	num-keen	salty, savory (also = salty snacks, the noun)
खट्टा	<i>khaTTaa</i>	khuT-Tah	sour, tangy
तीखा	<i>teekhaa</i>	tee-khah	spicy-hot (the chili kind of hot!)
कड़वा	<i>kaRvaa</i>	kuhR-vah	bitter
मज़ेदार	<i>mazedaar</i>	muh-zay-dahr	delicious, full of flavor (lit. fun-having)

Hungry, thirsty, and at the table

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
भूख लगी है	<i>bhookh lagee hai</i> (bhookh f)	bhookh luh-gee heh	(I'm) hungry — lit. hunger has struck
प्यास लगी है	<i>pyaas lagee hai</i> (pyaas f)	pyahs luh-gee heh	(I'm) thirsty

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मेन्यू	<i>menyoo</i> (m)	men-yoo	menu
बिल	<i>bil</i> (m)	bil	bill, check
एक प्लेट मोमोज़ देना	<i>ek pleT momos denaa</i> (pleT f)	ayk playT moh- mohz day-nah	one plate of momos, please (the all-purpose order shape)

In action

मुझे भूख लगी है। खाना कब बनेगा?

mujhe bhookh lagee hai. khaanaa kab banegaa? [mu-jhay bhookh luh-gee heh. khah-nah kuhb buh-nay-gah]

I'm hungry. When will the food be ready? (lit. to-me hunger struck is)

भैया, एक प्लेट गोलगप्पे देना।

bhaiyaa, ek pleT golgappe denaa. [bheh-yah, ayk playT gohl-gup-pay day-nah]

Bhaiya, one plate of golgappe, please.

यह बहुत तीखा है! पानी दो!

yeh bahut teekhaa hai! paanee do! [yeh bo-hut tee-khah heh! pah-nee doh]

This is really spicy! Give me water!

दाल मखनी बहुत मज़ेदार है।

daal makhane bahut mazedaar hai. [dahl mukh-nee bo-hut muh-zay-dahr heh]

The dal makhani is delicious.

आज डिनर में राजमा-चावल है।

aaj Dinar mein raajmaa-chaaval hai. [ahj din-er may(n) rahj-mah chah-vul heh]

Dinner today is rajma-chawal.

मैं रोज़ नाश्ते में पराँठा खाता हूँ।

main roz naashte mein paraanThaa khaataa hoon. [meh(n) rohz nahsh-tay may(n) puh-rah(n)-Thah khah-tah hoo(n)]

I eat a parantha for breakfast every day.

तुमने मोमोज़ चखे? — हाँ, बहुत अच्छे हैं!

tumne momos chakhe? — haan, bahut achchhe hain! [tum-nay moh-mohz chuh-khay — hah(n), bo-hut uch-chhay heh(n)]

Did you try the momos? — Yes, they're great!

एक कड़क चाय और दो समोसे — बस!

ek kaRak chaay aur do samose — bas! [ayk kuh-Ruk chah-ay awr doh suh-moh-say — buhs]

One strong chai and two samosas — that's all!

भैया, बिल देना।

bhaiyaa, bil denaa. [bheh-yah, bil day-nah]

Bhaiya, the bill please.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Street ordering has a rhythm: catch the vendor's eye, call him भैया (*bhaiyaa*), name the quantity, then soften the command with *denaa/banaa do*: भैया, एक प्लेट चाट बना दो, तीखा कम। (*bhaiyaa, ek pleT chaaT banaa do, teekhaa kam.*) [bheh-yah, ayk playT chahT buh-nah doh, tee-khah kum] — “make me a plate of chaat, easy on the spice.” No please needed; *bhaiyaa* IS the please. And the puri filled with spicy water is गोलगप्पा (*golgappaa*) in Delhi — say *panipuri* and you've outed yourself as Mumbai, *puchka* as Kolkata. In Delhi: *golgappe*, always.

CULTURE

Food is how Indian homes say I-love-you, so the second helping is not a question — it's a landing. और लो न! (*aur lo na!*) [awr loh nah] “take more!” will come at you before your plate is empty. A flat “no” reads as rejection; the graceful moves are बस, थोड़ा-सा (*bas, thoRaa-saa*) [buhs, thoh-Rah sah] “just a little,” or the veteran's trick: eat slowly and never fully finish the plate until you truly surrender with बस, पेट भर गया! (*bas, peT bhar gayaa!*) [buhs, payT bhur guh-yah] “enough, my stomach is full!”

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks with your partner:

1. **Dinner narration:** whoever cooks tonight, name everything on the table in Hindi — यह दाल है, यह चावल है, यह सब्ज़ी है। Then each of you rates it: मीठा? तीखा? मज़ेदार!
2. **The order rehearsal:** your partner plays a chaat vendor. Order for both of you using the pattern भैया, एक प्लेट ___ देना — three rounds: golgappe, momos, samose. They heckle like a real vendor; you keep your cool and add तीखा कम.
3. **Taste-test quiz:** partner names five real foods you both eat (pizza, achar, jalebi...); for each one you shout the right taste word — खट्टा! मीठा! नमकीन! Disagreements settled by actually eating some.

CHAPTER 7

Around the Home

A Delhi home has its own weather system: the cooler roaring in June, the geyser groaning awake in December, and above everything the छत (*chhat*) [chhut] — the rooftop where half of family life happens. This chapter walks you room by room through the house, hands you the bartan, and teaches you the two-word sentence every Delhiite knows by heart: बिजली गई!

(*bijlee gae!*) [bij-lee guh-ee]

House & rooms

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
घर	<i>ghar</i> (m)	ghur	home; house (the warm word)
मकान	<i>makaan</i> (m)	muh-kahn	house (the building itself)
फ्लैट	<i>flaiT</i> (m)	flehT	flat, apartment
कमरा	<i>kamraa</i> (m)	kum-rah	room
रसोई	<i>rasoee</i> (f)	ruh-soh-ee	kitchen (Delhi mostly says किचन kichan [ki-chun])
बाथरूम	<i>baathroom</i> (m)	bahth-room	bathroom — the word Delhi actually uses
गुसलखाना	<i>gusalkhaanaa</i> (m)	gu-sul-khah-nah	bathroom (older Urdu-flavored word; know it, hear it)
बेडरूम	<i>beDroom</i> (m)	beD-room	bedroom
बालकनी	<i>baalkanee</i> (f)	bahl-kuh-nee	balcony
छज्जा	<i>chhajjaa</i> (m)	chhuj-jah	ledge / small overhang balcony
छत	<i>chhat</i> (f)	chhut	roof, rooftop (see culture box!)
सीढ़ियाँ	<i>seeRhiyaan</i> (f pl)	see-Rhi-yah(n)	stairs

Furniture

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मेज़	<i>mez</i> (f)	mayz	table
कुर्सी	<i>kursee</i> (f)	kur-see	chair
पलंग	<i>palang</i> (m)	puh-lung	bed (everyday English: बेड beD)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सोफ़ा	<i>sofaa</i> (m)	soh-fah	sofa
अलमारी	<i>almaaree</i> (f)	ul-mah-ree	cupboard, wardrobe

Around the house

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दरवाज़ा	<i>darvaazaa</i> (m)	dur-vah-zah	door
खिड़की	<i>khiRkee</i> (f)	khiR-kee	window
पंखा	<i>pankhaa</i> (m)	pun-khah	ceiling fan
एसी	<i>esee</i> (m)	ay-see	AC, air conditioner
कूलर	<i>koolar</i> (m)	koo-lur	(desert) cooler — the sound of Delhi summer
गीज़र	<i>geezar</i> (m)	gee-zur	geyser, water heater — the hero of Delhi winter
फ्रिज	<i>frij</i> (m)	frij	fridge
टीवी	<i>Teevee</i> (m)	Tee-vee	TV
ताला	<i>taalaa</i> (m)	tah-lah	lock
चाबी	<i>chaabee</i> (f)	chah-bee	key

Bartan — the dishes

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
बर्तन	<i>bartan</i> (m)	bur-tun	dishes, pots and pans (bartan dhonaa = do the dishes)
प्लेट	<i>pleT</i> (f)	playT	plate
गिलास	<i>gilaas</i> (m)	gi-lahs	drinking glass, tumbler
चम्मच	<i>chammach</i> (m)	chum-much	spoon
कटोरी	<i>kaToree</i> (f)	kuh-Toh-ree	small bowl (for daal, sabzee)
थाली	<i>thaalee</i> (f)	thah-lee	big round platter — the whole Indian dinner plate

Bedroom & bathroom small things

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
तकिया	<i>takiyaa</i> (m)	tuh-ki-yah	pillow
कंबल	<i>kambal</i> (m)	kum-bul	blanket
चादर	<i>chaadar</i> (f)	chah-dur	bedsheet
तौलिया	<i>tauliyaa</i> (m)	taw-li-yah	towel
साबुन	<i>saabun</i> (m)	sah-bun	soap
बाल्टी	<i>baalTee</i> (f)	bahl-Tee	bucket (bucket baths are a real institution)

Chores & the utilities

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
साफ़ करना	<i>saaf karnaa</i>	sahf kuhr-nah	to clean
झाड़ू	<i>jhaaRoo</i> (f)	jhah-Roo	broom; झाड़ू लगाना <i>jhaaRoo lagaanaa</i> = to sweep
पोछा	<i>pochhaa</i> (m)	poh-chhah	mop(ping); पोछा लगाना <i>pochhaa lagaanaa</i> = to mop
कपड़े धोना	<i>kapRe dhonaa</i>	kup-Ray dhoh-nah	to wash clothes
खाना बनाना	<i>khaanaa banaanaa</i>	khah-nah buh-nah-nah	to cook (lit. make food)
बिजली	<i>bijlee</i> (f)	bij-lee	electricity, power
बिजली गई!	<i>bijlee gae!</i>	bij-lee guh-ee	the power's gone! (bijlee aa gae = it's back)
पानी आया	<i>paanee aayaa</i> (paanee m)	pah-nee ah-yah	the water (supply) is on — tank-filling hour!
काम वाली	<i>kaam vaalee</i> (f)	kahm vah-lee	domestic helper (m: kaam vaalaa) — see note

In action

हमारा फ़्लैट छोटा है, लेकिन बालकनी बड़ी है।

hamaaraa flaiT chhoTaa hai, lekin baalkanee baRee hai. [huh-mah-rah flehT chhoh-Tah heh, lay-kin bahl-kuh-nee buh-Ree heh]

Our flat is small, but the balcony is big.

अरे, बिजली गई! पंखा बंद है।

arre, bijlee gaee! pankhaa band hai. [uh-ray, bij-lee guh-ee! pun-khah bund heh]

Oh no, the power's gone! The fan is off. (band = closed/off)

एसी चला दो, बहुत गर्मी है।

esee chalaa do, bahut garmee hai. [ay-see chuh-lah doh, bo-hut gur-mee heh]

Turn on the AC, it's really hot. (garmee = heat)

चाबी कहाँ है? दरवाज़े पर ताला है।

chaabee kahaan hai? darvaaze par taalaa hai. [chah-bee kuh-hah(n) heh? dur-vah-zay pur tah-lah heh]

Where's the key? There's a lock on the door.

मैं बर्तन धोता हूँ, तुम झाड़ू लगाओ।

main bartan dhotaa hoon, tum jhaaRoo lagaao. [meh(n) bur-tun dhoh-tah hoo(n), tum jhah-Roo luh-gah-oh]

I'll do the dishes, you sweep.

फ्रिज में दूध है क्या?

frij mein doodh hai kyaa? [frij may(n) doodh heh kyah]

Is there milk in the fridge? (kyaa at the end = casual question tag)

शाम को हम छत पर चाय पीते हैं।

shaam ko ham chhat par chaay peete hain. [shahm koh huhm chhut pur chah-ay pee-tay heh(n)]

In the evening we drink chai up on the roof.

सर्दी में गीज़र चलाओ, फिर नहाओ!

sardee mein geezar chalaa, phir nahaa! [sur-dee may(n) gee-zur chuh-lah-oh, phir nuh-hah-oh]

In winter, turn on the geyser first, then bathe! (sardee = the cold season)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi homes gear up by season. Summer belongs to the कूलर (*koolar*) — a rumbling water-cooled box in the window that smells of wet khas grass — until the humid weeks when only the ऐसी (*esee*) will do. Winter mornings start with a shout of गीज़र चला दो! (*geezar chala do!*) [gee-zur chuh-lah doh] because nobody bathes till the water's hot. And when the power cuts, the backup battery hums on — the इन्वर्टर (*invarTar*) [in-vur-Tur]. Room names run in English — kitchen, bathroom, bedroom — but the things inside stay Hindi: bartan, jhaaRoo, baalTee, chaabee.

CULTURE

The छत (*chhat*) is Delhi's open-air living room. Winter Sundays mean sitting on the roof in the sun shelling peanuts; August 15 means kite battles shouted from rooftop to rooftop; summer nights once meant whole families sleeping upstairs on rope cots. People dry chilies and papads there, hang laundry there, fall in love across parapets there — Bollywood has a whole genre of chhat scenes. If your partner's family home has a chhat, ask to be taken up at sunset; it's the best view of the neighborhood's life.

NOTE

Many Delhi households, including modest ones, have daily help — a काम वाली (*kaam vaalee*) who comes to cook, sweep, or wash dishes. This is ordinary middle-class life, not extravagance. The etiquette to copy from your partner: address her respectfully (often *deedee* or *aunty*, never a bare “hey”), offer chai, and use polite verb forms. How a family speaks to its kaam vaalee tells you everything about the family.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks with your partner:

1. **House tour:** walk through your home together; you name every room and five objects in each — यह किचन है। यह फ्रिज है। Partner adds one word per room you didn't know.
2. **Chore split, in Hindi only:** negotiate tonight's chores with the pattern मैं ____, तुम ____ — *main bartan dhootaa hoon, tum khaanaa banaao*. No English allowed until the deal is struck.
3. **Bijlee gae drill:** partner suddenly announces बिजली गई! at random moments this week; you must respond correctly — light a phone torch and list what stopped working: पंखा बंद, ऐसी बंद, टीवी बंद!

CHAPTER 8

Body & Health

Nothing gets you looked after in a Delhi household faster than the sentence मेरी तबियत ठीक नहीं है (*meree tabiyat Theek naheen hai*) [may-ree tuh-bi-yut Theek nuh-hee(n) heh] — "I'm not feeling well." Within minutes someone will be making you turmeric milk and phoning a doctor-uncle. This chapter gives you the body from head to toe, the words for everyday ailments, and the patterns Hindi actually uses for them — because in Hindi you don't *have* a fever, a fever *is to you*.

The body, head to toe

Head & face

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सिर	<i>sir</i> (m)	sir	head
बाल	<i>baal</i> (m)	bahl	hair (usually plural: बाल)
चेहरा	<i>chehraa</i> (m)	cheh-rah	face
आँख	<i>aankh</i> (f)	ah(n)kh	eye
कान	<i>kaan</i> (m)	kahn	ear
नाक	<i>naak</i> (f)	nahk	nose
मुँह	<i>munh</i> (m)	mu(n)h	mouth; face (informal)
दाँत	<i>daant</i> (m)	dah(n)t	tooth
होंठ	<i>honTh</i> (m)	hoh(n)Th	lip
जीभ	<i>jeebh</i> (f)	jeebh	tongue
गला	<i>galaa</i> (m)	guh-lah	throat
गर्दन	<i>gardan</i> (f)	gur-dun	neck

Torso, arms & legs

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
शरीर	<i>shareer</i> (m)	shuh-reer	body

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कंधा	<i>kandhaa</i> (m)	kun-dhah	shoulder
हाथ	<i>haath</i> (m)	hahth	hand
उँगली	<i>ungalee</i> (f)	ung-lee	finger
अँगूठा	<i>angooThaa</i> (m)	un-goo-Thah	thumb
दिल	<i>dil</i> (m)	dil	heart
पेट	<i>peT</i> (m)	payT	stomach, belly
पीठ	<i>peeTh</i> (f)	peeTh	back
कमर	<i>kamar</i> (f)	kuh-mur	waist, lower back
टाँग	<i>Taang</i> (f)	Tah(n)g	leg
घुटना	<i>ghuTnaa</i> (m)	ghuT-nah	knee
पैर	<i>pair</i> (m)	pehr	foot (often leg too)
हड्डी	<i>haDDee</i> (f)	huD-Dee	bone
खून	<i>khoon</i> (m)	khoon	blood

WATCH OUT

Body-part genders are a minefield, and agreement exposes you instantly. Learn these cold: आँख (*aankh*) [ah(n)kh] and नाक (*naak*) [nahk] are **feminine**; कान (*kaan*) [kahn], मुँह (*munh*) [mu(n)h], हाथ (*haath*) [hahth] and पैर (*pair*) [pehr] are **masculine**; टाँग (*Taang*) [Tah(n)g] and पीठ (*peeTh*) [peeTh] are **feminine**. So: मेरी आँखें (*meree aankhen*) [may-ree ah(n)-khay(n)] but मेरे कान (*mere kaan*) [may-ray kahn].

Feeling unwell

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
तबियत	<i>tabiyat</i> (f)	tuh-bi-yut	health, condition (how you feel)
बुखार	<i>bukhaar</i> (m)	bu-khahr	fever
जुकाम	<i>zukaam</i> (m)	zu-kahm	a cold, the sniffles
खाँसी	<i>khaansee</i> (f)	khah(n)-see	cough

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दर्द	<i>dard</i> (m)	durd	pain, ache
चक्कर	<i>chakkar</i> (m)	chuk-kur	dizziness, dizzy spell
चोट	<i>choT</i> (f)	chohT	injury, hurt
उल्टी	<i>ulTee</i> (f)	ul-Tee	vomiting
ठंड	<i>ThanD</i> (f)	ThunD	cold, chill
कमज़ोर	<i>kamzor</i>	kum-zohr	weak
ख़राब	<i>kharaab</i>	khuh-rahb	bad, "off" (throat, stomach, health)

How Hindi says "I'm sick" — the ko-patterns

Almost every ailment uses the *mujhe ... hai* pattern from Unit 10: the sickness happens to you. Learn these as ready-made chunks.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सिर में दर्द	<i>sir mein dard</i>	sir may(n) durd	headache (lit. pain in the head)
पेट दर्द	<i>peT dard</i> (m)	payT durd	stomachache
गला ख़राब होना	<i>galaa kharaab honaa</i>	guh-lah khuh-rahb hoh-nah	to have a sore throat
बुखार होना	<i>bukhaar honaa</i>	bu-khahr hoh-nah	to have a fever (मुझे बुखार है)
ठंड लगना	<i>ThanD lagnaa</i>	ThunD lug-nah	to feel cold; to catch a chill
चक्कर आना	<i>chakkar aanaa</i>	chuk-kur ah-nah	to feel dizzy
चोट लगना	<i>choT lagnaa</i>	chohT lug-nah	to get hurt
उल्टी होना	<i>ulTee honaa</i>	ul-Tee hoh-nah	to vomit, to feel like vomiting
आराम करना	<i>aaraam karnaa</i>	ah-rahm kur-nah	to rest
ठीक हो जाना	<i>Theek ho jaanaa</i>	Theek hoh jah-nah	to get better, recover
दवाई लेना	<i>davaaee lenaa</i>	duh-vah-ee lay-nah	to take medicine

Doctor, medicine, emergency

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
डॉक्टर	<i>DaukTar</i> (m)	Dawk-Tūr	doctor
नर्स	<i>nars</i> (f)	nurs	nurse
मरीज़	<i>mareez</i> (m)	muh-reez	patient
दवाई	<i>davaaee</i> (f)	duh-vah-ee	medicine
गोली	<i>golee</i> (f)	goh-lee	pill, tablet
अस्पताल	<i>aspataal</i> (m)	us-puh-tahl	hospital
केमिस्ट	<i>kemisT</i> (m)	kay-misT	pharmacy; pharmacist (the Delhi word)
इलाज	<i>ilaaj</i> (m)	i-lahj	treatment, cure
आराम	<i>aaraam</i> (m)	ah-rahm	rest; relief
इमरजेंसी	<i>imarjensee</i> (f)	i-mur-jayn-see	emergency
एम्बुलेंस	<i>embulens</i> (f)	aym-bu-layns	ambulance
मदद	<i>madad</i> (f)	muh-dud	help

NOTE

In an emergency, मदद कीजिए! (*madad keejiye!*) [muh-dud kee-ji-yay] is "please help!" to a stranger, and the raw shout is बचाओ! (*bachaao!*) [buh-chah-oh] "save (me)!" 112 is the all-India emergency number (Delhi also uses 102/108 for ambulances). For "call an ambulance, quickly": जल्दी एम्बुलेंस बुलाओ! (*jaldee embulens bulaaao!*) [jul-dee aym-bu-layns bu-lah-oh].

In sentences

मेरे सिर में दर्द है।

mere sir mein dard hai. [may-ray sir may(n) durd heh]

I have a headache. (lit. in my head pain is)

आज मेरी तबियत ठीक नहीं है।

aaaj meree tabiyat Theek naheen hai. [ahj may-ree tuh-bi-yut Theek nuh-hee(n) heh]

I'm not feeling well today.

मुझे बुखार है और गला भी खराब है।

mujhe bukhaar hai aur galaa bhee kharaab hai. [mu-jhay bu-khahr heh awr guh-lah bhee khuh-rahb heh]

I have a fever and a sore throat too. (lit. to-me fever is and throat also bad is)

कल रात मुझे ठंड लग गई।

kal raat mujhe ThanD lag gae. [kul raht mu-jhay ThunD lug guh-ee]

Last night I caught a chill.

मुझे चक्कर आ रहे हैं।

mujhe chakkar aa rahe hain. [mu-jhay chuk-kur ah ruh-hay heh(n)]

I'm feeling dizzy. (lit. to-me dizzy-spells are coming)

डॉक्टर ने कहा, आराम करो और दवाई टाइम पर लो।

DaukTar ne kahaa, aaraam karo aur davaaee Taim par lo. [Dawk-Tur nay kuh-hah, ah-rahm kuh-roh awr duh-vah-ee Tah-im pur loh]

The doctor said: rest, and take your medicine on time.

पेट दर्द के लिए कौन-सी गोली अच्छी है?

peT dard ke liye kaun-see golee achchhee hai? [payT durd kay li-yay kawn-see goh-lee uch-chhee heh]

Which tablet is good for a stomachache?

सबसे पास वाला केमिस्ट कहाँ है?

sabse paas vaalaa kemisT kahaan hai? [sub-say pahs vah-lah kay-misT kuh-hah(n) heh]

Where is the nearest chemist?

चिंता मत करो, तुम जल्दी ठीक हो जाओगे।

chintaa mat karo, tum jaldee Theek ho jaaoge. [chin-tah mut kuh-roh, tum jul-dee Theek hoh jah-oh-gay]

Don't worry, you'll get better soon.

मेरी आँखें लाल हैं और नाक बंद है।

meree aankhen laal hain aur naak band hai. [may-ree ah(n)-khay(n) lahl heh(n) awr nahk bund heh]

My eyes are red and my nose is blocked.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhiites go to the केमिस्ट (*kemisT*) [kay-misT] or the "medical store" — nobody says "pharmacy." And everyday health talk is heavily Hinglish: you'll hear यार, मुझे कल से फीवर है (*yaar, mujhe kal se feevar hai*) [yahr, mu-jhay kul say fee-vur heh] as often as *bukhaar*, plus "BP", "sugar" (diabetes), and "loose motion" — the polite English cover for दस्त (*dast* (m)) [dust], diarrhea. A checkup is a चेकअप (*chekap*) [chayk-up]. Delhi shorthand you'll love: सिर दर्द (*sir dard*) [sir durd] also means "a hassle" — ये ट्रैफिक बड़ा सिर दर्द है। (*ye Traifik baRaa sir dard hai.*) [yay Treh-fik buh-Rah sir durd heh] "This traffic is a big headache."

CULTURE

Before any doctor is consulted, home remedies — घरेलू नुस्खे (*ghareloo nuskhe*) [ghuh-ray-loo nus-khay] — will be deployed. The undisputed king is हल्दी वाला दूध (*haldee vaalaa doodh*) [hul-dee vah-lah doodh], hot turmeric milk, for everything from colds to bruises. Expect ginger chai (अदरक वाली चाय, *adrak vaalee chaay*) [ud-ruk vah-lee chah-ay] for a sore throat, and in winter a bitter herbal brew called काढ़ा (*kaaRhah*) [kah-Rhah]. Drink whatever your mother-in-law hands you — it is love in liquid form, and refusing it is worse for your health than the fever.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks for this week:

1. **Point and name.** Your partner points at ten body parts in random order; you name each in Hindi with the right gender: यह मेरा हाथ है, यह मेरी नाक है... (*yeh meraa haath hai, yeh meree naak hai...*) [yeh may-rah hahth heh, yeh may-ree nahk heh]. Swap roles.
2. **Doctor-doctor.** Your partner is the doctor and asks क्या हुआ? कहाँ दर्द है? (*kyaa huaa? kahaan dard hai?*) [kyah hu-ah? kuh-hah(n) durd heh]. Invent three ailments using *mujhe ... hai* and *... mein dard hai*; the doctor prescribes rest, pills, or chai.
3. **Remedy hunt.** Ask your partner: तुम्हारे घर में बुखार का इलाज क्या है? (*tumhaare ghar mein bukhaar kaa ilaaj kyaa hai?*) [tum-hah-ray ghur may(n) bu-khahr kah i-lahj kyah heh] Learn the family remedy's name in Hindi and write it down here.

CHAPTER 9

Clothing & Colors

Delhi dresses in everything at once: office wear on the Metro, a grandmother's cotton साड़ी (*saaRee*) [sah-Ree], ripped jeans in Hauz Khas, and in January a whole city wrapped in shawls. This chapter gives you clothes, the wear/take-off/change verbs, fit words for shopping, and every major color — with the agreement rules that tell you why a yellow shirt is *peelee* but a red one stays *laal*.

Clothes

Everyday & traditional wear

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कपड़े	<i>kapRe</i> (m pl)	kup-Ray	clothes (कपड़ा <i>kapRaa</i> = cloth, garment)
कुर्ता	<i>kurtaa</i> (m)	kur-tah	kurta (long loose shirt)
पजामा	<i>pajaamaa</i> (m)	puh-jah-mah	pajama (drawstring trousers)
कुर्ता-पजामा	<i>kurtaa-pajaamaa</i> (m)	kur-tah-puh-jah-mah	kurta-pajama set (men)
कमीज़	<i>kameez</i> (f)	kuh-meez	shirt, tunic
सलवार	<i>salvaar</i> (f)	sul-vahr	salwar (loose pleated trousers)
सलवार-कमीज़	<i>salvaar-kameez</i> (f)	sul-vahr-kuh-meez	salwar-kameez set (women)
साड़ी	<i>saaRee</i> (f)	sah-Ree	sari
दुपट्टा	<i>dupaTTaa</i> (m)	du-puT-Tah	dupatta (long scarf)
लहंगा	<i>lahangaa</i> (m)	luh-hun-gah	lehenga (long festive skirt)
शर्ट	<i>sharT</i> (f)	shurT	shirt (Western)
टी-शर्ट	<i>Tee-sharT</i> (f)	Tee-shurT	T-shirt
पैंट	<i>painT</i> (f)	pehnT	trousers, pants
जीन्स	<i>jeens</i> (f)	jeens	jeans

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जैकेट	<i>jaikeT</i> (f)	jeh-kayT	jacket
स्वेटर	<i>sveTar</i> (m)	svay-Tur	sweater
कोट	<i>koT</i> (m)	kohT	coat
शॉल	<i>shaul</i> (f)	shawl	shawl

Feet, head & the rest

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जूते	<i>jootē</i> (m pl)	joo-tay	shoes (जूता jootaa = one shoe)
चप्पल	<i>chappal</i> (f)	chup-pul	chappals, flip-flops, slippers
मोज़े	<i>moze</i> (m pl)	moh-zay	socks (मोज़ा mozaa = one sock)
टोपी	<i>Topee</i> (f)	Toh-pee	cap, hat
चश्मा	<i>chashmaa</i> (m)	chush-mah	glasses, spectacles
घड़ी	<i>ghaRee</i> (f)	ghuh-Ree	watch; clock
बेल्ट	<i>belT</i> (f)	bayIT	belt
जेब	<i>jeb</i> (f)	jayb	pocket
चूड़ी	<i>chooRee</i> (f)	choo-Ree	bangle

Wearing, removing, changing

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पहनना	<i>pehennaa</i> (vt)	peh-hen-nah	to wear, put on
उतारना	<i>utaarnaa</i> (vt)	u-tahr-nah	to take off
बदलना	<i>badalnaa</i> (vt)	buh-dul-nah	to change (clothes)
धोना	<i>dhonaa</i> (vt)	dhoh-nah	to wash
पहन लो	<i>pehen lo</i>	peh-hen loh	put (it) on (friendly command)

Fit & condition

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ढीला	<i>Dheelaa</i>	Dhee-lah	loose
टाइट	<i>TaaiT</i>	Tah-iT	tight
छोटा	<i>chhoTaa</i>	chhoh-Tah	small, too small
बड़ा	<i>baRaa</i>	buh-Rah	big, too big
फ़िट	<i>fiT</i>	fiT	a good fit (यह फ़िट है = it fits)
साइज़	<i>saaiz (m)</i>	sah-iz	size
साफ़	<i>saaf</i>	sahf	clean
गंदा	<i>gandaa</i>	gun-dah	dirty
नया	<i>nayaa</i>	nuh-yah	new
पुराना	<i>puraanaa</i>	pu-rah-nah	old (of things)

Colors — रंग (rang)

रंग (*rang (m)*) [rung] means color. Colors are adjectives, so the Unit 6 rule applies: colors ending in *-aa* agree with the noun; all the others never change.

Colors that agree (-aa type)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पीला / पीली / पीले	<i>peelaa / peelee / peelee</i>	pee-lah / pee-lee / pee-lay	yellow
नीला	<i>neelaa</i>	nee-lah	blue
हरा	<i>haraa</i>	huh-rah	green
काला	<i>kaalaa</i>	kah-lah	black
भूरा	<i>bhooraa</i>	bhoo-rah	brown
सुनहरा	<i>sunahraa</i>	su-neh-rah	golden

Colors that never change

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लाल	<i>laal</i>	lahl	red
सफ़ेद	<i>safed</i>	suh-fayd	white
गुलाबी	<i>gulaabee</i>	gu-lah-bee	pink
नारंगी	<i>naarangee</i>	nah-run-gee	orange
बैंगनी	<i>baingnee</i>	beh(n)g-nee	purple
ग्रे	<i>gre</i>	gray	grey (the everyday Delhi word)

WATCH OUT

Only -aa colors change: पीला कुर्ता (*peelaa kurtaa*) [pee-lah kur-tah], पीली कमीज़ (*peelee kameez*) [pee-lee kuh-meez], पीले जूते (*peelee joote*) [pee-lay joo-tay]. But *laal*, *safed*, *gulaabee*, *naarangee*, *baingnee* are frozen: लाल साड़ी (*laal saaRee*) [lahl sah-Ree], never "लाली साड़ी". English speakers over-correct and inflect everything — resist! And remember कमीज़ (*kameez*), पैंट (*painT*) and जीन्स (*jeens*) are feminine, while कुर्ता (*kurtaa*) and स्वेटर (*sveTar*) are masculine.

In sentences

आज मैं कुर्ता-पजामा पहन रहा हूँ।

aaj main kurtaa-pajaamaa pehen rahaa hoon. [ahj meh(n) kur-tah-puh-jah-mah peh-hen ruh-hah hoo(n)]

Today I'm wearing a kurta-pajama.

यह कमीज़ थोड़ी टाइट है, बड़ा साइज़ दिखाइए।

yeh kameez thoRee TaaiT hai, baRaa saaiz dikhaaiye. [yeh kuh-meez thoh-Ree Tah-iT heh, buh-Rah sah-iz di-khah-i-yeh]

This shirt is a bit tight — please show me a bigger size.

मुझे पीला रंग पसंद है, लेकिन पीली पैंट? कभी नहीं!

mujhe peelaa rang pasand hai, lekin peelee painT? kabhee naheen! [mu-jhay pee-lah rung puh-sund heh, lay-kin pee-lee pehnT? kuh-bhee nuh-hee(n)]

I like the color yellow — but yellow pants? Never!

यह नीली कमीज़ तुम पर अच्छी लग रही है।

yeh neelee kameez tum par achchhee lag rahee hai. [yeh nee-lee kuh-meez tum pur uch-chhee lug ruh-hee heh]

This blue shirt looks good on you. (lit. on you is seeming good)

बाहर ठंड है, स्वेटर पहन लो।

baahar ThanD hai, sveTar pehen lo. [bah-hur ThunD heh, svay-Tur peh-hen loh]

It's cold outside — put on a sweater.

जैकेट उतारो और आराम से बैठो।

jaikeT utaaro aur aaraam se baiTho. [jeh-kayT u-tah-roh awr ah-rahm say beh-Thoh]

Take off your jacket and sit comfortably.

तुम्हारे जूते बहुत गंदे हैं, बाहर उतारो।

tumhaare joote bahut gande hain, baahar utaaro. [tum-hah-ray joo-tay bo-hut gun-day heh(n), bah-hur u-tah-roh]

Your shoes are really dirty — take them off outside.

घर आकर कपड़े बदलो।

ghar aakar kapRe badlo. [ghur ah-kur kup-Ray bud-loh]

Change your clothes when you get home.

मेरा चश्मा और घड़ी कहाँ हैं?

meraa chashmaa aur ghaRee kahaan hain? [may-rah chush-mah awr ghuh-Ree kuh-hah(n) heh(n)]

Where are my glasses and watch?

शादी में वह सुनहरा लहंगा पहन रही है।

shaadee mein voh sunahraa lahanga pehen rahee hai. [shah-dee may(n) voh su-neh-rah luh-hun-gah peh-hen ruh-hee heh]

At the wedding she's wearing a golden lehenga.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi सर्दी (*sardee*) [sur-dee] is no joke — January mornings hit 5°C in a city built for 45°C. The whole city layers up: an "inner" (thermal) under the shirt, then a *sveTar*, then a *jaikeT*, plus a मफ़लर (*maflar*) [muf-lur] — a muffler wound around head and ears, Delhi's most beloved winter accessory — and for grandparents a heavy *shaul*. Shopkeepers will urge all of this on you in one breath: भैया, ठंड बहुत है, स्वेटर के ऊपर जैकेट पहनो। (*bhaiyaa, ThanD bahut hai, sveTar ke oopar jaikeT pehno.*) [bheh-yah, ThunD bo-hut heh, svay-Tur kay oo-pur jeh-kayT peh-noh] "Brother, it's really cold — wear a jacket over the sweater."

CULTURE

Shoes come off at the door of most Delhi homes — look for the pile of *chappal* and follow suit; barefoot or socks indoors is normal, and shoes always come off at temples and gurdwaras. New clothes matter: on Diwali the whole family wears something new, and for weddings people invest seriously — men in kurta-pajama or sherwani, women in *saaRee*, *salvaar-kameez* or *lahangaa*. If your in-laws gift you clothes, wear them at the next family occasion; it will be noticed, warmly.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks for this week:

1. **Closet tour.** Pick eight items from your closet and present each with color + item, agreement correct: यह मेरी नीली जीन्स है। यह मेरा काला स्वेटर है। (*yeh meree neelee jeans hai. yeh meraa kaalaa sveTar hai.*) [yeh may-ree nee-lee jeans heh. yeh may-rah kah-lah svay-Tur heh] Partner checks every ending.
2. **What are you wearing?** Over the phone or from another room, ask each other तुम क्या पहन रहे हो? (*tum kyaa pehen rahe ho?*) [tum kyah peh-hen ruh-hay hoh] and describe your outfit in full, colors included.
3. **Compliment game.** Give each other three compliments with the pattern तुम पर ____ अच्छा लग रहा है। (*tum par ____ achchhaa lag rahaa hai.*) [tum pur ____ uch-chhah lug ruh-hah heh] — adjusting *achchhaa/achchhee* to the item, of course.

CHAPTER 10

City & Transport — Getting Around Delhi

Delhi is a city of twenty million people and, on bad days, apparently twenty million vehicles. Mercifully it also has one of the world's great metro systems. This chapter equips you for all of it: the Metro, autos and app-cabs, asking directions in a गली (*galee*) [guh-lee], and the everyday places you'll be going. Master *seedhe* – *daayen* – *baayen* and the city opens up.

The Delhi Metro

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मेट्रो	<i>meTro</i> (f)	may-Troh	the Metro
स्टेशन	<i>sTeshan</i> (m)	sTay-shun	station
लाइन	<i>laain</i> (f)	lah-in	line
येलो लाइन	<i>yelo laain</i> (f)	yay-loh lah-in	Yellow Line (Delhi's north-south spine)
ब्लू लाइन	<i>bloo laain</i> (f)	bloo lah-in	Blue Line
ट्रेन	<i>Tren</i> (f)	Trayn	train
टोकन	<i>Tokan</i> (m)	Toh-kun	token (single-ride)
कार्ड	<i>kaarD</i> (m)	kahrD	(metro) card
गेट	<i>geT</i> (m)	gayT	gate (गेट नंबर 2 = gate no. 2)
भीड़	<i>bheeR</i> (f)	bheeR	crowd
किराया	<i>kiraayaa</i> (m)	ki-rah-yah	fare

On the road

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ऑटो	<i>auTo</i> (m)	aw-Toh	auto-rickshaw (the green-and-yellow one)
रिक्शा	<i>rikshaa</i> (m)	rik-shah	(cycle) rickshaw
टैक्सी	<i>Taiksee</i> (f)	Tehk-see	taxi
कैब	<i>kaib</i> (f)	kehb	cab (app-based)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ओला / ऊबर	<i>olaa / oobar</i>	oh-lah / oo-bur	Ola / Uber (how Delhi actually books cabs)
बस	<i>bas</i> (f)	bus	bus
डीटीसी बस	<i>DeeTeesee bas</i> (f)	Dee-Tee-see bus	DTC (Delhi's public buses)
गाड़ी	<i>gaaRee</i> (f)	gah-Ree	car; vehicle (Delhi's all-purpose word)
साइकिल	<i>saaikil</i> (f)	sah-i-kil	bicycle
सड़क	<i>saRak</i> (f)	suh-Ruk	road
गली	<i>galee</i> (f)	guh-lee	lane, alley
चौक	<i>chauk</i> (m)	chawk	square, chowk
चौराहा	<i>chauraahaa</i> (m)	chaw-rah-hah	intersection, crossroads
फ्लाईओवर	<i>flaaeeovar</i> (m)	flah-ee-oh-vur	flyover (overpass)
सिग्नल	<i>signal</i> (m)	sig-nul	traffic signal
लाल बत्ती	<i>laal battee</i> (f)	lahl but-tee	red light
जाम	<i>jaam</i> (m)	jahm	traffic jam (जाम लगा है = it's jammed)
हॉर्न	<i>haurn</i> (m)	hawrn	horn (you will hear many)

Directions

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सीधा / सीधे	<i>seedhaa / seedhe</i>	see-dhah / see-dhay	straight / straight ahead (सीधे जाओ)
दाएँ	<i>daayen</i>	dah-yay(n)	right (to the right)
बाएँ	<i>baayen</i>	bah-yay(n)	left (to the left)
आगे	<i>aage</i>	ah-gay	ahead, further on
पीछे	<i>peechhe</i>	pee-chhay	behind, back
सामने	<i>saamne</i>	sahm-nay	opposite, in front (के सामने)
पास	<i>paas</i>	pahs	near (के पास)
दूर	<i>door</i>	door	far

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
यू-टर्न	<i>yoo-Tarn</i> (m)	yoo-Turn	U-turn (यू-टर्न लो = take a U-turn)

Places around town

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जगह	<i>jagah</i> (f)	juh-gah	place
बाज़ार	<i>baazaar</i> (m)	bah-zahr	market, bazaar
दुकान	<i>dukaan</i> (f)	du-kahn	shop
मॉल	<i>maul</i> (m)	mawl	mall
पार्क	<i>paark</i> (m)	pahrk	park
मंदिर	<i>mandir</i> (m)	mun-dir	temple
मस्जिद	<i>masjid</i> (f)	mus-jid	mosque
गुरुद्वारा	<i>gurudvaaraa</i> (m)	gu-rud-vah-rah	gurdwara (Sikh temple)
गिरजाघर	<i>girjaaghar</i> (m)	gir-jah-ghur	church (Delhi also says चर्च charch [church])
स्कूल	<i>skool</i> (m)	skool	school
ऑफिस	<i>aufis</i> (m)	aw-fis	office
अस्पताल	<i>aspataal</i> (m)	us-puh-tahl	hospital
थाना	<i>thaanaa</i> (m)	thah-nah	police station
पुलिस	<i>pulis</i> (f)	pu-lis	police

Getting-around verbs

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जाना	<i>jaanaa</i> (vi)	jah-nah	to go
आना	<i>aanaa</i> (vi)	ah-nah	to come
पहुँचना	<i>pahunchnaa</i> (vi)	puh-hu(n)ch-nah	to arrive, reach
चढ़ना	<i>chaRhnaa</i> (vi)	chuRh-nah	to board, climb on
उतरना	<i>utarnaa</i> (vi)	u-tur-nah	to get off, get down

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मुड़ना	<i>muRnaa</i> (vi)	muR-nah	to turn
रुकना	<i>ruknaa</i> (vi)	ruk-nah	to stop
बैठना	<i>baiThnaa</i> (vi)	behTh-nah	to sit; to get into (a vehicle)

WATCH OUT

Two traps here. First: उतरना (*utarna*) [u-tur-nah] with a short *a* means to get off (a bus, the Metro); उतारना (*utaarna*) [u-tahr-nah] with long *aa* means to take something off (Chapter 9). One vowel is the difference between leaving the bus and undressing on it. Second: keep right and left straight — *daayen* = right, *baayen* = left. Memory hook: **baayen** and English "port-side **backwards**"... or simply drill it with your partner until it's automatic.

In sentences

राजीव चौक पर उतरो और येलो लाइन लो।

raajeev chauk par utaro aur yelo laain lo. [rah-jeev chawk pur u-tuh-roh awr yay-loh lah-in loh]
Get off at Rajiv Chowk and take the Yellow Line.

अगला स्टेशन कौन-सा है?

aglaa sTeshan kaun-saa hai? [ug-lah sTay-shun kawn-sah heh]
Which is the next station?

भैया, इंडिया गेट चलोगे? कितना लगे?

bhaiyaa, inDiya geT chaloge? kitnaa loge? [bheh-yah, in-Di-yah gayT chuh-loh-gay? kit-nah loh-gay]
Bhaiya, will you go to India Gate? How much will you take?

सिग्नल से दाएँ मुड़ो, फिर सीधे जाओ।

signal se daayen muRo, phir seedhe jaao. [sig-nul say dah-yay(n) mu-Roh, phir see-dhay jah-oh]
Turn right at the signal, then go straight.

मंदिर के सामने रुकिए।

mandir ke saamne rukiye. [mun-dir kay sahm-nay ru-ki-yay]
Please stop in front of the temple.

मेट्रो में बहुत भीड़ है, अगली ट्रेन लेते हैं।

meTro mein bahut bheeR hai, aglee Tren lete hain. [may-Troh may(n) bo-hut bheeR heh, ug-lee Trayn lay-tay heh(n)]

The Metro is really crowded — let's take the next train.

क्या यह बस सीपी जाती है?

kyaa yeh bas seepee jaatee hai? [kyah yeh bus see-pee jah-tee heh]

Does this bus go to CP (Connaught Place)?

हम टाइम पर पहुँचेंगे? — नहीं यार, जाम लगा है।

ham Taim par pahunchenge? — naheen yaar, jaam lagaa hai. [hum Tah-im pur puh-hu(n)-chay(n)-gay? — nuh-hee(n) yahr, jahm luh-gah heh]

Will we arrive on time? — No yaar, there's a jam.

ऑफिस दूर है क्या? — नहीं, पास है, मैं साइकिल से जाता हूँ।

aufis door hai kyaa? — naheen, paas hai, main saaikil se jaataa hoon. [aw-fis door heh kyah? — nuh-hee(n), pahs heh, meh(n) sah-i-kil say jah-tah hoo(n)]

Is the office far? — No, it's close; I go by bicycle.

यहाँ यू-टर्न लो और बाएँ वाली गली में मुड़ो।

yahaan yoo-Tarn lo aur baayen vaalee galee mein muRo. [yuh-hah(n) yoo-Turn loh awr bah-yay(n) vah-lee guh-lee may(n) mu-Roh]

Take a U-turn here and turn into the lane on the left.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Metro survival, Delhi edition: buy a *kaarD* (or use the QR ticket in the app) so you skip the *Tokan* line; the first coach is the ladies' coach — men, don't board it; eating on the train earns you a fine and public shame. With autos, the magic sentence is भैया, मीटर से चलो। (*bhaiyaa, meeTar se chalo.*) [bheh-yah, mee-Tur say chuh-loh] "Brother, go by the meter" — said with full confidence and zero hope. For short hops there's the ई-रिक्शा (*ee-rikshaa*) [ee-rik-shah], the shared electric rickshaw, ten rupees to the Metro gate. And everyone, including your in-laws, will simply say ओला बुला लो (*olaa bulaa lo*) [oh-lah bu-lah loh] — "call an Ola."

CULTURE

Four places every Delhi conversation assumes you know. कर्नाट प्लेस (*kanauT ples*) [kuh-nawT plays] — Connaught Place, but everyone says सीपी (*seepee*) [see-pee] — the colonial-era circle at the city's heart. चाँदनी चौक (*chaandnee chauk*) [chah(n)d-nee chawk] — the glorious chaos of the old city: food, fabric, wedding shopping. इंडिया गेट (*inDiyaa geT*) [in-Di-yah gayT] — the war memorial where families stroll on summer evenings with ice cream. And लाल क़िला (*laal qilaa*) [lahl qi-lah] — the Red Fort, from whose ramparts the Prime Minister addresses the nation every Independence Day.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks for this week:

1. **Metro quiz.** Open a Delhi Metro map together. Your partner names a station they know well; you answer with the line: यह येलो लाइन पर है। (*yeh yelo laain par hai.*) [yeh yeh-loh lah-in pur heh] Five stations, then swap.
2. **Guide me home.** Your partner plays auto driver from the nearest Metro station to their family home in Delhi; you give directions turn by turn: सीधे जाओ... दाएँ मुड़ो... यहाँ रुको। (*seedhe jao... daayen muRo... yahaan ruko.*) [see-dhay jah-oh... dah-yay(n) mu-Roh... yuh-hah(n) ru-koh]
3. **Sunday plan.** Plan an outing using at least four place words and two vehicles: पहले हम मेट्रो से सीपी चलेंगे, फिर ऑटो से... (*pehle ham meTro se seepee challenge, phir auTo se...*) [peh-lay hum may-Troh say see-pee chuh-lay(n)-gay, phir aw-Toh say]

CHAPTER 11

Money, Shopping & Bargaining

In Delhi, shopping is a conversation and sometimes a sport. In a mall you pay what the tag says; in Sarojini Nagar or the sabzi mandi, the first price is merely an opening argument. This chapter gives you money words, price-asking, weights, modern payment (yes, यूपीआई (yoo-pee-aaee) [yoo-pee-ah-ee] — even the coconut-seller has a QR code), and the sacred art of मोल-भाव (mol-bhaav) [mohl-bhahv] — bargaining.

Money & prices

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पैसा	<i>paisaa</i> (m)	peh-sah	money; a paisa (1/100 rupee)
पैसे	<i>paise</i> (m pl)	peh-say	money (the usual plural form)
रुपया	<i>rupayaa</i> (m)	ru-puh-yah	rupee (₹)
रुपये	<i>rupaye</i> (m pl)	ru-puh-yay	rupees (सौ रुपये = ₹100)
दाम	<i>daam</i> (m)	dahm	price
क्रीमत	<i>keemat</i> (f)	kee-mut	price, value
रेट	<i>reT</i> (m)	rayT	rate (the word Delhi actually uses)
भाव	<i>bhaav</i> (m)	bhahv	going rate (the mandi word)
महँगा	<i>mehngaa</i>	mehn-gah	expensive
सस्ता	<i>sastaa</i>	sus-tah	cheap
छुट्टा	<i>chhuTTaa</i> (m)	chhuT-Tah	change, small notes/coins
उधार	<i>udhaar</i> (m)	u-dhahr	credit, loan (उधार देना = lend)
बिल	<i>bil</i> (m)	bil	bill, receipt
खर्च	<i>kharch</i> (m)	khurch	expense, spending
बचत	<i>bachat</i> (f)	buh-chut	savings
सेल	<i>sel</i> (f)	sayl	sale (सेल लगी है = there's a sale on)
मुफ्त	<i>muft</i>	muft	free (मुफ्त में = for free; Delhi also says फ्री free)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मोल-भाव	<i>mol-bhaav</i> (m)	mohl-bhahv	bargaining, haggling

Paying, modern Delhi style

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कैश	<i>kaish</i> (m)	kehsh	cash
कार्ड	<i>kaarD</i> (m)	kahrD	card (debit/credit)
यूपीआई	<i>yoo-pee-aaee</i> (m)	yoo-pee-ah-ee	UPI (scan-and-pay; ubiquitous)
एटीएम	<i>e-Tee-em</i> (m)	ay-Tee-aym	ATM

Asking the price

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
कितने का है?	<i>kitne kaa hai?</i>	kit-nay kah heh	how much is it? (m item)
कितने की है?	<i>kitne kee hai?</i>	kit-nay kee heh	how much is it? (f item)
क्या भाव है?	<i>kyaa bhaav hai?</i>	kyah bhahv heh	what's the rate? (produce, mandi)
कितना हुआ?	<i>kitnaa huaa?</i>	kit-nah hu-ah	what's the total? (lit. how much did it become)
कम करो	<i>kam karo</i>	kum kuh-roh	lower it (the price)
थोड़ा कम कर दो	<i>thoRaa kam kar do</i>	thoh-Rah kum kur doh	knock a little off (softer)
ठीक-ठीक लगाओ	<i>Theek-Theek lagaao</i>	Theek-Theek luh-gah-oh	quote me the real price
छुट्टा नहीं है	<i>chhuTTaa naheen hai</i>	chhuT-Tah nuh-hee(n) heh	(I/we have) no change — heard daily
रहने दो	<i>rehne do</i>	reh-nay doh	never mind, forget it (walk-away move)

NOTE

kaa/kee/ke agrees with the thing you're pricing: यह कुर्ता कितने का है? (*yeh kurtaa kitne kaa hai?*) [yeh kur-tah kit-nay kah heh] but यह साड़ी कितने की है? (*yeh saaRee kitne kee hai?*) [yeh sah-Ree kit-nay kee heh], and for plurals ये केले कितने के हैं? (*ye kele kitne ke hain?*) [yay kay-lay kit-nay kay heh(n)] "How much are these bananas?"

At the shop & the mandi

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दुकानदार	<i>dukaandaar</i> (m)	du-kahn-dahr	shopkeeper
ग्राहक	<i>graahak</i> (m)	grah-huk	customer
सामान	<i>saamaan</i> (m)	sah-mahn	stuff, goods, luggage
थैला	<i>thailaa</i> (m)	theh-lah	(shopping) bag
किलो	<i>kilo</i> (m)	ki-loh	kilo
आधा किलो	<i>aadhaa kilo</i>	ah-dhah ki-loh	half a kilo
पाव	<i>paav</i> (m)	pahv	quarter kilo, 250 g (एक पाव अदरक)
दर्जन	<i>darjan</i> (m)	dur-jun	dozen (bananas come this way)

Buying & selling verbs

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खरीदना	<i>khareednaa</i> (vt)	khuh-reed-nah	to buy
बेचना	<i>bechnaa</i> (vt)	baych-nah	to sell
देना	<i>denaa</i> (vt)	day-nah	to give
लेना	<i>lenaa</i> (vt)	lay-nah	to take
लौटाना	<i>lauTaanaa</i> (vt)	law-Tah-nah	to return (something), give back
तोलना	<i>tolnaa</i> (vt)	tohl-nah	to weigh
खर्च करना	<i>kharch karnaa</i> (vt)	khurch kur-nah	to spend

In sentences

भैया, यह कुर्ता कितने का है?

bhaiyaa, yeh kurtaa kitne kaa hai? [bheh-yah, yeh kur-tah kit-nay kah heh]

Bhaiya, how much is this kurta?

टमाटर क्या भाव है? — चालीस रुपये किलो।

TamaaTar kyaa bhaav hai? — chaalees rupaye kilo. [Tuh-mah-Tur kyah bhahv heh? — chah-lees ru-puh-yay ki-loh]

What's the rate for tomatoes? — Forty rupees a kilo.

बहुत महँगा है, थोड़ा कम कर दो।

bahut mehngaa hai, thoRaa kam kar do. [bo-hut mehn-gah heh, thoh-Rah kum kur doh]

That's really expensive — knock a little off.

आधा किलो आलू और एक पाव अदरक देना।

aadhaa kilo aaloo aur ek paav adrak denaa. [ah-dhah ki-loh ah-loo awr ayk pahv ud-ruk day-nah]

Give me half a kilo of potatoes and 250 grams of ginger.

छुट्टा नहीं है — यूपीआई कर दूँ?

chhuTTaa naheen hai — yoo-pee-aaee kar doon? [chhuT-Tah nuh-hee(n) heh — yoo-pee-ah-ee kur doo(n)]

I don't have change — shall I do UPI?

कैश दोगे या कार्ड से?

kaish doge yaa kaarD se? [kehsh doh-gay yah kahrD say]

Will you pay cash or by card?

यह वाला सस्ता है और अच्छा भी है।

yeh vaalaa sastaa hai aur achchhaa bhee hai. [yeh vah-lah sus-tah heh awr uch-chhah bhee heh]

This one is cheap, and it's good too.

थैला लाए हो? सामान बहुत है।

thailaa laae ho? saamaan bahut hai. [theh-lah lah-ay hoh? sah-mahn bo-hut heh]

Did you bring a bag? There's a lot of stuff.

दीदी, बिल में सौ रुपये ज़्यादा हैं, चेक कीजिए।

deedee, bil mein sau rupaye zyaadaa hain, chek keejiye. [dee-dee, bil may(n) saw ru-puh-yay zyah-dah heh(n), chayk kee-ji-yay]

Didi, the bill is a hundred rupees over — please check.

मुफ्त में कुछ नहीं मिलता, बेटा।

muft mein kuchh naheen miltaa, beTaa. [muft may(n) kuchh nuh-hee(n) mil-tah, bay-Tah]

Nothing comes free, son. (a line every Delhi elder owns)

DELHI STREET NOTE

The full Sarojini Nagar script. Learn it as theater:

You: भैया, यह टी-शर्ट कितने की है? (*bhaiyaa, yeh Tee-sharT kitne kee hai?*) [bheh-yah, yeh Tee-shurT kit-nay kee heh]

Shopkeeper: तीन सौ की। (*teen sau kee.*) [teen saw kee] — ₹300.

You: क्या बात कर रहे हो! सौ में दोगे? (*kyaa baat kar rahe ho! sau mein doge?*) [kyah baht kur ruh-hay hoh! saw may(n) doh-gay] — "What are you even saying! Will you give it for 100?"

Shopkeeper: नहीं भैया, ढाई सौ लगेंगे। (*naheen bhaiyaa, Dhaaee sau lagenge.*) [nuh-hee(n) bheh-yah, Dhah-ee saw luh-gay(n)-gay] — ₹250 (*Dhaaee* = 2½).

You: ठीक-ठीक लगाओ। डेढ़ सौ, आखिरी। (*Theek-Theek lagaao. DeRh sau, aakhiree.*) [Theek-Theek luh-gah-oh. DayRh saw, ah-khi-ree] — ₹150 (*DeRh* = 1½), final.

Shopkeeper: चलो, आपके लिए दो सौ। (*chalo, aapke liye do sau.*) [chuh-loh, ahp-kay li-yay doh saw]

Now the nuclear option: shrug, say रहने दो (*rehne do*) [reh-nay doh], and walk. If you hear अरे सुनो, ले लो! (*arre suno, le lo!*) [uh-ray su-noh, lay loh] behind you — you've won. Delhi also calls change खुल्ले पैसे (*khulle paise*) [khul-lay peh-say], "open money."

CULTURE

Know where to bargain. Street markets (Sarojini Nagar, Janpath, the sabzi mandi) expect it — not bargaining there is leaving money on the table. Malls, branded shops and anywhere with a "Fixed Rate" sign do not. Packaged goods carry an एमआरपी (*em-aar-pee*) [aym-ahr-pee] — the legally printed Maximum Retail Price — and no one may charge above it, so checking the MRP is a national habit. At the neighborhood grocery, trusted regulars run a monthly *udhaar* account settled on payday — old-school credit that still runs half of Delhi.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks for this week:

1. **Sabzi mandi.** Your partner is the vegetable-seller. Buy three vegetables using क्या भाव है? (*kyaa bhaav hai?*) [kyah bhahv heh], order in *kilo / aadhaa kilo / paav*, and get at least one price reduced.
2. **Sarojini showdown.** Run the T-shirt script above, then improvise: partner starts at ₹500, you must land under ₹250 using *kam karo*, *Theek-Theek lagaao* and one dramatic *rehne do*.
3. **Price quiz.** Partner holds up five household things; for each, ask *kitne kaa hai?* or *kitne kee hai?* with the right gender, and react to the invented price: इतना महँगा! (*itnaa mehngaa!*) [it-nah mehn-gah] or वाह, सस्ता है! (*vaah, sastaa hai!*) [vah, sus-tah heh]

CHAPTER 12

Work, Study & Everyday Activities

Half of Delhi's small talk is about work: the job, the boss, the commute, the precious छुट्टी (*chhuTTee*) [chhuT-Tee]. The other half is about someone's exams. This chapter covers office and study vocabulary, the famous learn/teach verb pairs that trip up every English speaker, and the daily-routine verbs that let you narrate your whole day — from *uThnaa* to *sonaa*.

Work

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
काम	<i>kaam</i> (m)	kahm	work; task (काम करना = to work)
नौकरी	<i>naukree</i> (f)	naw-kree	job
दफ़्तर	<i>daftar</i> (m)	duf-tur	office (the Hindi word)
ऑफ़िस	<i>aufis</i> (m)	aw-fis	office (what Delhi says daily)
बॉस	<i>baus</i> (m)	baws	boss
मीटिंग	<i>meeTing</i> (f)	mee-Ting	meeting
कंपनी	<i>kampanee</i> (f)	kum-puh-nee	company
छुट्टी	<i>chhuTTee</i> (f)	chhuT-Tee	day off; leave; vacation — both senses
तनख़्वाह	<i>tankhvaah</i> (f)	tun-khvah	salary
सैलरी	<i>sailaree</i> (f)	seh-luh-ree	salary (the everyday loanword)
बिज़ी	<i>bizee</i>	bi-zee	busy (yes, Delhi just says "busy")
फ़्री	<i>free</i>	free	free, not busy
फ़ुर्सत	<i>fursat</i> (f)	fur-sut	free time, leisure (फ़ुर्सत में = at leisure)

NOTE

The dictionary word for busy is व्यस्त (*vyast*) [vyust] — you'll see it in writing and hear it in news Hindi, but across a chai table Delhi says *bizee*. Likewise क्या तुम कल फ़्री हो? (*kyaa tum kal free ho?*) [kyah tum kul free hoh] "Are you free tomorrow?" is completely normal Hindi now. *fursat* is the lovely native word for unhurried free time: फ़ुर्सत में आना (*fursat mein aanaa*) [fur-sut may(n) ah-nah] — "come when you have time."

Study

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पढ़ाई	<i>paRhaaee</i> (f)	puh-Rhah-ee	studies, studying
स्कूल	<i>skool</i> (m)	skool	school
कॉलेज	<i>kaulej</i> (m)	kaw-layj	college
यूनिवर्सिटी	<i>yoonivarsiTee</i> (f)	yoo-ni-vur-si-Tee	university
क्लास	<i>klaas</i> (f)	klahs	class
टीचर	<i>Teechar</i> (m)	Tee-chur	teacher (address them as "sir"/"ma'am")
स्टूडेंट	<i>sTooDenT</i> (m)	sToo-DaynT	student
इम्तिहान	<i>imtihaan</i> (m)	im-ti-hahn	exam
एग्जाम	<i>egzaam</i> (m)	ayg-zahm	exam (the campus word)
होमवर्क	<i>homvark</i> (m)	hohm-vurk	homework
किताब	<i>kitaab</i> (f)	ki-tahb	book
कॉपी	<i>kaupée</i> (f)	kaw-pee	notebook (Indian English "copy")
पेन	<i>pen</i> (m)	payn	pen
शब्द	<i>shabd</i> (m)	shubd	word
सवाल	<i>savaal</i> (m)	suh-vahl	question
जवाब	<i>javaab</i> (m)	juh-vahb	answer

Learning & thinking verbs

The learn/teach pairs

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सीखना	<i>seekhnaa</i> (vt)	seekh-nah	to learn
सिखाना	<i>sikhaanaa</i> (vt)	si-khah-nah	to teach (a skill: cooking, driving, Hindi)
पढ़ना	<i>paRhnaa</i> (vt)	puRh-nah	to read; to study
पढ़ाना	<i>paRhaanaa</i> (vt)	puh-Rhah-nah	to teach (lessons, as a teacher does)

Remembering, understanding, doing

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लिखना	<i>likhnaa</i> (vt)	likh-nah	to write
याद करना	<i>yaad karnaa</i> (vt)	yahd kur-nah	to memorize; to think of someone
याद आना	<i>yaad aanaa</i> (vi)	yahd ah-nah	to come to mind, to recall (मुझे याद आया)
भूलना	<i>bhoolnaa</i> (vt)	bhool-nah	to forget
समझना	<i>samajhnaa</i> (vt)	suh-mujh-nah	to understand
सोचना	<i>sochnaa</i> (vt)	sohch-nah	to think
कोशिश करना	<i>koshish karnaa</i> (vt)	koh-shish kur-nah	to try (कोशिश f = attempt)
शुरू करना	<i>shuroo karnaa</i> (vt)	shu-roo kur-nah	to start
खत्म करना	<i>khatam karnaa</i> (vt)	khuh-tum kur-nah	to finish

WATCH OUT

English "teach" hides two Hindi verbs, and "learn/study" two more. *seekhnaa* = learn, *sikhaanaa* = teach a skill; *paRhnaa* = read/study, *paRhaanaa* = teach lessons. So: मैं हिन्दी सीख रहा हूँ। (*main hindee seekh rahaa hoon.*) [meh(n) hin-dee seekh ruh-hah hoo(n)] — never "*sikhaa rahaa hoon*", which would mean you're the teacher. And the one that melts hearts when you get it right: मुझे तुम्हारी याद आ रही थी। (*mujhe tumhaaree yaad aa rahee thee.*) [mu-jhay tum-hah-ree yahd ah ruh-hee thee] "I was missing you" — literally, "your memory kept coming to me."

The daily-routine verbs

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
उठना	<i>uThnaa</i> (vi)	uTh-nah	to get up, wake up
नहाना	<i>nahaanaa</i> (vi)	nuh-hah-nah	to bathe, shower
तैयार होना	<i>taiyaar honaa</i> (vi)	teh-yahr hoh-nah	to get ready
निकलना	<i>nikalnaa</i> (vi)	ni-kul-nah	to leave, head out
पहुँचना	<i>pahunchnaa</i> (vi)	puh-hu(n)ch-nah	to arrive
लौटना	<i>lauTnaa</i> (vi)	lawT-nah	to return, come back

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आराम करना	<i>aaraam karnaa</i> (vt)	ah-rahm kur-nah	to rest, relax
सोना	<i>sonaa</i> (vi)	soh-nah	to sleep

In sentences

मैं रोज़ सात बजे उठता हूँ और नौ बजे निकलता हूँ।

main roz saat baje uThtaa hoon aur nau baje nikaltaa hoon. [meh(n) roh-z saht buh-jay uTh-tah hoo(n) awr nau buh-jay ni-kul-tah hoo(n)]

I get up at seven every day and leave at nine.

तुम क्या काम करते हो? — मैं एक कंपनी में काम करता हूँ।

tum kyaa kaam karte ho? — main ek kampanee mein kaam kartaa hoon. [tum kyah kahm kur-tay hoh? — meh(n) ayk kum-puh-nee may(n) kahm kur-tah hoo(n)]

What work do you do? — I work at a company.

आज बॉस के साथ मीटिंग है, मैं बहुत बिज़ी हूँ।

aaj baus ke saath meeTing hai, main bahut bizee hoon. [ahj baws kay sahth mee-Ting heh, meh(n) bo-hut bi-zee hoo(n)]

I have a meeting with the boss today; I'm very busy.

वह हिन्दी सिखाती है और मैं सीखता हूँ।

voh hindee sikhaatee hai aur main seekhtaa hoon. [voh hin-dee si-khah-tee heh awr meh(n) seekh-tah hoo(n)]

She teaches Hindi and I learn it.

कल इम्तिहान है, आज पूरी रात पढ़ाई होगी।

kal imtihaan hai, aaj pooree raat paRhaaee hogee. [kul im-ti-hahn heh, ahj poo-ree raht puh-Rhah-ee hoh-gee]

The exam is tomorrow — tonight will be all studying.

मुझे यह शब्द याद नहीं आ रहा।

mujhe yeh shabd yaad naheen aa rahaa. [mu-jhay yeh shubd yahd nuh-hee(n) ah ruh-hah]

I can't recall this word. (lit. this word isn't coming to memory)

कोशिश करो, धीरे-धीरे समझ आ जाएगा।

koshish karo, dheere-dheere samajh aa jaaegaa. [koh-shish kuh-roh, dheeray-dheeray suh-mujh ah jah-ay-gah]

Keep trying — slowly it will start to make sense.

काम खत्म करके जल्दी घर लौटो।

kaam khatam karke jaldee ghar lauTo. [kahm khuh-tum kur-kay jul-dee ghur law-Toh]

Finish work and come home early.

अगले हफ्ते मेरी छुट्टी है, चलो कहीं चलते हैं।

agle hafte meree chhuTTEE hai, chalo kaheen chalte hain. [ug-lay huf-tay may-ree chhuT-Tee heh, chuh-loh kuh-hee(n) chul-tay heh(n)]

I'm off next week — let's go somewhere.

सोने से पहले फ़ोन मत देखो।

sone se pehle fon mat dekho. [soh-nay say peh-lay fohn mut day-khoh]

Don't look at your phone before sleeping.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi office talk is fluent Hinglish. A colleague will say कल मैं छुट्टी पर हूँ, वर्क फ़्रॉम होम करूँगा।

(kal main chhuTTEE par hoon, vark fraum hom karoongaa.) [kul meh(n) chhuT-Tee pur hoo(n), vork frawm hohm kuh-roo(n)-gah] — leave and WFH in one breath. The universal excuse for

lateness is traffic: यार, जाम में फँस गया। *(yaar, jaam mein phans gayaa.)* [yahr, jahm may(n)

phuns guh-yah] "Got stuck in a jam." A steady 9-to-5 is नौ से पाँच की नौकरी *(nau se paanch kee*

naukree) [naw say pah(n)ch kee naw-kree], and payday brings the sweetest sentence in the

language: सैलरी आ गई! *(sailaree aa gae!)* [seh-luh-ree ah guh-ee]

CULTURE

Two things to know. First, the सरकारी नौकरी *(sarkaaree naukree)* [sur-kah-ree naw-kree] — a government job — is the classic dream in many families: secure, pensioned, prestigious, and a favorite topic of aunties assessing sons-in-law. Second, India's holiday calendar is gloriously crowded: Diwali, Holi, Eid, Guru Nanak Jayanti, Christmas and more are all public holidays, so *chhuTTEE* planning is a competitive sport. If someone asks about your *paRhaaee* or your job title, it's not nosiness — it's the standard way elders show care.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks for this week:

1. **My whole day.** Narrate your day in at least six sentences chaining the routine verbs: मैं उठता हूँ, नहाता हूँ, तैयार होता हूँ... (*main uThtaa hoon, nahaataa hoon, taiyaar hotaa hoon...*)

[meh(n) uTh-tah hoo(n), nuh-hah-tah hoo(n), teh-yahr hoh-tah hoo(n)] Partner listens for wrong verbs and missing *baje* times.

2. **Teach-and-learn swap.** You teach your partner three English idioms; they teach you three Hindi words — narrating with the pair verbs as you go: मैं तुम्हें सिखा रहा हूँ, तुम सीख रही हो। (*main tumhen sikhaa rahaa hoon, tum seekh rahee ho.*) [meh(n) tum-hay(n) si-khah ruh-

hah hoo(n), tum seekh ruh-hee hoh]

3. **The interview.** Ask your partner three questions about school and first jobs: तुम कहाँ पढ़ती थीं? पहली नौकरी कैसी थी? (*tum kahaan paRhatee theen? pehlee naukree kaisee thee?*)

[tum kuh-hah(n) puRh-tee thee(n)? peh-lee naw-kree keh-see thee] (Use *paRhate the* if your partner is male.) Report back one thing you learned, in Hindi.

CHAPTER 13

Weather & Nature

Delhi's weather is not small talk — it's an epic with a full cast: 45-degree summers, a dust storm or two, a monsoon that turns the city green, foggy winter mornings, and one perfect February. This chapter gives you the weather words, Delhi's very real seasons, and the nature and animal vocabulary you need in a city where a बंदर (*bandar*) [bun-dur] may genuinely visit your balcony.

Weather

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मौसम	<i>mausam</i> (m)	maw-sum	weather; season
गर्मी	<i>garmee</i> (f)	gur-mee	heat; summer
सर्दी	<i>sardee</i> (f)	sur-dee	cold; winter
ठंड	<i>ThanD</i> (f)	ThunD	cold, chill
बारिश	<i>baarish</i> (f)	bah-rish	rain
धूप	<i>dhoop</i> (f)	dhoop	sunshine
छाया	<i>chhaayaa</i> (f)	chhah-yah	shade, shadow
हवा	<i>havaa</i> (f)	huh-vah	wind; air
बादल	<i>baadal</i> (m)	bah-dul	cloud
आँधी	<i>aandhee</i> (f)	ah(n)-dhee	dust storm (a Delhi specialty)
लू	<i>loo</i> (f)	loo	the hot summer wind (May-June)
कोहरा	<i>kohraa</i> (m)	koh-rah	fog (Delhi's winter blanket)
स्मॉग	<i>smaug</i> (m)	smawg	smog (an autumn reality; AQI is daily talk)
बिजली	<i>bijlee</i> (f)	bij-lee	lightning; electricity — both!
तूफ़ान	<i>toofaan</i> (m)	too-fahn	storm

NOTE

bijlee does double duty: lightning in the sky and the electricity in your walls, so बिजली चली गई (*bijlee chalee gae*) [bij-lee chuh-lee guh-ee] means "the power's gone out." Likewise *garmee* and *sardee* are both the sensation and the season: गर्मी का मौसम (*garmee kaa mausam*) [gur-mee kah maw-sum] = summertime.

Talking about the weather

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
आज मौसम अच्छा है।	<i>aaj mausam achchhaa hai.</i>	ahj maw-sum uch-chhah heh	the weather's nice today
कितनी गर्मी है!	<i>kitnee garmee hai!</i>	kit-nee gur-mee heh	it's so hot! (lit. how much heat!)
आज ठंड है।	<i>aaj ThanD hai.</i>	ahj ThunD heh	it's cold today
बारिश हो रही है।	<i>baarish ho rahee hai.</i>	bah-rish hoh ruh-hee heh	it's raining
धूप निकली है।	<i>dhoop niklee hai.</i>	dhoop nik-lee heh	the sun's out
लू चल रही है।	<i>loo chal rahee hai.</i>	loo chul ruh-hee heh	the hot wind is blowing
लू लगना	<i>loo lagnaa</i>	loo lug-nah	to get heatstroke (लू लग गई!)
बहुत कोहरा है।	<i>bahut kohraa hai.</i>	bo-hut koh-rah heh	it's very foggy

The seasons

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
गर्मियाँ	<i>garmiyaan</i> (f pl)	gur-mi-yah(n)	summer (गर्मियों में = in summer)
सर्दियाँ	<i>sardiyaan</i> (f pl)	sur-di-yah(n)	winter (सर्दियों में = in winter)
बारिश का मौसम	<i>baarish kaa mausam</i> (m)	bah-rish kah maw-sum	the rainy season
मानसून	<i>maansoon</i> (m)	mahn-soon	monsoon (July–September)
बसंत	<i>basant</i> (m)	buh-sunt	spring (February; blink and you miss it)
पतझड़	<i>patjhaR</i> (m)	put-jhuR	autumn, leaf-fall

Nature

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पेड़	<i>peR</i> (m)	payR	tree
फूल	<i>phool</i> (m)	phool	flower
पत्ता	<i>pattaa</i> (m)	put-tah	leaf
घास	<i>ghaas</i> (f)	ghahs	grass
मिट्टी	<i>miTTee</i> (f)	miT-Tee	earth, soil (smells wonderful in rain)
आसमान	<i>aasmaan</i> (m)	ahs-mahn	sky
सूरज	<i>sooraj</i> (m)	soo-ruj	sun
चाँद	<i>chaand</i> (m)	chah(n)d	moon
तारा	<i>taaraa</i> (m)	tah-rah	star (तारे taare = stars)
नदी	<i>nadee</i> (f)	nuh-dee	river (Delhi's is the यमुना yamunaa [yuh-mu-nah])
पहाड़	<i>pahaaR</i> (m)	puh-hahR	mountain, hill

Animals you'll actually meet

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जानवर	<i>jaanvar</i> (m)	jahn-vur	animal
कुत्ता	<i>kutta</i> (m)	kut-tah	dog
बिल्ली	<i>billee</i> (f)	bil-lee	cat
गाय	<i>gaay</i> (f)	gahy	cow
बंदर	<i>bandar</i> (m)	bun-dur	monkey (Delhi has thousands)
चिड़िया	<i>chiRiyaa</i> (f)	chi-Ri-yah	bird; sparrow (everyday word)
पक्षी	<i>pakshee</i> (m)	puk-shee	bird (formal/written word)
कबूतर	<i>kabootar</i> (m)	kuh-boo-tur	pigeon (ruler of Delhi balconies)
मच्छर	<i>machchhar</i> (m)	much-chhur	mosquito
मक्खी	<i>makkhee</i> (f)	muk-khee	fly

In sentences

आज बहुत गर्मी है, बाहर लू चल रही है।

aaj bahut garmee hai, baahar loo chal rahee hai. [ahj bo-hut gur-mee heh, bah-hur loo chul ruh-hee heh]

It's very hot today — the loo is blowing outside.

बारिश हो रही है, छत से कपड़े उतार लो।

baarish ho rahee hai, chhat se kapRe utaar lo. [bah-rish hoh ruh-hee heh, chhut say kup-Ray u-tahr loh]

It's raining — take the clothes down from the roof.

दिसंबर में बहुत कोहरा होता है, फ्लाइट लेट हो जाती हैं।

disambar mein bahut kohraa hotaa hai, flaaIT leT ho jaatee hain. [di-sum-bur may(n) bo-hut koh-rah hoh-tah heh, flah-iT layT hoh jah-tee heh(n)]

In December there's heavy fog; flights run late.

बिजली चली गई! — कोई बात नहीं, अभी आ जाएगी।

bijlee chalee gae! — koe baat naheen, abhee aa jaaegee. [bij-lee chuh-lee guh-ee! — koh-ee baht nuh-hee(n), uh-bhee ah jah-ay-gee]

The power's gone! — No problem, it'll be back soon.

रात में आसमान साफ़ था, चाँद और तारे दिख रहे थे।

raat mein aasmaan saaf thaa, chaand aur taare dikh rahe the. [raht may(n) ahs-mahn sah f thah, chah(n)d awr tah-ray dikh ruh-hay thay]

The sky was clear at night; the moon and stars were visible.

बालकनी में बंदर आ गया! दरवाज़ा बंद करो!

baalkanee mein bandar aa gayaa! darvaazaa band karo! [bahl-kuh-nee may(n) bun-dur ah guh-yah! dur-vah-zah bund kuh-roh]

A monkey's gotten onto the balcony! Shut the door!

मच्छर बहुत हैं, खिड़की बंद कर दो।

machchhar bahut hain, khiRkee band kar do. [much-chhur bo-hut heh(n), khiR-kee bund kur doh]

There are a lot of mosquitoes — close the window.

चलो, बारिश में चाय और पकौड़े!

chalo, baarish mein chaay aur pakauRe! [chuh-loh, bah-rish may(n) chah-ay awr puh-kaw-Ray]

Come on — chai and pakoras in the rain!

सर्दियों में हम धूप में बैठते हैं।

sardiyon mein ham dhoop mein baiThte hain. [sur-di-yoh(n) may(n) hum dhoop may(n) behTh-tay heh(n)]

In winter we sit in the sunshine. (a beloved Delhi pastime)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's weather has its own vocabulary of drama. In May an *aandhee* can turn the sky brown in minutes — everyone runs to shut windows. June elders warn धूप में मत जाओ, लू लग जाएगी। (*dhoop mein mat jao, loo lag jaaegee.*) [dhoop may(n) mut jah-oh, loo lug jah-ay-gee]

"Don't go out in the sun, you'll get heatstroke." December *kohraa* swallows the airport whole. And in late autumn, checking the air quality is as routine as checking the time — आज AQI कितना है? (*aaq e-kyoo-aaee kitnaa hai?*) [ahj ay-kyoo-ah-ee kit-nah heh] — with masks and air purifiers making a seasonal appearance.

CULTURE

Delhi really has five seasons, and each has its rituals. A short, perfect *basant* (February — flowers, kite skies); the furnace of *garmiyaan* (April-June — mangoes and nimbu-paani); then the *maansoon*, the most romantic weather in India: the first rain releases the smell of wet earth — मिट्टी की खुशबू (*miTTee kee khushboo*) [miT-Tee kee khush-boo] — and the entire city's love language becomes *chaay aur pakauRe* on a balcony while it pours. Bollywood has a hundred rain songs for a reason. October-November brings festival weather, and *sardiyaan* (December-January) means shawls, weddings, peanuts, and chairs dragged into the winter *dhoop*.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

Three mini-tasks for this week:

- Daily weather report.** Each morning, text your partner one Hindi line about your weather: आज धूप है। (*aaq dhoop hai.*) [ahj dhoop heh] They reply with Delhi's weather; compare cities all week.
- Season showdown.** Ask: तुम्हारा पसंदीदा मौसम कौन-सा है? (*tumhaaraa pasandeedaa mausam kaun-saa hai?*) [tum-hah-rah puh-sun-dee-dah maw-sum kawn-sah heh] "Which is your favorite season?" Each of you defends your choice with two reasons in Hindi.
- Animal safari.** On a walk (or through photos), name every creature you spot in Hindi — कुत्ता, बिल्ली, कबूतर, चिड़िया... (*kuttaa, billee, kabootar, chiRiyaa...*) [kut-tah, bil-lee, kuh-boo-tur, chi-Ri-yah] First to ten wins; mosquitoes count.

CHAPTER 14

Feelings, Personality & Small Talk

You can find the metro and order the chai — now learn to say how you actually feel, and to keep a Delhi conversation rolling. Delhiites talk about feelings constantly, usually at full volume, and half the time with one borrowed English word: टेंशन (*Tenshan*) [Tayn-shun]. This chapter gives you feeling words, personality words, and the small-talk starters and reactions that make you sound alive, not like a textbook.

Feelings

Core feeling words

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खुश	<i>khush</i>	khush	happy
खुशी	<i>khushiee</i> (f)	khu-shee	happiness, joy
उदास	<i>udaas</i>	u-dahs	sad
गुस्सा	<i>gussaa</i> (m)	gus-sah	anger; angry
नाराज़	<i>naaraaz</i>	nah-rahz	upset, displeased (with someone)
परेशान	<i>pareshaan</i>	puh-ray-shahn	worried, troubled
थका हुआ	<i>thakaa huaa</i>	thuh-kah hu-ah	tired
बोर	<i>bor</i>	bor	bored (English loan; बोर होना <i>bor honaa</i> = to get bored)
नर्वस	<i>narvas</i>	nur-vus	nervous (English loan)
टेंशन	<i>Tenshan</i> (f)	Tayn-shun	stress, worry (THE Delhi feeling word)
मज़ा	<i>mazaa</i> (m)	muh-zah	fun, enjoyment
शर्म	<i>sharm</i> (f)	shurm	shyness, embarrassment
डर	<i>Dar</i> (m)	Dur	fear
अकेला	<i>akelaa</i>	uh-kay-lah	alone, lonely

How feelings work: they come to you

Most feelings in Hindi are nouns that *come to* you or *attach to* you — you learned this ko-pattern in Unit 10. Memorize these as chunks:

PATTERN	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मुझे गुस्सा आ रहा है	<i>mujhe gussaa aa rahaa hai</i>	mu-jhay gus-sah ah ruh-hah heh	I'm getting angry
वो मुझसे नाराज़ है	<i>voh mujhse naaraaz hai</i>	voh mujh-say nah-rahz heh	she/he is upset with me
मुझे डर लगता है	<i>mujhe Dar lagtaa hai</i>	mu-jhay Dur lug-tah heh	I'm scared (fear strikes me)
मुझे शर्म आ रही है	<i>mujhe sharm aa rahee hai</i>	mu-jhay shurm ah ruh-hee heh	I'm embarrassed
मज़ा आ गया!	<i>mazaa aa gayaa!</i>	muh-zah ah guh-yah	that was great fun!
भूख लगी है	<i>bhookh (f) lagee hai</i>	bhookh luh-gee heh	(I'm) hungry
प्यास लगी है	<i>pyaas (f) lagee hai</i>	pyahs luh-gee heh	(I'm) thirsty
नींद आ रही है	<i>neend (f) aa rahee hai</i>	neend ah ruh-hee heh	(I'm) sleepy

WATCH OUT

Don't translate "I am scared / embarrassed / having fun" with *main hoon*. These feelings take मुझे (*mujhe*) [mu-jhay]: say मुझे डर लग रहा है (*mujhe Dar lag rahaa hai*) [mu-jhay Dur lug ruh-hah heh], never "*main Dar hoon*". Simple states like *khush* / *udaas* / *pareshaan* DO work with *main... hoon*: मैं खुश हूँ। (*main khush hoon.*) [meh(n) khush hoo(n)]

Personality

Adjectives ending in *-aa* agree like always: प्यारा / प्यारी (*pyaaraa* / *pyaaree*) [pyah-rah / pyah-ree].

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अच्छा	<i>achchhaa</i>	uch-chhah	good, nice
प्यारा	<i>pyaaraa</i>	pyah-rah	sweet, lovable, cute
समझदार	<i>samajhdaar</i>	suh-mujh-dahr	sensible, mature
मेहनती	<i>mehnatee</i>	meh-nuh-tee	hardworking
आलसी	<i>aalsee</i>	ahl-see	lazy
मज़ाकिया	<i>mazaakiyaa</i>	muh-zah-ki-yah	funny (Delhi also just says फ़नी <i>fanee</i>)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सीधा	<i>seedhaa</i>	see-dhah	straightforward, simple (person)
तेज़	<i>tez</i>	tayz	sharp, quick-witted
शांत	<i>shaant</i>	shahnt	calm, quiet
बातूनी	<i>baatoonee</i>	bah-too-nee	talkative, chatterbox
शैतान	<i>shaitaan</i>	sheh-tahn	naughty, mischievous (affectionate)

Small talk, Delhi style

Conversation starters

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
और बताओ!	<i>aur bataao!</i>	awr buh-tah-oh	so, tell me! / what else is going on?
क्या चल रहा है?	<i>kyaa chal rahaa hai?</i>	kyah chul ruh-hah heh	what's going on?
सब ठीक?	<i>sab Theek?</i>	sub Theek	all good?
कैसा रहा दिन?	<i>kaisaa rahaa din?</i>	keh-sah ruh-hah din	how was your day?
क्या सीन है?	<i>kyaa seen (m) hai?</i>	kyah seen heh	what's the scene/plan? (Delhi)

Reactions — sound interested

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अच्छा?!	<i>achchhaa?! </i>	uch-chhah	oh really?!
सच में?	<i>sach (m) mein?</i>	such may(n)	really? seriously?
वाह!	<i>vaah!</i>	vah	wow!
अरे वाह!	<i>arre vaah!</i>	uh-ray vah	oh wow!
ओहो!	<i>oho!</i>	oh-hoh	oho! (surprise, often teasing)
चलो अच्छा है	<i>chalo achchhaa hai</i>	chuh-loh uch-chhah heh	well, that's good (then)
कमाल है!	<i>kamaal (m) hai!</i>	kuh-mahl heh	amazing! / unbelievable!

In action

आज मैं बहुत खुश हूँ।

aaj main bahut khush hoon. [ahj meh(n) bo-hut khush hoo(n)]

I'm very happy today.

मुझे गुस्सा आ रहा है।

mujhe gussaa aa rahaa hai. [mu-jhay gus-sah ah ruh-hah heh]

I'm getting angry. (lit. to-me anger is coming)

टेंशन मत लो, सब ठीक हो जाएगा।

Tenshan mat lo, sab Theek ho jaayegaa. [Tayn-shun mut loh, sub Theek hoh jah-ay-gah]

Don't stress, everything will be fine.

कल पार्टी में बहुत मज़ा आ गया!

kal paarTee mein bahut mazaa aa gayaa! [kul pahr-Tee may(n) bo-hut muh-zah ah guh-yah]

The party yesterday was so much fun!

मुझे अँधेरे से डर लगता है।

mujhe andhere se Dar lagtaa hai. [mu-jhay un-dhay-ray say Dur lug-tah heh]

I'm afraid of the dark. (lit. to-me dark-from fear strikes)

तुम्हारी बहन बहुत समझदार है।

tumhaaree behen bahut samajhdaar hai. [tum-hah-ree beh-hen bo-hut suh-mujh-dahr heh]

Your sister is very sensible.

वो थोड़ा परेशान लग रहा है।

voh thoRaa pareshaan lag rahaa hai. [voh thoh-Rah puh-ray-shahn lug ruh-hah heh]

He's looking a bit worried.

और बताओ, क्या चल रहा है?

aur bataao, kyaa chal rahaa hai? [awr buh-tah-oh, kyah chul ruh-hah heh]

So tell me, what's going on?

अच्छा?! सच में? कमाल है!

achchhaa?! sach mein? kamaal hai! [uch-chhah? such may(n)? kuh-mahl heh]

Really?! Seriously? That's amazing!

मैं आज बहुत थका हुआ हूँ, जल्दी सोऊँगा।

main aaj bahut thakaa huaa hoon, jaldee sooongaa. [meh(n) ahj bo-hut thuh-kah hu-ah hoo(n), jul-dee soh-oo(n)-gah]

I'm really tired today, I'll sleep early.

DELHI STREET NOTE

In Delhi, stress has one name: टेंशन (*Tenshan*) [Tayn-shun]. You'll hear टेंशन मत लो यार!

(*Tenshan mat lo yaar!*) [Tayn-shun mut loh yahr] — "don't take tension" — ten times a day.

Feelings-talk is heavily Hinglish: "*main thoRaa low feel kar rahaa hoon*", "*full excited hoon!*". And the answer to क्या सीन है? (*kyaa seen hai?*) [kyah seen heh] when there is no

plan: कोई सीन नहीं। (*koe seen naheen.*) [koh-ee seen nuh-hee(n)]

CULTURE

Small talk in Delhi runs on repetition, and that's the charm: सब ठीक? हाँ, सब ठीक। घर पर सब ठीक? बिल्कुल। (*sab Theek? haan, sab Theek. ghar par sab Theek? bilkul.*) [sub Theek? hah(n), sub Theek. ghur pur sub Theek? bil-kul] Asking twice isn't awkward — it's warmth. The all-purpose restarter when conversation lulls is और बताओ (*aur bataao*) [awr buh-tah-oh] — it literally means "tell more", and nobody expects new information. With elders, switch to और बताइए (*aur bataaiye*) [awr buh-tah-i-yay].

WITH YOUR PARTNER

1) Tonight, ask each other कैसा रहा दिन? (*kaisaa rahaa din?*) [keh-sah ruh-hah din] and answer with at least two feeling words each. 2) Your partner tells you three pieces of news (one boring, one big, one fake) — react to each with a different reaction word: *achchhaa?!*, *sach mein?*, *kamaal hai!*, *arre vaah!* 3) Describe two family members using personality words (*samajhdhaar*, *baatoonee*, *aalsee...*) and have your partner guess who you mean.

CHAPTER 15

Core Verbs — the 120 You Actually Need

Here they are: the ~120 verbs that carry almost every Delhi conversation, sorted by theme so they stick. Learn them as infinitives (-*naa* forms) — every tense you met in Book 2 is built from these. Delhi tip: when in doubt, Delhiites just bolt an English word onto करना (*karnaa*) [kur-nah] — *try karo, enjoy karo* — but the verbs below are the real engine of the language.

NOTE

(*vt*) = transitive (takes an object; uses ने *ne* [nay] in simple past — Unit 14). (*vi*) = intransitive (no object, never *ne*). A few rebels are marked (*vt, no ne*) or (*vt/vi*). For *X karnaa* compounds, the gender shown on the noun *X* is what the past participle agrees with: मैंने कोशिश की। (*maine koshish kee.*) [meh(n)-nay koh-shish kee]

The verb bank

1 · Being & staying

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
होना	<i>hona</i> (vi)	hoh-nah	to be; to happen
हो जाना	<i>ho jaana</i> (vi)	hoh jah-nah	to become; to get done
रहना	<i>rehna</i> (vi)	reh-nah	to live, to stay

NOTE

Hindi has no verb "to have". You "keep" things (*rakhnaa*), things are "near you" (मेरे पास कार है *mere paas kaar hai* [may-ray pahs kahr heh]), or family "is yours" (मेरी दो बहनें हैं *meri do behnen hain* [may-ree doh beh-nay(n) heh(n)]).

2 · Motion

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जाना	<i>jaana</i> (vi)	jah-nah	to go
आना	<i>aana</i> (vi)	ah-nah	to come
चलना	<i>chalna</i> (vi)	chul-nah	to walk, to move; (machine) to run

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दौड़ना	<i>dauRnaa</i> (vi)	dawR-nah	to run
भागना	<i>bhaagnaa</i> (vi)	bhahg-nah	to run off, to rush
पहुँचना	<i>pahunchnaa</i> (vi)	puh-hu(n)ch-nah	to arrive, to reach
निकलना	<i>nikalnaa</i> (vi)	ni-kul-nah	to leave, to head out
लौटना	<i>lauTnaa</i> (vi)	lawT-nah	to return
घूमना	<i>ghoomnaa</i> (vi)	ghoom-nah	to wander, to go around (for fun)
मुड़ना	<i>muRnaa</i> (vi)	muR-nah	to turn (left/right)

3 · Giving & getting

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
देना	<i>denaa</i> (vt)	day-nah	to give
लेना	<i>lenaa</i> (vt)	lay-nah	to take
लाना	<i>laanaa</i> (vt, no ne)	lah-nah	to bring
ले जाना	<i>le jaanaa</i> (vt, no ne)	lay jah-nah	to take (away), to carry off
लौटाना	<i>lauTaanaa</i> (vt)	law-Tah-nah	to give back, to return (sth)
भेजना	<i>bhejnaa</i> (vt)	bhayj-nah	to send
मिलना	<i>milnaa</i> (vi)	mil-nah	to meet; to be received (<i>mujhe milaa</i> = I got)

4 · Talking

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
बोलना	<i>bolnaa</i> (vt/vi)	bohl-nah	to speak, to say
कहना	<i>kehnaa</i> (vt)	keh-nah	to say, to tell
बात करना	<i>baat</i> (f) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	baht kur-nah	to talk, to have a word
पूछना	<i>poochhnaa</i> (vt)	poochh-nah	to ask
बताना	<i>bataanaa</i> (vt)	buh-tah-nah	to tell, to let (sb) know
सुनना	<i>sunnaa</i> (vt)	sun-nah	to hear, to listen

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
समझाना	<i>samjhaanaa</i> (vt)	sum-jhah-nah	to explain
बुलाना	<i>bulaanaa</i> (vt)	bu-lah-nah	to call (over), to invite
फ़ोन करना	<i>fon</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	fohn kur-nah	to phone
मैसेज करना	<i>maisej</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	meh-sayj kur-nah	to text, to message
जवाब देना	<i>javaab</i> (m) <i>denaa</i> (vt)	juh-vahb day-nah	to answer, to reply
चिल्लाना	<i>chillaanaa</i> (vi)	chil-lah-nah	to shout

5 · Mind & memory

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सोचना	<i>sochnaa</i> (vt)	sohch-nah	to think
समझना	<i>samajhnaa</i> (vt/vi)	suh-mujh-nah	to understand
जानना	<i>jaannaa</i> (vt)	jahn-nah	to know
मानना	<i>maannaa</i> (vt)	mahn-nah	to accept, to believe, to agree
याद करना	<i>yaad</i> (f) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	yahd kur-nah	to remember, to think of (sb)
याद आना	<i>yaad aanaa</i> (vi)	yahd ah-nah	to come to mind; to be missed
भूलना	<i>bhoolnaa</i> (vt, no ne)	bhool-nah	to forget (usually <i>bhool jaanaa</i>)
चाहना	<i>chaahnaa</i> (vt)	chah-nah	to want; to love
पसंद करना	<i>pasand</i> (f) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	puh-sund kur-nah	to like, to prefer

6 · Daily routine

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खाना	<i>khaanaa</i> (vt)	khah-nah	to eat
पीना	<i>peenaa</i> (vt)	pee-nah	to drink
सोना	<i>sonaa</i> (vi)	soh-nah	to sleep
जागना	<i>jaagnaa</i> (vi)	jahg-nah	to wake, to stay awake
उठना	<i>uThnaa</i> (vi)	uTh-nah	to get up

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
बैठना	<i>baiThnaa</i> (vi)	behTh-nah	to sit
नहाना	<i>nahaanaa</i> (vi)	nuh-hah-nah	to bathe, to shower
पहनना	<i>pehenna</i> (vt)	peh-hen-nah	to wear, to put on
बनाना	<i>banaanaa</i> (vt)	buh-nah-nah	to make
पकाना	<i>pakaanaa</i> (vt)	puh-kah-nah	to cook
खिलाना	<i>khilaanaa</i> (vt)	khi-lah-nah	to feed (sb)
धोना	<i>dhonaa</i> (vt)	dhoh-nah	to wash
साफ़ करना	<i>saaf karnaa</i> (vt)	sahf kur-nah	to clean
आराम करना	<i>aaraam</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	ah-rahm kur-nah	to rest

7 · Work & learning

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
करना	<i>karnaa</i> (vt)	kur-nah	to do
काम करना	<i>kaam</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	kahm kur-nah	to work
पढ़ना	<i>paRhnaa</i> (vt)	puRh-nah	to read, to study
लिखना	<i>likhnaa</i> (vt)	likh-nah	to write
सीखना	<i>seekhnaa</i> (vt)	seekh-nah	to learn
सिखाना	<i>sikhaanaa</i> (vt)	si-khah-nah	to teach (a skill)
पढ़ाना	<i>paRhaanaa</i> (vt)	puh-Rhah-nah	to teach (a subject)
कोशिश करना	<i>koshish</i> (f) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	koh-shish kur-nah	to try

8 · Perceiving & seeming

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
देखना	<i>dekhnaa</i> (vt)	daykh-nah	to see, to look, to watch
दिखना	<i>dikhnaa</i> (vi)	dikh-nah	to be visible, to look (like)
दिखाना	<i>dikhaanaa</i> (vt)	di-khah-nah	to show

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
लगना	<i>lagnaa</i> (vi)	lug-nah	to seem, to feel, to strike (Unit 10)
महसूस करना	<i>mehsoos karnaa</i> (vt)	meh-soos kur-nah	to feel (an emotion, a sensation)

9 · Hands & objects

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पकड़ना	<i>pakaRnaa</i> (vt)	puh-kuR-nah	to hold, to catch
छोड़ना	<i>chhoRnaa</i> (vt)	chhoR-nah	to leave, to let go; to drop (sb) off
रखना	<i>rakhnaa</i> (vt)	rukhnah	to put, to keep
उठाना	<i>uThaanaa</i> (vt)	u-Thah-nah	to pick up, to lift
गिरना	<i>girnaa</i> (vi)	gir-nah	to fall
गिर जाना	<i>gir jaanaa</i> (vi)	gir jah-nah	to fall down, to fall over
खोलना	<i>kholnaa</i> (vt)	khohl-nah	to open
बंद करना	<i>band karnaa</i> (vt)	bund kur-nah	to close, to switch off
तोड़ना	<i>toRnaa</i> (vt)	tohR-nah	to break
जोड़ना	<i>joRnaa</i> (vt)	johR-nah	to join, to add
डालना	<i>Daalnaa</i> (vt)	Dahl-nah	to put in, to pour
फेंकना	<i>phenknaa</i> (vt)	phay(n)k-nah	to throw
काटना	<i>kaaTnaa</i> (vt)	kahT-nah	to cut

10 · Life

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जीना	<i>jeenaa</i> (vi)	jee-nah	to live, to be alive
मरना	<i>marnaa</i> (vi)	mur-nah	to die
बनना	<i>bannaa</i> (vi)	bun-nah	to become, to get made

11 · Start, stop, finish

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
शुरू करना	<i>shuroo karnaa</i> (vt)	shu-roo kur-nah	to start (sth)
शुरू होना	<i>shuroo honaa</i> (vi)	shu-roo hoh-nah	to begin
खत्म करना	<i>khatam karnaa</i> (vt)	khuh-tum kur-nah	to finish (sth)
खत्म होना	<i>khatam honaa</i> (vi)	khuh-tum hoh-nah	to end, to run out
रुकना	<i>ruknaa</i> (vi)	ruk-nah	to stop, to wait a moment
रोकना	<i>roknaa</i> (vt)	roh-k-nah	to stop (sb/sth)

12 · Winning & losing

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पाना	<i>paanaa</i> (vt)	pah-nah	to get, to obtain; (after a stem) to manage to
जीतना	<i>jeetnaa</i> (vt)	jeet-nah	to win
हारना	<i>haarna</i> (vt, no ne)	hahr-nah	to lose (a game, a match)

13 · Laughing & crying

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
हँसना	<i>hansnaa</i> (vi)	hu(n)s-nah	to laugh
मुस्कुराना	<i>muskuraanaa</i> (vi)	mus-ku-rah-nah	to smile
रोना	<i>ronaa</i> (vi)	roh-nah	to cry
डरना	<i>Darnaa</i> (vi)	Dur-nah	to be afraid
प्यार करना	<i>pyaar</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	pyahr kur-nah	to love

14 · Everyday essentials

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खरीदना	<i>khareednaa</i> (vt)	khuh-reed-nah	to buy
बेचना	<i>bechnaa</i> (vt)	baych-nah	to sell
खोना	<i>khonaa</i> (vt, no ne)	khoh-nah	to lose (sth) (usually <i>kho jaanaa</i>)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ढूँढना	<i>DhoonDhnaa</i> (vt)	Dhoo(n)Dh-nah	to look for, to search
इंतज़ार करना	<i>intezaar</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	in-tay-zahr kur-nah	to wait (for)
मदद करना	<i>madad</i> (f) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	muh-dud kur-nah	to help
इस्तेमाल करना	<i>istemaal</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	is-tay-mahl kur-nah	to use
ज़रूरत होना	<i>zaroorat</i> (f) <i>honaa</i> (vi)	zuh-roo-rut hoh-nah	to be needed (<i>mujhe ... kee zaroorat hai</i>)
खेलना	<i>khelnaa</i> (vt)	khayl-nah	to play
गाना	<i>gaanaa</i> (vt)	gah-nah	to sing
नाचना	<i>naachnaa</i> (vi)	nahch-nah	to dance
कमाना	<i>kamaanaa</i> (vt)	kuh-mah-nah	to earn
खर्च करना	<i>kharch</i> (m) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	khurch kur-nah	to spend (money)
चलाना	<i>chalaanaa</i> (vt)	chuh-lah-nah	to drive, to run (a machine)
पहुँचाना	<i>pahunchaanaa</i> (vt)	puh-hu(n)-chah-nah	to drop (sb) somewhere, to deliver
बदलना	<i>badalnaa</i> (vt/vi)	buh-dul-nah	to change
भरना	<i>bharna</i> (vt/vi)	bhur-nah	to fill (a form, a glass)
मनाना	<i>manaanaa</i> (vt)	muh-nah-nah	to celebrate; to win (sb) over
सजाना	<i>sajaanaa</i> (vt)	suh-jah-nah	to decorate
जलाना	<i>jalaanaa</i> (vt)	juh-lah-nah	to light, to burn (sth)
ध्यान रखना	<i>dhyaan</i> (m) <i>rakhnaa</i> (vt)	dhyahn rukh-nah	to take care (of)
शादी करना	<i>shaadee</i> (f) <i>karnaa</i> (vt)	shah-dee kur-nah	to marry

The twelve MVPs in action

If you drill nothing else this week, drill these twelve: *karnaa*, *honaa*, *jaanaa*, *aanaa*, *denaa*, *lenaa*, *khaanaa*, *peenaa*, *dekhnnaa*, *bolnaa*, *milnaa*, *chaahnaa*.

तुम क्या कर रहे हो?

tum kyaa kar rahe ho? [tum kyah kur ruh-hay hoh]

What are you doing? (karnaa)

कल छुट्टी है।

kal chhuTTee hai. [kul chhuT-Tee heh]

Tomorrow is a holiday. (hona; chhuTTee f)

हम कल दिल्ली जा रहे हैं।

ham kal dillee jaa rahe hain. [hum kul dil-lee jah ruh-hay heh(n)]

We're going to Delhi tomorrow. (jaanaa)

घर जल्दी आना।

ghar jaldee aanaa. [ghur jul-dee ah-nah]

Come home early. (aanaa)

भैया, एक चाय देना।

bhaiyaa, ek chaay denaa. [bheh-yah, ayk chah-ay day-nah]

Bhaiya, give (me) one chai. (denaa)

मैं ऑटो ले लूँगा।

main auto le loongaa. [meh(n) aw-Toh lay loo(n)-gah]

I'll take an auto. (lena)

खाना खाया?

khaanaa khaayaa? [khah-nah khah-yah]

Did you eat? (khaanaa — also the noun "food", m)

पानी पियो।

paanee piyo. [pah-nee pi-yoh]

Drink water. (peena)

यह फ़ोटो देखो!

yeh foTo dekho! [yeh foh-Toh day-khoh]

Look at this photo! (dekhnaa; foTo m)

धीरे बोलो, प्लीज़।

dheere bolo, pleez. [dhee-ray boh-loh, pleez]

Speak slowly, please. (bolnaa)

कल मिलते हैं!

kal milte hain! [kul mil-tay heh(n)]

See you tomorrow! (milnaa — lit. we meet tomorrow)

मैं हिन्दी सीखना चाहता हूँ।

main hindee seekhnaa chaahtaa hoon. [meh(n) hin-dee seekh-nah chah-tah hoo(n)]

I want to learn Hindi. (chaahnaa + infinitive)

WATCH OUT

Four common transitive verbs refuse *ne* in the past: लाना, भूलना, हारना, ले जाना (*laanaa*, *bhoolnaa*, *haarna*, *le jaanaa*). Say मैं चाय लाया (*main chaay laayaa*) [meh(n) chah-ay lah-yah], NOT "*maine chaay laayaa*". With *bolnaa* and *samajhnaa* you'll hear both वो बोला (*voh bolaa*) and उसने बोला (*usne bolaa*) — both fine in Delhi.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's favorite verb trick: any English verb + *karna*. एडजस्ट कर लेंगे। (*adjust kar lenge.*) [uh-jusT kur lay(n)-gay] — we'll adjust. Also "*try karo*", "*enjoy karo*", "*miss kar rahaa thaa*", "*manage ho jaayegaa*". And notice how often Delhiites soften a verb with *lenaa/denaa*: कर लूँगा (*kar loongaa*) "I'll get it done (for myself)", बता देना (*bataa denaa*) "do let me know" — full system in Unit 19.

CULTURE

खिलाना (*khilaanaa*) [khi-lah-nah] — "to feed" — is practically a love language in Indian homes. Hosts serve you personally, refill your plate uninvited, and say और लो ना! (*aur lo naa!*) [awr loh nah] "take more!". Refusing outright can feel cold; the polished move is बस, पेट भर गया — खाना बहुत अच्छा था। (*bas, peT bhar gayaa — khaanaa bahut achchhaa thaa.*) [bus, payT bhar guh-yah — khah-nah bo-hut uch-chhah thah] "I'm full — the food was wonderful."

WITH YOUR PARTNER

1) Verb charades: act out five verbs from this chapter (no words!) — your partner calls out the Hindi infinitive, then you switch. 2) "My evening in six verbs": narrate tonight using at least six verbs (*main aayaa, maine khaanaa banaayaa...*) and let your partner fix your *ne*'s. 3) Ask your partner: तीन verbs में मुझे describe करो! (*teen verbs mein mujhe describe karo!*) — which three verbs describe you best? (*sonaa? hansnaa? khaanaa?*)

CHAPTER 16

Core Adjectives & Opposites

Adjectives come in pairs, so learn them in pairs — Delhi bargaining is basically a duel of महंगा (*mehngaa*) [mehn-gah] versus सस्ता (*sastaa*) [sus-tah]. This chapter gives you ~80 of the most useful ones, each flagged for whether it changes form or not.

NOTE

(v) = variable: -aa changes for gender/number/oblique — बड़ा लड़का, बड़े लड़के, बड़ी लड़की (*baRaa laRkaa*, *baRe laRke*, *baRee laRkee*) [buh-Rah luhR-kah, buh-Ray luhR-kay, buh-Ree luhR-kee]. (inv) = invariable: never changes — साफ़ कमरा, साफ़ चादर (*saaf kamraa*, *saaf chaadar*) [sahf kum-rah, sahf chah-dur]. Watch for the trap words ending in -aa that are still (inv)!

The adjective bank

Size & shape

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
बड़ा	<i>baRaa</i> (v)	buh-Rah	big; elder
छोटा	<i>chhoTaa</i> (v)	chhoh-Tah	small; younger; short (height)
लंबा	<i>lambaa</i> (v)	lum-bah	long; tall — for "short (person)" use <i>chhoTaa</i> , but note it can also mean "younger"
मोटा	<i>moTaa</i> (v)	moh-Tah	fat, thick
पतला	<i>patlaa</i> (v)	put-lah	thin, slim
भारी	<i>bhaaree</i> (inv)	bhah-ree	heavy
हल्का	<i>halkaa</i> (v)	hul-kah	light (weight)
ऊँचा	<i>oonchaa</i> (v)	oo(n)-chah	high, tall (things)
नीचा	<i>neechaa</i> (v)	nee-chah	low
चौड़ा	<i>chauRaa</i> (v)	chaw-Rah	wide
तंग	<i>tang</i> (inv)	tung	narrow, tight (Old Delhi lanes!)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खुला	<i>khulaa</i> (v)	khu-lah	open
बंद	<i>band</i> (inv)	bund	closed, shut
गहरा	<i>gehraa</i> (v)	geh-rah	deep (water, color, sleep)

Quality & condition

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
नया	<i>nayaa</i> (v)	nuh-yah	new (forms: नया, नए, नई <i>nayaa, nae, naee</i>)
पुराना	<i>puraanaa</i> (v)	pu-rah-nah	old (things)
अच्छा	<i>achchhaa</i> (v)	uch-chhah	good
बुरा	<i>buraa</i> (v)	bu-rah	bad
साफ़	<i>saaf</i> (inv)	sahf	clean
गंदा	<i>gandaa</i> (v)	gun-dah	dirty
सही	<i>sahee</i> (inv)	suh-hee	right, correct
गलत	<i>galat</i> (inv)	guh-lut	wrong
आसान	<i>aasaan</i> (inv)	ah-sahn	easy
मुश्किल	<i>mushkil</i> (inv)	mush-kil	difficult
महंगा	<i>mehngaa</i> (v)	mehn-gah	expensive
सस्ता	<i>sastaa</i> (v)	sus-tah	cheap
असली	<i>aslee</i> (inv)	us-lee	real, genuine
नक़ली	<i>naklee</i> (inv)	nuk-lee	fake
मज़बूत	<i>mazboot</i> (inv)	muz-boot	strong, sturdy
कमज़ोर	<i>kamzor</i> (inv)	kum-zor	weak
नरम	<i>naram</i> (inv)	nuh-rum	soft
सख़्त	<i>sakht</i> (inv)	sukht	hard, strict
गीला	<i>geelaa</i> (v)	gee-lah	wet

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सूखा	<i>sookhaa</i> (v)	soo-khah	dry
ताज़ा	<i>taazaa</i> (inv)	tah-zah	fresh (colloquially also <i>taazee</i> with f nouns)
बासी	<i>baasee</i> (inv)	bah-see	stale (food)
बढ़िया	<i>baRhiyaa</i> (inv)	buh-Rhi-yah	great, top quality (Delhi staple!)
बेकार	<i>bekaar</i> (inv)	bay-kahr	useless, no good
अजीब	<i>ajeeb</i> (inv)	uh-jeeb	strange, weird
अलग	<i>alag</i> (inv)	uh-lug	different, separate
ज़रूरी	<i>zarooree</i> (inv)	zuh-roo-ree	necessary, important

People & states

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
सुंदर	<i>sundar</i> (inv)	sun-dur	beautiful, pretty
खूबसूरत	<i>khoobsoorat</i> (inv)	khoob-soo-rut	beautiful (the Urdu-Delhi favorite)
जवान	<i>javaan</i> (inv)	juh-vahn	young
बूढ़ा	<i>booRhaa</i> (v)	boo-Rhah	old (people only — see the box)
अमीर	<i>ameer</i> (inv)	uh-meer	rich
गरीब	<i>gareeb</i> (inv)	guh-reeb	poor
मशहूर	<i>mashhoor</i> (inv)	mush-hoor	famous
व्यस्त	<i>vyast</i> (inv)	vyust	busy (Delhi mostly says बिज़ी <i>bizee</i>)
भूखा	<i>bhookhaa</i> (v)	bhoo-khah	hungry
प्यासा	<i>pyaasaa</i> (v)	pyah-sah	thirsty
होशियार	<i>hoshiyaar</i> (inv)	hoh-shi-yahr	clever, smart
शादीशुदा	<i>shaadeeshudaa</i> (inv)	shah-dee-shu-dah	married (an -aa trap: never changes)
कुँवारा	<i>kunvaaraa</i> (v)	ku(n)-vah-rah	unmarried, single

WATCH OUT

puraanaa is for things; बूढ़ा (*booRhaa*) [boo-Rhah] is for people. पुराना दोस्त (*puraanaa dost*) [pu-rah-nah dohst] = an old (long-time) friend, not an elderly one. And don't call anyone *booRhaa* to their face — the respectful word for elderly people is बुजुर्ग (*buzurg*) [bu-zurg].

Taste & temperature

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
गरम	<i>garam</i> (inv)	guh-rum	hot (temperature, not spice)
ठंडा	<i>ThanDaa</i> (v)	Thun-Dah	cold
मीठा	<i>meeThaa</i> (v)	mee-Thah	sweet
तीखा	<i>teekhaa</i> (v)	tee-khah	spicy, hot (chili)
नमकीन	<i>namkeen</i> (inv)	num-keen	salty, savory
खट्टा	<i>khaTTaa</i> (v)	khuT-Tah	sour
कड़वा	<i>kaRvaa</i> (v)	kuR-vah	bitter
फीका	<i>pheekaa</i> (v)	phee-kah	bland; weak (chai without enough of anything)
टेस्ती	<i>TesTee</i> (inv)	Tays-Tee	tasty (English loan, heard everywhere)

Speed & order

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
तेज़	<i>tez</i> (inv)	tayz	fast; sharp; strong (chili, sun, mind)
धीमा	<i>dheemaa</i> (v)	dhee-mah	slow
सीधा	<i>seedhaa</i> (v)	see-dhah	straight; direct
उल्टा	<i>ulTaa</i> (v)	ul-Tah	reverse, upside down, the wrong way
पहला	<i>pehlaa</i> (v)	peh-lah	first
आखिरी	<i>aakhiree</i> (inv)	ah-khi-ree	last, final
अगला	<i>aglaa</i> (v)	ug-lah	next
पिछला	<i>pichhlaa</i> (v)	pichh-lah	previous, last (week, month)
खतरनाक	<i>khatarnaak</i> (inv)	khuh-tur-nahk	dangerous (for "safe" Delhi just says सेफ़ <i>sef</i>)

How much? — the quantity adjectives

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
बहुत	<i>bahut</i> (inv)	bo-hut	very; a lot, many
थोड़ा	<i>thoRaa</i> (v)	thoh-Rah	a little, a bit (थोड़ा-सा <i>thoRaa-saa</i> = just a little)
कम	<i>kam</i> (inv)	kum	less, little, not enough
ज़्यादा	<i>zyaadaa</i> (inv)	zyah-dah	more; too much
काफ़ी	<i>kaafee</i> (inv)	kah-fee	enough, plenty; quite (<i>kaafee achchhaa</i> = quite good)
पूरा	<i>pooraa</i> (v)	poo-rah	full, whole, complete
आधा	<i>aadhaa</i> (v)	ah-dhah	half
सारा	<i>saaraa</i> (v)	sah-rah	all, the whole (<i>saaraa din</i> = all day)
ख़ाली	<i>khaalee</i> (inv)	khah-lee	empty; free, unoccupied
भरा (हुआ)	<i>bharaa</i> (<i>huaa</i>) (v)	bhuh-rah (hu-ah)	full, filled

WATCH OUT

"Very" is *bahut*, not *zyaadaa*. बहुत अच्छा (*bahut achchhaa*) [bo-hut uch-chhah] = very good; ज़्यादा (*zyaadaa*) usually means "too much / more": खाना ज़्यादा है। (*khaanaa zyaadaa hai.*) [khah-nah zyah-dah heh] = there's too much food. Its partner *kam* flags "too little": नमक कम है। (*namak kam hai.*) [nuh-muk kum heh] = it needs more salt. (*namak m*)

In action

यह कुर्ता थोड़ा बड़ा है — छोटा साइज़ दिखाओ।

yeh kurtaa thoRaa baRaa hai — chhoTaa saaiz dikhaao. [yeh kur-tah thoh-Rah buh-Rah heh — chhoh-Tah sah-iz di-khah-oh]

This kurta is a bit big — show me a smaller size. (kurtaa m, saaiz m)

पुरानी दिल्ली की गलियाँ तंग हैं, लेकिन खाना बढ़िया है।

puraanee dillee kee galiyaan tang hain, lekin khaanaa baRhiyaa hai. [pu-rah-nee dil-lee kee guh-li-yah(n) tung heh(n), lay-kin khah-nah buh-Rhi-yah heh]

Old Delhi's lanes are narrow, but the food is superb. (galee f, pl. galiyaan)

ये आम मीठे हैं या खट्टे?

ye aam meeThe hain yaa khaTTe? [yay ahm mee-Thai heh(n) yah khuT-Tay]

Are these mangoes sweet or sour? (aam m pl — adjectives go plural too)

चाय बहुत गरम है, ध्यान से पियो।

chaay bahut garam hai, dhyaan se piyo. [chah-ay bo-hut guh-rum heh, dhyahn say pi-yoh]

The chai is very hot — drink carefully.

मेरा फ़ोन पुराना हो गया है — अब नया लेना है।

meraa fon puraanaa ho gayaa hai — ab nayaa lenaa hai. [may-rah fohn pu-rah-nah hoh guh-yah heh — ub nuh-yah lay-nah heh]

My phone has gotten old — time to get a new one.

खाना थोड़ा तीखा है, पर बहुत टेस्टी है!

khaanaa thoRaa teekhaa hai, par bahut TesTee hai! [khah-nah thoh-Rah tee-khah heh, pur bo-hut Tays-Tee heh]

The food is a little spicy, but really tasty!

गिलास आधा भरा है या आधा खाली?

gilaas aadhaa bharaa hai yaa aadhaa khaalee? [gi-lahs ah-dhah bhuh-rah heh yah ah-dhah khah-lee]

Is the glass half full or half empty? (gilaas m)

आज सब्ज़ी ताज़ा है — कल की बासी थी।

aaj sabzee taazaa hai — kal kee baasee thee. [ahj sub-zee tah-zah heh — kul kee bah-see thee]

Today the sabzi is fresh — yesterday's was stale. (sabzee f)

मेरी हिन्दी अभी कमज़ोर है, लेकिन धीरे-धीरे अच्छी हो रही है।

merEE hindEE abhee kamzor hai, lekin dheere-dheere achchhee ho rahee hai. [may-ree hin-dee uh-bhee kum-zor heh, lay-kin dheeray dheeray uch-chhee hoh ruh-hee heh]

My Hindi is still weak, but it's slowly getting better. (hindEE f → achchhee)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi's praise ladder, bottom to top: ठीक-ठाक (*Theek-Thaak*) [Theek-Thahk] "so-so" → *achchhaa* → *baRhiyaa* → एक नंबर! (*ek nambar!*) [ayk num-bur] "first-rate!" → ज़बरदस्त (*zabardast*) [zuh-bur-dust] (full street-talk kit in Chapter 18). English adjectives get borrowed shamelessly: सिंपल (*simpal*) [sim-pul], फ्री (*free*) [free], सेफ़ (*sef*) [sayf], कूल (*kool*) [kool]. And *tez* does triple duty — fast auto, sharp kid, and strong chili: मिर्च तेज़ है! (*mirch tez hai!*) [mirch tayz heh] (*mirch f*)

CULTURE

Brace yourself: aunties and uncles comment on bodies freely. थोड़े मोटे हो गए हो! (*thoRe moTe ho gaye ho!*) [thoh-Ray moh-Tay hoh guh-yay hoh] "you've gotten a little fat!" is normal drawing-room talk — concern and affection, not insult, and the English word "healthy" is the standard euphemism for plump. Smile, don't return the favor with elders. Where adjectives do win hearts: praising the cooking. खाना बहुत बढ़िया बना है! (*khaanaa bahut baRhiyaa banaa hai!*) [khah-nah bo-hut buh-Rhi-yah buh-nah heh] will make your mother-in-law's evening.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

1) Opposites ping-pong: one of you fires an adjective from this chapter, the other shoots back the opposite within two seconds — *baRaa? chhoTaa! mehngaa? sastaa! garam? ThanDaa!* First to ten wins. 2) Point at five things around the room and describe each with two adjectives, endings and all — यह अलमारी पुरानी और भारी है। (*yeh almaaree puraanee aur bhaaree hai.*) [yeh ul-mah-ree pu-rah-nee awr bhah-ree heh] — your partner referees the agreement. 3) Dinner review: rate tonight's meal Delhi-style with at least four chapter words — *garam? teekhaa? pheekaa? baRhiyaa? ek nambar?*

CHAPTER 17

Adverbs, Postpositions & Connectors

This chapter is the glue aisle: every postposition from Book 2 on one page, then the little words that tell you when, where, and how — and the connectors Delhi drops into every second sentence: *matlab*, *vaise*, *khair*. None of these words is glamorous, but stack them up and your Hindi suddenly flows instead of hopping from noun to noun.

Postpositions — the full recap

NOTE

Reminder from Unit 7: everything before a postposition goes oblique — यह → इस, वह → उस, मेरा कमरा → मेरे कमरे में (*meraa kamraa* → *mere kamre mein*) [may-ray kum-ray may(n)]. The compound ones below are just *ke/kee* + a location word.

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
का / के / की	<i>kaa / ke / kee</i>	kah / kay / kee	of, 's (agrees like an adjective)
को	<i>ko</i>	koh	to; marks the person/thing affected
से	<i>se</i>	say	from; with (a tool); by; than
में	<i>mein</i>	may(n)	in, inside
पर	<i>par</i>	pur	on, at
तक	<i>tak</i>	tuk	until, up to, as far as
के लिए	<i>ke liye</i>	kay li-yay	for
के पास	<i>ke paas</i>	kay pahs	near; "have" (<i>mere paas ... hai</i>)
के साथ	<i>ke saath</i>	kay saht	with (a person)
के बाद	<i>ke baad</i>	kay bahd	after
से पहले	<i>se pehle</i>	say peh-lay	before
के सामने	<i>ke saamne</i>	kay sahm-nay	in front of, opposite
के पीछे	<i>ke peechhe</i>	kay pee-chhay	behind
के ऊपर	<i>ke oopar</i>	kay oo-pur	on top of, above

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
के नीचे	<i>ke neeche</i>	kay nee-chay	under, below
के अंदर	<i>ke andar</i>	kay un-dur	inside
के बाहर	<i>ke baahar</i>	kay bah-hur	outside
के बारे में	<i>ke baare mein</i>	kay bah-ray may(n)	about, concerning
की तरफ़	<i>kee taraf</i>	kee tuh-ruf	towards
की वजह से	<i>kee vajah se</i>	kee vuh-juh say	because of
के बिना	<i>ke binaa</i>	kay bi-nah	without
के अलावा	<i>ke alaavaa</i>	kay uh-lah-vah	besides, apart from

Adverbs of time

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अब	<i>ab</i>	ub	now
अभी	<i>abhee</i>	uh-bhee	right now; just now
फिर	<i>phir</i>	phir	then; again
कभी	<i>kabhee</i>	kuh-bhee	ever (कभी नहीं <i>kabhee naheen</i> = never)
कभी-कभी	<i>kabhee-kabhee</i>	kuh-bhee kuh-bhee	sometimes
हमेशा	<i>hameshaa</i>	huh-may-shah	always
अक्सर	<i>aksar</i>	uk-sur	often
रोज़	<i>roz</i>	rohz	every day
जल्दी	<i>jaldee</i>	jul-dee	quickly; early
देर से	<i>der se</i>	dayr say	late (<i>der f</i> = delay)
पहले	<i>pehle</i>	peh-lay	earlier; first; before
बाद में	<i>baad mein</i>	bahd may(n)	later, afterwards
अब तक	<i>ab tak</i>	ub tuk	until now, so far
अभी तक	<i>abhee tak</i>	uh-bhee tuk	(still not / not) yet — loves <i>naheen</i>

Adverbs of place

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
यहाँ	<i>yahaan</i>	yuh-hah(n)	here
वहाँ	<i>vahaan</i>	vuh-hah(n)	there
यहीं / वहीं	<i>yaheen / vaheen</i>	yuh-hee(n) / vuh- hee(n)	right here / right there
कहीं	<i>kaheen</i>	kuh-hee(n)	somewhere (कहीं नहीं <i>kaheen naheen</i> = nowhere)
हर जगह	<i>har jagah</i>	hur juh-guh	everywhere (<i>jagah f</i> = place)
अंदर	<i>andar</i>	un-dur	inside
बाहर	<i>baahar</i>	bah-hur	outside
ऊपर	<i>oopar</i>	oo-pur	up, upstairs
नीचे	<i>neeche</i>	nee-chay	down, downstairs
आगे	<i>aage</i>	ah-gay	ahead, forward
पीछे	<i>peechhe</i>	pee-chhay	behind, at the back
पास	<i>paas</i>	pahs	nearby, close
दूर	<i>door</i>	door	far

Manner & degree

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ऐसे	<i>aise</i>	eh-say	like this, this way
वैसे	<i>vaise</i>	veh-say	like that (for "by the way" see connectors)
धीरे	<i>dheere</i>	dhee-ray	slowly (धीरे-धीरे <i>dheere-dheere</i> = little by little)
तेज़	<i>tez</i>	tayz	fast
ज़ोर से	<i>zor se</i>	zohr say	loudly, hard (<i>zor m</i> = force)
ध्यान से	<i>dhyaan se</i>	dhyahn say	carefully
आराम से	<i>aaraam se</i>	ah-rahm say	comfortably, easily, gently

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
अचानक	<i>achaanak</i>	uh-chah-nuk	suddenly
ज़रूर	<i>zaroor</i>	zuh-roor	definitely, for sure
शायद	<i>shaayad</i>	shah-yud	maybe, perhaps
बिल्कुल	<i>bilkul</i>	bil-kul	absolutely, exactly (बिल्कुल नहीं <i>bilkul naheen</i> = not at all)
सिर्फ़	<i>sirf</i>	sirf	only
बस	<i>bas</i>	bus	just, only; enough
लगभग	<i>lagbhag</i>	lug-bhug	about, roughly
तक़रीबन	<i>takreeban</i>	tuk-ree-bun	about, roughly (Urdu-Delhi twin of <i>lagbhag</i>)

Connectors — the glue

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
और	<i>aur</i>	awr	and (also: more)
लेकिन	<i>lekin</i>	lay-kin	but
पर	<i>par</i>	pur	but (lighter; extremely common in speech)
या	<i>yaa</i>	yah	or
कि	<i>ki</i>	ki	that (<i>usne kahaa ki...</i> = he said that...)
क्योंकि	<i>kyonki</i>	kyoh(n)-ki	because
इसलिए	<i>isliye</i>	is-li-yay	so, therefore
फिर	<i>phir</i>	phir	then, next
तो	<i>to</i>	toh	so, then (also the flavor particle — Unit 24)
अगर	<i>agar</i>	uh-gur	if (<i>agar... to...</i>)
जब	<i>jab</i>	jub	when (<i>jab... tab/to...</i>)
जैसे	<i>jaise</i>	jeh-say	like, as (<i>jaise ki</i> = such as)
मतलब	<i>matlab</i> _(m)	mut-lub	meaning; "I mean..." — Delhi's favorite filler
वैसे	<i>vaise</i>	veh-say	by the way

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ख़ैर	<i>khair</i>	khehr	anyway, oh well (Urdu-Delhi; closes a topic)

In action

मैं रोज़ सुबह मेट्रो से ऑफ़िस जाता हूँ।

main roz subah meTro se aufis jaataa hoon. [meh(n) roh-z su-beh mayT-roh say aw-fis jah-tah hoo(n)]

I go to the office by metro every morning. (subah f)

वो हमेशा देर से आती है, लेकिन आज जल्दी आ गई।

voh hameshaa der se aatee hai, lekin aaj jaldee aa gae. [voh huh-may-shah dayr say ah-tee heh, lay-kin ahj jul-dee ah guh-ee]

She always comes late, but today she came early.

मेरी चाबी कहीं नहीं मिल रही।

meree chaabee kaheen naheen mil rahee. [may-ree chah-bee kuh-hee(n) nuh-hee(n) mil ruh-hee]

My key is nowhere to be found. (spoken Hindi drops hai after naheen)

मंदिर के सामने एक छोटी-सी दुकान है।

mandir ke saamne ek chhoTee-see dukaan hai. [mun-dir kay sahm-nay ayk chhoh-Tee-see du-kahn heh]

There's a little shop in front of the temple. (dukaan f)

अगर बारिश हुई, तो हम अंदर बैठेंगे।

agar baarish huee, to ham andar baiThenge. [uh-gur bah-rish hu-ee, toh hum un-dur beh-Thay(n)-gay]

If it rains, we'll sit inside.

अभी तक जवाब नहीं आया?

abhee tak javaab naheen aayaa? [uh-bhee tuk juh-vahb nuh-hee(n) ah-yah]

No reply yet?

मतलब, तुम कल नहीं आ रहे?

matlab, tum kal naheen aa rahe? [mut-lub, tum kul nuh-hee(n) ah ruh-hay]

Meaning... you're not coming tomorrow?

खैर, छोड़ो — पहले चाय पियो।

khair, chhoRo — pehle chaay piyo. [khehr, chhoh-Roh — peh-lay chah-ay pi-yoh]

Anyway, drop it — first have your chai.

काम के बाद हम बाहर खाना खाएँगे।

kaam ke baad ham baahar khaanaa khaaenge. [kahm kay bahd hum bah-hur khah-nah khah-ay(n)-gay]

After work we'll eat out.

यह जगह बिल्कुल घर जैसी है।

yeh jagah bilkul ghar jaisee hai. [yeh juh-guh bil-kul ghur jeh-see heh]

This place is exactly like home. (jaisee agrees with jagah f)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Three connectors run every Delhi conversation. *matlab* buys thinking time and rephrases: मतलब, कहना ये है कि... (*matlab, kehnaa ye hai ki...*) [mut-lub, keh-nah yay heh ki] "I mean, the point is that...". *vaise* pivots to gossip: वैसे, सुना तुमने? (*vaise, sunaa tumne?*) [veh-say, su-nah tum-nay] "by the way, did you hear?". *khair* closes a chapter with a sigh: खैर, जो हुआ सो हुआ। (*khair, jo huaa so huaa.*) [khehr, joh hu-ah soh hu-ah] "anyway, what's done is done." Bonus: Delhi English swallows *ki* whole — "I told him *ki* don't be late."

CULTURE

Time words in India are elastic — say hello to Indian Stretchable Time. अभी आया। (*abhee aayaa.*) [uh-bhee ah-yah] "just coming" can mean twenty minutes; बस पाँच मिनट (*bas paanch minaaT*) [bus pah(n)ch mi-nuT] is a unit of hope, not of time. Remember from Chapter 5 that *kal* is both yesterday and tomorrow, and *parson* both two days ago and two days ahead — the verb tense decides. If a Delhi dinner invitation says 8 o'clock, arriving at 8 sharp means helping your hosts set the table.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

1) Postposition hunt: describe where five things in the room are, each with a different postposition — फ़ोन तकिये के नीचे है। (*fon takiye ke neeche hai.*) [fohn tuh-ki-yay kay nee-chay heh] — then let your partner quiz you: *chaabee kahaan hai?* 2) Habit interview: ask each other about routines and answer only with *hameshaa / aksar / kabhee-kabhee / kabhee naheen* — do the answers match what your partner thinks? 3) The *agar...to* game: trade five silly hypotheticals — अगर करोड़ रुपये मिलें, तो? (*agar karoR rupaye milen, to?*) [uh-gur kuh-rohR ru-puh-yay mi-lay(n), toh] — and answer in Hindi.

CHAPTER 18

Delhi Street Talk — Slang & Fillers

Grammar makes you understood; this chapter makes you sound like you actually live in Delhi. Everything here is current, everyday, and clean — the words friends toss across a chai stall, not anything that will get you in trouble. One rule before you start: all of it is informal. Friends and your partner, yes; elders, in-laws, and your boss, no — the culture box at the end draws the exact line.

Calling people

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING & USAGE
यार	<i>yaar</i> (m)	yahr	dude, man, buddy — ends half of Delhi's sentences (<i>chalo yaar, naheen yaar</i>)
भाई	<i>bhaaee</i> (m)	bhah-ee	bro — friends, cousins, any guy your age (shopkeepers get <i>bhaiyaa</i>)
हाँ भाई	<i>haan bhaaee</i>	hah(n) bhah-ee	"yes bro" — hello / so, what's up; opens phone calls
बंदा	<i>bandaa</i> (m)	bun-dah	guy (f: बंदी <i>bandee</i> [bun-dee] girl) — <i>achchhaa bandaa hai</i> = he's a good guy
अरे	<i>arre</i>	uh-ray	hey! oh! — grabs attention, starts half of all sentences
ओए	<i>oye</i>	oh-ay	oi! — CLOSE friends only; never strangers, never elders
ओए होए!	<i>oye hoye!</i>	oh-ay hoh-ay	ooh la la! — teasing someone who's dressed up or blushing
पागल	<i>paagal</i>	pah-gul	silly, crazy — affectionate between friends and couples (<i>paagal hai tu!</i>)

Yes, right, wow — agreement & praise

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING & USAGE
हाँ जी	<i>haan jee</i>	hah(n) jee	warm yes — the one item here that's safe with absolutely everyone
ठीक है जी	<i>Theek hai jee</i>	Theek heh jee	"okay then" — warm, slightly wry sign-off

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING & USAGE
पक्का	<i>pakkaa</i>	puk-kah	for sure, confirmed — <i>pakkaa na?</i> = promise?
सही है!	<i>sahee hai!</i>	suh-hee heh	nice, right on, fair enough — the all-purpose approval
क्या बात है!	<i>kyaa baat hai!</i>	kyah baht heh	wow, beautiful! — THE compliment reaction
ज़बरदस्त	<i>zabardast</i>	zuh-bur- dust	smashing, awesome
मस्त	<i>mast</i>	must	great, lovely, chilled — <i>mast hai yaar</i>
कमाल	<i>kamaal</i> (m)	kuh-mahl	<i>kamaal hai!</i> = unbelievable; <i>kamaal kaa</i> = amazing (<i>kamaal kaa khaanaa</i>)
ग़ज़ब	<i>gazab</i> (m)	guh-zub	<i>gazab!</i> = incredible, killer
एकदम	<i>ekdum</i>	ayk-dum	totally, completely — <i>ekdum sahee, ekdum fresh</i>
बिंदास	<i>bindaas</i>	bin-dahs	carefree, bold; also "go right ahead" (<i>poochho? bindaas poochho!</i>)

अच्छा — one word, five meanings

You met अच्छा (*achchhaa*) [uch-chhah] as "good." In conversation it's a Swiss Army knife — the tone does all the work:

TONE	हिन्दी	IT MEANS	SITUATION
flat, short	अच्छा।	OK, got it	acknowledging an instruction
pitch jumps up	अच्छा?!	really?!	reacting to news
long and slow	अच्छा...	ohhh, I see...	the penny finally drops
sharp, clipped	अच्छा!	oh right!	suddenly remembering (<i>achchhaa! doodh laanaa thaa</i>)
sing-song, eyebrow up	अच्छा जी?	oh really, is that so?	teasing challenge — big with couples

Moving things along

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING & USAGE
चलो	<i>chalo</i>	chuh-loh	let's go; also "fine, okay then" (<i>chalo, Theek hai</i>)
चल	<i>chal</i>	chul	c'mon; also "yeah right, come off it" (<i>chal, jhooTh mat bol</i>) — very close friends only
चल ना	<i>chal naa</i>	chul nah	come onnn — the wheedle that gets people out of the house
बस	<i>bas</i>	bus	enough, that's it — <i>bas bas!</i> = stop pouring!
हो गया	<i>ho gayaa</i>	hoh guh-yah	done, that's that — <i>ho gayaa?</i> = all done?
और बताओ	<i>aur bataao</i>	awr buh-tah-oh	"so, what else?" — keeps a conversation from ever ending
क्या सीन है?	<i>kyaa seen hai?</i>	kyah seen heh	what's the plan? what's happening?

The great Delhi words

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING & USAGE
जुगाड़	<i>jugaaR</i> (m)	ju-gahR	the clever workaround — see below, it deserves a paragraph
सेटिंग	<i>seTing</i> (f)	say-Ting	an "arrangement" — inside contact, connection (<i>meree seTing hai</i> = I know a guy)
वेल्ला	<i>vellaa</i> (v)	vayl-lah	idle, loafing — Delhi's proudest state of being (f: <i>vellee</i>)
टाइमपास	<i>Taimpaas</i> (m)	Tah-im-pahs	time-killing fun; light fluff (the classic movie review: <i>Theek hai, Taimpaas hai</i>)
फ़ालतू	<i>faaltoo</i>	fahl-too	useless, pointless; <i>faaltoo mein</i> = for no reason
फ़ंडा	<i>funDaa</i> (m)	fun-Dah	concept, personal theory — <i>simpal funDaa hai...</i>
पंगा	<i>pangaa</i> (m)	pun-gah	trouble, a run-in; <i>pangaa lenaa</i> = to pick a fight (<i>pangaa mat lo</i>)
बकवास	<i>bakvaas</i> (f)	buk-vahs	nonsense, rubbish — <i>film bakvaas thee; bakvaas band karo</i> (friends only)

जुगाड़ (*jugaaR*) [ju-gahR] is Delhi's national sport: fixing the problem with whatever is on hand — a phone call, a spare wire, a friend's friend, sheer nerve. A cooler bolted onto a bicycle is *jugaaR*; sold-out tickets appearing "through a contact" is *jugaaR*; so is your landlord's TV antenna made from a cooking pot. The verbs are *jugaaR karnaa* and *jugaaR lagaanaa*, and the word is half compliment, half national confession — Delhiites say it with real pride.

Chill, Delhi-style

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING & USAGE
टेंशन मत लो यार	<i>Tenshan mat lo yaar</i>	Tayn-shun mut loh yahr	relax, don't stress — the city's unofficial motto
चिल मार	<i>chil maar</i>	chil mahr	chill out — <i>chil maar yaar, sab Theek hai</i>
सब सेट है	<i>sab seT hai</i>	sub sayT heh	everything's sorted, all arranged

In action — the top twelve

यार, बहुत भूख लगी है — कुछ खाते हैं?

yaar, bahut bhookh lagee hai — kuchh khaate hain? [yahr, bo-hut bhookh luh-gee heh — kuchh khah-tay heh(n)]

Yaar, I'm starving — shall we eat something?

हाँ भाई, क्या हाल है? — बस, मस्त।

haan bhaaee, kyaa haal hai? — bas, mast. [hah(n) bhah-ee, kyah hahl heh? — bus, must]

Hey bro, how's it going? — Just great.

अच्छा जी? तो कल रात कहाँ थे आप?

achchhaa jee? to kal raat kahaan the aap? [uch-chhah jee? toh kul raht kuh-hah(n) thay ahp]

Oh really? So where were YOU last night? (the teasing aap — couples' specialty)

पक्का आओगे ना? — हाँ यार, पक्का!

pakkaa aaoge naa? — haan yaar, pakkaa! [puk-kah ah-oh-gay nah? — hah(n) yahr, puk-kah]

You'll definitely come, right? — Yes yaar, hundred percent!

क्या बात है! नई शर्ट में हीरो लग रहे हो!

kyaa baat hai! naee sharT mein heero lag rahe ho! [kyah baht heh! nuh-ee shurT may(n) hee-roh lug ruh-hay hoh]

Look at that! You're looking like a film hero in the new shirt! (sharT f)

कल का डिनर ज़बरदस्त था, एकदम ज़बरदस्त।

kal kaa Dinar zabardast thaa, ekdum zabardast. [kul kah Di-nur zuh-bur-dust thah, ayk-dum zuh-bur-dust]

Yesterday's dinner was awesome, totally awesome. (Dinar m — English loan)

चल ना यार, वहाँ मज़ा आएगा।

chal naa yaar, vahaan mazaa aayegaa. [chul nah yahr, vuh-hah(n) muh-zah ah-ay-gah]

Come onnn yaar, it'll be fun there.

और भाई, वीकेंड का क्या सीन है?

aur bhaaee, veekenD kaa kyaa seen hai? [awr bhah-ee, vee-kaynD kah kyah seen heh]

So bro, what's the scene this weekend? (veekenD m)

कोई जुगाड़ करो यार, टिकट चाहिए ही चाहिए।

koee jugaaR karo yaar, TikaT chaahiye hee chaahiye. [koh-ee ju-gahR kuh-roh yahr, Ti-kuT chah-hi-yay hee chah-hi-yay]

Work some jugaad, yaar — we absolutely have to get tickets.

आज मैं एकदम वेल्ला हूँ — कोई काम नहीं।

aaj main ekdum vellaa hoon — koee kaam naheen. [ahj meh(n) ayk-dum vayl-lah hoo(n) — koh-ee kahm nuh-hee(n)]

I'm completely vella today — nothing to do.

फ़िल्म कैसी थी? — यार, पूरी बकवास।

film kaisee thee? — yaar, pooree bakvaas. [film keh-see thee? — yahr, poo-ree buk-vahs]

How was the movie? — Total rubbish, yaar. (film f, bakvaas f → pooree)

टेंशन मत लो यार, चिल मारो — सब सेट है।

Tenshan mat lo yaar, chil maaro — sab seT hai. [Tayn-shun mut loh yahr, chil mah-roh — sub sayT heh]

Don't stress yaar, chill — it's all sorted.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi slang wears its Punjabi heart openly — *oye, vellaa, pangaa* all came up the Grand Trunk Road. The other engine is English: Delhi will verb anything — *chil maarnaa, bank maarnaa* [bunk mahr-nah] (to skip class), *seT karnaa, scene banaanaa*. And don't fear sounding dated: slang fashion changes, but this chapter is the evergreen core — *yaar* has been cool since your in-laws were in college.

CULTURE

Slang is a register, not just vocabulary. With friends and your partner, every word here signals warmth; with elders and in-laws, the same words signal disrespect. Hard rules: never *oye*, never bare *chal*, never *yaar* to your *saas-sasur*; with them it's जी हाँ (*jee haan*) [jee hah(n)], *aap*, and full sentences. The one safe crossover is *jee* itself — *haan jee*, *Theek hai jee* — which makes everything respectful. When unsure, listen to your partner's register and stay one notch politer.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

1) Watch one scene of a Delhi film or web series together and count the *yaars* and *achchhaas* — loser buys chai. 2) The *achchhaa* drill: your partner says अच्छा five ways (flat, surprised, slow, sharp, teasing); you call out which meaning each one was — then swap. 3) Plan Saturday using only this chapter: *kyaa seen hai?* — *main to vellaa hoon.* — *chal naa, kaheen chalte hain.* — *pakkaa?* — *pakkaa. ho gayaa, seT hai.*

CHAPTER 19

Love & Affection

This chapter is for the two of you. Hindi sweet-talk runs from film-song poetry down to the world's most practical love language — खाना खाया? (*khaanaa khaayaa?*) [khah-nah khah-yah] "have you eaten?" — and Delhi couples mix English into all of it without blinking. Here are the pet names, the compliments, the big sentence, and the two verbs every couple needs: *rooThnaa* and *manaanaa*.

Pet names

Private vocabulary — for the two of you, not for the dinner table with elders (see the culture box).

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जान	<i>jaan</i> (f)	jahn	darling (literally: life)
मेरी जान	<i>meree jaan</i>	may-ree jahn	my love, my life
जानू	<i>jaanoo</i>	jah-noo	sweetie (<i>jaan</i> , made cuter)
बाबू	<i>baaboo</i>	bah-boo	babe — yes, grown adults; extremely common
बेबी	<i>bebee</i>	bay-bee	baby — English, fully adopted
शोना	<i>shonaa</i>	shoh-nah	sweetie, "goldie" (from <i>sonaa</i> = gold)

Love words

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
प्यार	<i>pyaar</i> (m)	pyahr	love — the everyday word
मोहब्बत	<i>mohabbat</i> (f)	moh-hub-but	love — Urdu-Delhi, a shade deeper and more romantic
इश्क़	<i>ishq</i> (m)	ishq	love — poetic and passionate; lives in ghazals and film songs, use it for effect, not errands
दिल	<i>dil</i> (m)	dil	heart (<i>dil se</i> = from the heart)
याद	<i>yaad</i> (f)	yahd	memory; the missing of someone
वादा	<i>vaadaa</i> (m)	vah-dah	promise

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
रिश्ता	<i>rishtaa</i> (m)	rish-tah	relationship, bond
नोक-झोंक	<i>nok-jhonk</i> (f)	nohk-jhoh(n)k	playful bickering — the sign of a healthy Delhi couple
हमेशा के लिए	<i>hameshaa ke liye</i>	huh-may-shah kay li-yay	forever

Saying it

PATTERN	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
मैं तुमसे प्यार करता हूँ।	<i>main tumse pyaar kartaa hoon.</i>	meh(n) tum-say pyahr kur-tah hoo(n)	I love you (Jacob speaking)
मैं भी तुमसे प्यार करती हूँ।	<i>main bhee tumse pyaar kartee hoon.</i>	meh(n) bhee tum-say pyahr kur-tee hoo(n)	I love you too (her reply — female form)
तुम मुझे बहुत पसंद हो।	<i>tum mujhe bahut pasand ho.</i>	tum mu-jhay bo-hut puh-sund hoh	I really like you
तुम्हारी याद आ रही है।	<i>tumhaaree yaad aa rahee hai.</i>	tum-hah-ree yahd ah ruh-hee heh	I miss you (right now) (lit. your memory is coming)
मैं तुम्हें मिस कर रहा था।	<i>main tumhen mis kar rahaa thaa.</i>	meh(n) tum-hay(n) mis kur ruh-hah thah	I was missing you — Delhi happily mixes in English
तुम मेरी जान हो।	<i>tum meree jaan ho.</i>	tum may-ree jahn hoh	you are my life

Compliments

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
तुम बहुत सुंदर लग रही हो।	<i>tum bahut sundar lag rahee ho.</i>	tum bo-hut sun-dur lug ruh-hee hoh	you're looking beautiful (to her)
तुम बहुत अच्छे लग रहे हो।	<i>tum bahut achchhe lag rahe ho.</i>	tum bo-hut uch-chhay lug ruh-hay hoh	you're looking great (to him)
क्या बात है!	<i>kyaa baat hai!</i>	kyah baht heh	wow, look at you! (when your partner dresses up)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
यह रंग तुम पर बहुत अच्छा लग रहा है।	<i>yeh rang tum par bahut achchhaa lag rahaa hai.</i>	yeh rung tum pur bo-hut uch-chhah lug ruh-hah heh	this color looks great on you (<i>rang m</i>)
तुम्हारी मुस्कान बहुत प्यारी है।	<i>tumhaaree muskaan (f) bahut pyaaree hai.</i>	tum-hah-ree mus-kahn bo-hut pyah-ree heh	your smile is lovely

The real love language

In an Indian relationship, "I love you" is said daily — just usually disguised as food and logistics:

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
खाना खाया?	<i>khaanaa khaayaa?</i>	khah-nah khah-yah	have you eaten? — functionally "I love you"
घर पहुँच के बताना।	<i>ghar pahunch ke bataanaa.</i>	ghur puh-hu(n)ch kay buh-tah-nah	let me know when you reach home
ध्यान रखना।	<i>dhyaan rakhnaa.</i>	dhyahn rukh-nah	take care (of yourself)
आराम करो।	<i>aaraam karo.</i>	ah-rahm kuh-roh	get some rest
मैं हूँ ना।	<i>main hoon naa.</i>	meh(n) hoo(n) nah	I'm here, no? — don't worry, you have me

Couple verbs

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
रूठना	<i>rooThnaa (vi)</i>	rooTh-nah	to sulk, to be miffed (usually <i>rooTh jaanaa</i>)
मनाना	<i>manaanaa (vt)</i>	muh-nah-nah	to win (someone) back with sweetness — the cure for <i>rooThnaa</i>
गले लगाना	<i>gale lagaanaa (vt)</i>	guh-lay luh-gah-nah	to hug (गले लग जाओ <i>gale lag jaao</i> = come here, hug)
हाथ पकड़ना	<i>haath (m) pakaRnaa (vt)</i>	hahth puh-kuR-nah	to hold hands
तारीफ़ करना	<i>taareef (f) karnaa (vt)</i>	tah-reef kur-nah	to compliment, to praise

NOTE

The *rooThnaa-manaanaa* cycle is the plot of half of Bollywood and most real couples: one sulks charmingly, the other brings chai, compliments, and apologies until peace returns. It's practically a hobby — learn both verbs as a pair.

In action

मैं तुमसे बहुत प्यार करता हूँ।

main tumse bahut pyaar kartaa hoon. [meh(n) tum-say bo-hut pyahr kur-tah hoo(n)]

I love you very much.

मैं भी तुमसे प्यार करती हूँ।

main bhee tumse pyaar kartee hoon. [meh(n) bhee tum-say pyahr kur-tee hoo(n)]

I love you too. (her reply — kartee)

तुम्हारी बहुत याद आ रही है।

tumhaaree bahut yaad aa rahee hai. [tum-hah-ree bo-hut yahd ah ruh-hee heh]

I'm really missing you.

मैं तुम्हें पूरा दिन मिस कर रहा था।

main tumhen pooraa din mis kar rahaa thaa. [meh(n) tum-hay(n) poo-rah din mis kur ruh-hah thah]

I was missing you all day.

तुम आज बहुत सुंदर लग रही हो।

tum aaj bahut sundar lag rahee ho. [tum ahj bo-hut sun-dur lug ruh-hee hoh]

You're looking really beautiful today.

अरे वाह — तुम बहुत अच्छे लग रहे हो!

arre vaah — tum bahut achchhe lag rahe ho! [uh-ray vah — tum bo-hut uch-chhay lug ruh-hay hoh]

Oh wow — you're looking very handsome! (her to him)

खाना खाया? घर पहुँच के बताना।

khaanaa khaayaa? ghar pahunch ke bataanaa. [khah-nah khah-yah? ghur puh-hu(n)ch kay buh-tah-nah]

Did you eat? Text me when you reach home. (= I love you, twice)

जानू रूठ गई है — अब उसे मनाना पड़ेगा।

jaanoo rooTh gaee hai — ab use manaanaa paRegaa. [jah-noo rooTh guh-ee heh — ub u-say muh-nah-nah puh-Ray-gah]

Jaanu is sulking — now I'll have to win her back.

वादा करो, हमेशा साथ रहोगे।

vaadaa karo, hameshaa saath rahoge. [vah-dah kuh-roh, huh-may-shah saath ruh-hoh-gay]

Promise me you'll always stay with me.

इधर आओ, गले लग जाओ।

idhar aao, gale lag jaa. [i-dhur ah-oh, guh-lay lug jah-oh]

Come here — give me a hug. (idhar = over here)

DELHI STREET NOTE

Delhi couple-speak is Hinglish at its purest: "I love you yaar", *mis kar rahaa thaa*, "tum cute lag rahee ho", चलो, डेट पे चलते हैं। (*chalo, DeT pe chalte hain.*) [chuh-loh, DayT pay chul-tay heh(n)] — note Delhi's *pe* for *par*. The cheapest sweetness upgrade is tacking *naa* onto requests: रुको ना... (*ruko naa...*) [ru-koh nah] "staaay, no?". Even the fights are Hinglish: "pehle tum sorry bolo!"

CULTURE

Public affection in India is modest: hand-holding in malls and parks is normal for couples now, but kissing in public is not done, and in front of parents or in-laws even a hug between partners is unusual — affection there flows through care instead: serving food, *khaanaa khaayaa?*, *dhyaan rakhnaa*. Pet names are private too — *meree jaan* lands beautifully at home and lands you teasing for a decade if the cousins hear it. Traditionally many couples wouldn't even say each other's first names in front of elders; modern Delhi is relaxed, but you'll still hear a spouse summoned with just सुनो! (*suno!*) [su-noh] "listen!"

WITH YOUR PARTNER

1) Pick pet names for each other from the table and use them all evening — first one to slip back to real names makes the chai. 2) Compliment volley: three compliments each from this chapter, with the right endings (*lag rahee ho / lag rahe ho*) — the listener referees the grammar before saying *shukriyaa*. 3) Drama practice: one of you pretends to *rooTh* (arms crossed, face turned); the other has to *manaao* using at least three lines from this chapter. Swap roles. No laughing — okay, some laughing.

CHAPTER 20

Festivals & Occasions

Delhi's year is a festival relay: दिवाली (*divaalee*) [di-vah-lee] lights in autumn, colors at होली (*holee*) [hoh-lee] in spring, Eid crowds at Jama Masjid, and wedding bands blocking traffic all winter. This chapter gives you the words for every big त्योहार (*tyohaar*) [tyoh-hahr], the greetings people actually say, and the two customs that will make you the favorite son-in-law: the sweets box and touching feet.

दिवाली (*divaalee*) — the festival of lights

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
त्योहार	<i>tyohaar</i> (m)	tyoh-hahr	festival
दिवाली	<i>divaalee</i> (f)	di-vah-lee	Diwali (October–November; cards say दीपावली <i>deepaavalee</i>)
दीया	<i>deeyaa</i> (m)	dee-yah	little oil lamp (pl. दीये <i>deeye</i>)
मिठाई	<i>miThaaee</i> (f)	mi-Thah-ee	sweets
पटाखा	<i>paTaakhaa</i> (m)	puh-Tah-khah	firecracker (pl. पटाखे <i>paTaakhe</i>)
लक्ष्मी पूजा	<i>lakshmee poojaa</i> (f)	luksh-mee poo-jah	the Lakshmi worship on Diwali night
सफ़ाई	<i>safaaee</i> (f)	suh-fah-ee	cleaning — the great pre-Diwali scrub-down of the whole house
रंगोली	<i>rangolee</i> (f)	run-goh-lee	colored floor design at the doorway

होली (*holee*) — the festival of colors

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
होली	<i>holee</i> (f)	hoh-lee	Holi (March)
रंग	<i>rang</i> (m)	rung	color
गुलाल	<i>gulaal</i> (m)	gu-lahl	the dry colored powder
पिचकारी	<i>pichkaaree</i> (f)	pich-kah-ree	water gun

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ठंडाई	<i>ThanDaaee</i> (f)	Thun-Dah-ee	spiced milk-and-almond drink of Holi
बुरा न मानो, होली है!	<i>buraa na maano, holee hai!</i>	bu-rah nuh mah-noh, hoh-lee heh	"don't mind — it's Holi!" (the all-purpose Holi excuse)

राखी और करवा चौथ (raakhee aur karvaa chauth)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
रक्षाबंधन	<i>rakshaabandhan</i> (m)	ruk-shah-bun-dhun	Rakshabandhan (August) — everyone just says राखी
राखी	<i>raakhee</i> (f)	rah-khee	the thread a sister ties on her brother's wrist
करवा चौथ	<i>karvaa chauth</i> (m)	kur-vah chawth	autumn fast wives keep for their husbands
व्रत	<i>vrat</i> (m)	vrut	fast (<i>vrat rakhnaa</i> = to keep a fast)
चाँद	<i>chaand</i> (m)	chah(n)d	moon — the karvaa chauth fast opens only at moonrise

NOTE

Karvaa chauth is a couples' festival at heart — she fasts sunrise to moonrise, dresses up, and the first sip of water comes looking at the moon and then at her husband. Plenty of modern Delhi husbands now keep the fast alongside their wives. If your partner keeps it, मैं भी तुम्हारे साथ व्रत रखूँगा। (*main bhee tumhaare saath vrat rakhoongaa.*) [meh(n) bhee tum-hah-ray sahth vrut ruh-khoo(n)-gah] is about the most romantic sentence in this book.

ईद (eed)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ईद	<i>eed</i> (f)	eed	Eid
मस्जिद	<i>masjid</i> (f)	mus-jid	mosque — Delhi's जामा मस्जिद <i>jaamaa masjid</i> overflows on Eid morning
सेवइयाँ	<i>sevaiyaan</i> (f pl)	say-vai-yah(n)	the sweet vermicelli of Eid

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
ईदी	<i>eedee</i> (f)	ee-dee	Eid money/gift for the youngsters
इफ़्तार	<i>iftaar</i> (m)	if-tahr	the evening fast-breaking meal in the month of <i>ramzaan</i>

नवरात्रे, दशहरा और छठ (navraatre, dashehrraa aur chhaTh)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
नवरात्रे	<i>navraatre</i> (m pl)	nuv-raht-ray	Navratri, the nine nights of the Goddess (Delhi says <i>navraatre</i> ; standard is नवरात्रि <i>navraatri</i>)
दशहरा	<i>dashehrraa</i> (m)	duh-sheh-rah	Dussehra, the day good defeats evil
रावण	<i>raavaN</i> (m)	rah-vuN	Ravan — his giant effigies burn at Dussehra
पुतला	<i>putlaa</i> (m)	put-lah	effigy
रामलीला	<i>raamleelaa</i> (f)	rahm-lee-lah	the Ram story staged over ten nights — Old Delhi's is legendary
छठ	<i>chhaTh</i> (f)	chhuTh	Chhath — sun-worship festival Delhi's Purvanchali families celebrate at the Yamuna ghats

जन्मदिन (janmdin) — birthdays

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
जन्मदिन	<i>janmdin</i> (m)	juh-num-din	birthday (Delhi says बर्थडे <i>barthDe</i> just as often)
केक काटना	<i>kek</i> (m) <i>kaaTnaa</i>	kayk kahT-nah	to cut the cake — the centerpiece ritual, cameras out
पार्टी	<i>paarTee</i> (f)	pahr-Tee	party (<i>paarTee kab de rahe ho?</i> = so when are you treating us?)
तोहफ़ा	<i>tohfaa</i> (m)	toh-fah	gift, present (Delhi also just says गिफ़्ट <i>gifT</i>)

शादी (shaadee) — the big fat Delhi wedding

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
शादी	<i>shaadee</i> (f)	shah-dee	wedding, marriage (<i>vivaah</i> is the formal word on invitation cards)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दूल्हा	<i>doolhaa</i> (m)	dool-hah	groom
दुल्हन	<i>dulhan</i> (f)	dul-hun	bride
बारात	<i>baaraat</i> (f)	bah-raht	the groom's procession — brass band, dancing, traffic jam
घोड़ी	<i>ghoRee</i> (f)	ghoh-Ree	the mare the groom rides in on
मेहंदी	<i>mehndee</i> (f)	meh(n)-dee	henna; the mehndi ceremony
संगीत	<i>sangeet</i> (m)	sun-geet	the music-and-dance night before the wedding
फेरे	<i>phere</i> (m pl)	phay-ray	the seven rounds of the sacred fire — the actual "I do"
लहंगा	<i>lehngaa</i> (m)	leh(n)-gah	the bride's heavy embroidered skirt outfit
शेरवानी	<i>shervaanee</i> (f)	shayr-vah-nee	the groom's long formal coat
कार्ड	<i>kaarD</i> (m)	kahrD	the wedding invitation — <i>shaadee kaa kaarD</i>

मंदिर और पूजा (mandir aur poojaa)

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
पूजा	<i>poojaa</i> (f)	poo-jah	worship, prayer ritual (also at home)
मंदिर	<i>mandir</i> (m)	mun-dir	temple
प्रसाद	<i>prasaad</i> (m)	pruh-sahd	blessed food shared after worship — accept with the right hand
आरती	<i>aartee</i> (f)	ahr-tee	the lamp-waving prayer song
भगवान	<i>bhagvaan</i> (m)	bhug-vahn	God
आशीर्वाद	<i>aasheervaad</i> (m)	ah-sheer-vahd	blessing — what elders give when you touch their feet

Greetings people actually say

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
हैप्पी दिवाली!	<i>haippee divaaalee!</i>	heh-pee di-vah-lee	what 90% of Delhi actually says

हिन्दी	ROMAN	SAY IT	MEANING
दिवाली मुबारक!	<i>divaalee mubaarak!</i>	di-vah-lee mu- bah-ruk	happy Diwali! (<i>mubaarak</i> works after any occasion word)
शुभ दीपावली	<i>shubh deepaavalee</i>	shubh dee-pah- vuh-lee	formal version — printed on cards and sweet boxes
होली मुबारक!	<i>holee mubaarak!</i>	hoh-lee mu-bah- ruk	happy Holi!
ईद मुबारक!	<i>eed mubaarak!</i>	eed mu-bah-ruk	Eid Mubarak!
जन्मदिन मुबारक!	<i>janmdin mubaarak!</i>	juh-num-din mu- bah-ruk	happy birthday!
शादी मुबारक!	<i>shaadee mubaarak!</i>	shah-dee mu- bah-ruk	congratulations on the wedding!
नया साल मुबारक!	<i>nayaa saal (m) mubaarak!</i>	nuh-yah sahl mu- bah-ruk	happy new year!
आपको भी!	<i>aapko bhee!</i>	ahp-koh bhee	same to you! — the reply you'll need within seconds

In action

दिवाली पर हम दीये जलाएँगे और मिठाई बाँटेंगे।

divaalee par ham deeye jalaaenge aur miThaaee baanTenge. [di-vah-lee pur hum dee-yay juh-lah-ay(n)-gay awr mi-Thah-ee bah(n)-Tay(n)-gay]

On Diwali we'll light lamps and hand out sweets. (*baanTnaa* = to distribute)

कल लक्ष्मी पूजा है — आज घर की सफ़ाई करनी है।

kal lakshmee poojaa hai — aaj ghar kee safaaee karnee hai. [kul luksh-mee poo-jah heh — ahj ghur kee suh-fah-ee kur-nee heh]

Tomorrow is the Lakshmi puja — today the house has to be cleaned.

होली पर सब एक-दूसरे को रंग लगाते हैं।

holee par sab ek-doosre ko rang lagaate hain. [hoh-lee pur sub ayk-doos-ray koh rung luh-gah-tay heh(n)]

On Holi everyone puts color on each other.

राखी पर बहन भाई को राखी बाँधती है।

raakhee par behen bhaaee ko raakhee baandhtee hai. [rah-khee pur beh-hen bhah-ee koh rah-khee bah(n)dh-tee heh]

On Rakhi, a sister ties a rakhi on her brother. (baandhnaa = to tie)

मैं भी तुम्हारे साथ व्रत रखूँगा।

main bhee tumhaare saath vrat rakhoongaa. [meh(n) bhee tum-hah-ray sahth vrut ruh-khoo(n)-gah]

I'll keep the fast with you too. (karvaa chauth points: maximum)

ईद पर पुरानी दिल्ली में सेवइयाँ ज़रूर खाना।

eed par puraanee dillee mein sevaiyaan zaroor khaanaa. [eed pur pu-rah-nee dil-lee may(n) say-vai-yah(n) zuh-roor khah-nah]

On Eid, definitely eat sevaiyaan in Old Delhi.

दशहरे पर रावण का पुतला जलता है।

dashehre par raavaN kaa putlaa jaltaa hai. [duh-sheh-ray pur rah-vuN kah put-lah jul-tah heh]

At Dussehra, Ravan's effigy goes up in flames. (jalnaa vi = to burn)

जन्मदिन मुबारक! चलो, केक काटो!

janmdin mubaarak! chalo, kek kaaTo! [juh-num-din mu-bah-ruk! chuh-loh, kayak kah-Toh]

Happy birthday! Come on, cut the cake!

दूल्हा घोड़ी पर आता है और बाराती नाचते हैं।

doolhaa ghoree par aataa hai aur baaraatee naachte hain. [dool-hah ghoh-Ree pur ah-tah heh awr bah-rah-tee nahch-tay heh(n)]

The groom arrives on a mare and the baraat guests dance. (baaraatee m = procession member)

आंटी जी, आपको और पूरे परिवार को दिवाली मुबारक!

aanTee jee, aapko aur poore parivaar ko divaalee mubaarak! [ahn-Tee jee, ahp-koh awr poo-ray puh-ri-vahr koh di-vah-lee mu-bah-ruk]

Aunty ji, happy Diwali to you and the whole family! (parivaar m)

CULTURE

Festival season runs on *miThaaee*: nobody crosses a doorstep empty-handed in Diwali week. The standard offering is a डिब्बा (*Dibbaa*) [Dib-bah] — a box — of sweets or dry fruits, handed over with both hands; काजू कतली (*kaajoo katlee*) [kah-joo kut-lee] is the undisputed crowd-pleaser. The boxes circulate so vigorously that Delhi jokes the same box of सोन पापड़ी (*son paapRee*) [sohn pahp-Ree] tours the entire city every year. Bringing a good Dibbaa to the in-laws is basic festival armor — and never return anyone's container empty.

CULTURE

पैर छूना (*pair chhoonaa*) [pehr chhoo-nah] — touching elders' feet — is the highest-value gesture you can learn: bend and touch (or reach toward) the feet of grandparents, parents, and elder relatives on festivals, first meetings, and goodbyes. The formal name is चरण स्पर्श (*charaN sparsh*) [chuh-ruN spursh]. The elder blesses you — जीते रहो! (*jeete raho!*) [jee-tay ruh-hoh] "live long!", खुश रहो! (*khush raho!*) [khush ruh-hoh] — or pulls you up mid-bend with *bas bas*, *beTaa*; the attempt itself is the point. An American son-in-law who does this on Diwali will be discussed admiringly for weeks. Follow your partner's lead on whose feet and when.

DELHI STREET NOTE

Every festival has a Delhi address: Dussehra's burning *raavaN* at the Ramlila grounds near the Red Fort, Eid morning and iftaar lanes at *jaamaa masjid*, *chhaTh* crowds at the Yamuna ghats, and baraats blocking your road all wedding season — give it five minutes and enjoy the band. Two practical notes: firecrackers are heavily restricted in Delhi these days, so Diwali is more lights, card games — ताश (*taash*) [tahsh] — and food than bombs; and in Holi week, watch for water balloons from balconies. Kids start "practicing" days early.

WITH YOUR PARTNER

1) Festival quiz: your partner names a festival, you fire back three words that belong to it — *divaalee* → *deeye*, *miThaaee*, *safaaee*! Then swap. 2) Ask your partner to walk you through their family's biggest festival day, then retell it back in three Hindi sentences using this chapter's words. 3) Rehearse the in-law entrance for the next occasion, full choreography: Dibbaa in both hands, नमस्ते आंटी जी, दिवाली मुबारक! (*namaste aanTee jee, divaalee mubaarak!*) [nuh-muhs-tay ahn-Tee jee, di-vah-lee mu-bah-ruk], then the feet-touch — your partner plays the aunty and must bless you properly: *jeete raho!*